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Hindustan Times
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India a trusted partner in weaponised world: Modi

Rajeev Jayaswal
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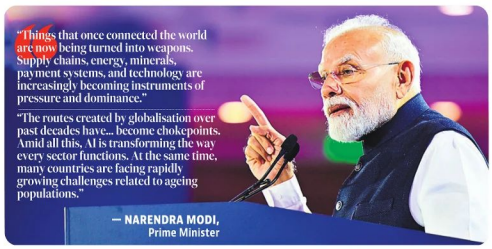
NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday pitched India as a reliable global partner to empower humanity in an unstable world where supply chains, trade and technologies were weaponised as he underlined the unique path forged by the country that endeavoured to open new doors for other nations.

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi, Modi also hailed the country's transformation under his government, underlined the strides taken in economic inclusion, showcased India's dynamism as the "mother of democracy" and its confluence of languages and cultures, and emphasised the nation's commitment to international technological, climate and economic solidarity.

continued on →13



LTCG DEBATE HEALTHY, KEEN TO HEAR VIEWS, SAYS SITHARAMAN

Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday acknowledged the debate over long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax and securities transaction tax (STT), as well as the rupee's recent depreciation, while expressing confidence that private investment in India was reviving. "It's healthy to have this debate, and I will be keen to hear them," she said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum. →P16

NATION-BUILDING BETS OVER SHORT-TERM RETURNS: CHANDRA

Tata Sons chair N Chandrasekaran said the group will keep building what India and the world need, including semiconductor chips, even if these projects are slow to deliver amid a tussle with owners who are pressing for quicker returns. Tata's semiconductor push shouldn't be judged on whether it meets the numbers in two to three years, he said. "Direction is certain, need is certain, ability to execute is certain," he said. →P16

LAST-MINUTE QUESTION PAPER GENERATION CAN CURB LEAKS: NILEKANI

Generating exam papers at the last minute from a question bank will eliminate the "economic incentive" behind paper leaks, Infosys chair and head of the high-powered task force on exam reforms Nandan Nilekani said. He added that expanding the network of testing locations was another priority. Nilekani said the idea that AI is fuelling job losses "is all disaster-marketing to suit the interests of large capital". →P10

morestories

IMF: India weathered global storm better than others →P2
Mkts rebound as FM remarks lift investor sentiments →P16

No let-up in stir: Rahul; you'll lose again: Shah

Smriti Kak Ramachandran and Saubhadra Chatterji
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NEW DELHI: Union home minister Amit Shah on Tuesday hit out at the Opposition, saying the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) will return to power with a resounding majority in 2029, hours after Congress leader Rahul Gandhi vowed that the ongoing protests against chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar will continue.

Citing the outcome of recent bypolls in states such as Gujarat, Rajasthan and West Bengal, where the Bharatiya Janata Party won, Shah said the Congress leadership, particularly the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Gandhi, should reflect on recent defeats.

"Rahul Gandhi should engage in self-reflection by learning from the election results. Instead of questioning the election process with every defeat, the Congress should reflect on its acceptability among the people. The trust of the people is earned

continued on →13

LoP in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and other INDIA bloc leaders during a press conference in New Delhi on Tuesday. ARVIND YADAV/HT

Jantar Mantar change after SC nudge: Police

Shruti Kakkar
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NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday told the Delhi High Court that they denotified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site in the national capital following a Supreme Court order earlier this month that nudged authorities to consider alternative, better-equipped spaces where residents could exercise their democratic rights without hindering public safety.

"We denotified Jantar Mantar after Supreme Court's order dated October 9," the Delhi Police told the single-judge bench of Justice Amit Mahajan. →P4

No UPI fees till after Diwali with 'festive season in mind'

Rajeev Jayaswal
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NEW DELHI: The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), which operates India's retail payments and settlement systems, on Tuesday deferred the implementation of a 0.4% merchant discount rate (MDR) on select UPI transactions above ₹2,000, just two days before the scheduled rollout.

The deferment is temporary, and a fresh implementation date will be announced after Diwali.

"The UPI and Services Steering Committee today decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on select Person-to-Merchant UPI transactions shall be implemented immediately post-Diwali, on a date to be notified separately," Mumbai-based NPCI said in a statement.

NPCI SAID THAT A DATE FOR THE IMPLEMENTATION OF MERCHANT DISCOUNT RATE WILL BE NOTIFIED SEPARATELY

A circular issued by NPCI last month had set an MDR of 0.4% on select P2M payments above ₹2,000 made through popular UPI apps such as Paytm, PhonePe and Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM), with implementation scheduled for October 15. NPCI had clarified that merchants, not consumers, would pay the fee. The levy was also capped at ₹300 for transactions of ₹75,000 or more.

As per the September 15 circular, person-to-person payments were to remain free. For essential services such as railways, telecom, fuel and insurance, the MDR was capped at a flat ₹5 per transaction above ₹2,000. →P16

11 MINORS DROWN AS BOAT CAPSIZES ON GANGA IN BIHAR

Avinash Kumar
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PATNA: Eleven children drowned and several people were feared missing on Tuesday after a boat capsized in Raghopur Diara area of Vaishali district in Bihar, police said, adding that rescue agencies were searching the waters of the Ganga for survivors. Seven people were rescued, said officials.

Initial reports suggested an imbalance caused the capsize.

Police said the incident took place around 8.30pm when the boat was ferrying passengers to a hamlet near Rampur Shyamchand village.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi termed the accident "deeply painful". →P12

MoS Murugan quits; third minister to step down in four months

Smriti Kak Ramachandran
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NEW DELHI: Union minister of state (MoS) for information and broadcasting L Murugan on Tuesday announced his resignation from the Rajya Sabha and the Union council of ministers, saying that he would return to Tamil Nadu to focus on politics in the southern state.

Murugan is the third minister after former MoS for railways and food processing Ravneet Singh Bittu and former MoS for minority affairs and fisheries, animal husbandry and dairying George Kurian to exit in less than four months, stoking speculation that a rejig in the council of ministers was imminent.

While there is speculation that the rejig may see several new faces, it is unclear whether minister of petroleum and natural gas Hardeep Puri and MoS for Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution and Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment BL Verma – who did not get renominated to the Rajya Sabha from Uttar Pradesh – will continue to serve as ministers. →P8

L Murugan

PHARMACY OWNER SHOOTS DEAD PJB ANTI-DRUG ACTIVIST

CHANDIGARH: An anti-drug activist, Parvinder Singh alias Jhota, was shot dead by a medical store owner in Punjab's Mansa on Tuesday, police said, adding that the accused is on the run. The murder drew condemnation from political leaders, who cornered the ruling AAP over the law-and-order situation in the state. →P11

'LADAKH INTEGRAL PART OF INDIA': MEA SLAMS CHINA

Rezaul H Laskar
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NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday rejected China's objection to naming of places in Ladakh, and emphasised the Chinese side's actions cannot change the fact that Ladakh is "an integral and inalienable part" of the country. →P9

PAGE ONE PLUS

{ MY INDIA } AHEAD OF LIKELY VISIT

Modi, Carney discuss relations in phone call

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and his Canadian counterpart Mark Carney on Tuesday agreed to build on the momentum in bilateral ties and work on "concrete outcomes" in key areas such as trade and security against the backdrop of geo-economic churn caused by the policies of the US administration. Modi said that he had a "warm and productive conversation" with Carney. A readout from the Canadian PMO said Carney and Modi reiterated their "commitment to conclude negotiations" for a comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA) "at the earliest opportunity, supporting efforts to double two-way trade by 2030". The two leaders agreed to remain in close contact ahead of Modi's visit to Canada in December, it said. HTC

{ BUSINESS } CROWDED HOME MARKET

Apple launches new smart home products

Apple on Tuesday launched a raft of smart products, including the iPad-like device HomeView, in a bet that its AI-upgraded Siri virtual assistant can help it carve out a bigger share of the competitive connected home market. The HomeView device, which starts at $299 and starts shipping next month, will help users control doorbells, thermostats and smart locks in a market where Apple has tinkered for a decade without major success. The HomeView launch was accompanied by updates to HomePod smart speaker and Apple TV devices. It introduced a range of accessories made by LG and Schneider Electric and designed with help from Apple. REUTERS

{ BUSINESS } OPS TRANSFER IN PHASED MANNER

Mumbai int'l flights shift to NMIA deferred till March '27

The proposed partial shifting of international flights from Mumbai airport to Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) has been deferred until the summer schedule beginning March 2027, following discussions between airport operator Adani Airports Holdings Ltd (AAHL) and airline representatives on Tuesday, an official said. AAHL, which owns both airports, had asked airlines to shift 33% of their international flights from Mumbai airport to NMIA by October 25. Mumbai airport had planned to cut 265 weekly international flights from Terminal 2 (T2) from that date, HT reported last week. "With the redevelopment plan shifted to March, airlines are expected to transition their international operations in a phased manner," the official said. →P16

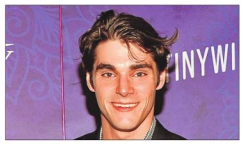
{ SPORT } 10-YEAR DEAL

F1 to return to Africa with race in Rwanda

Formula 1 will return to Africa with a grand prix in Rwanda starting early next decade once a new track has been built southeast of the capital, F1 and the country's president said Tuesday. The announcement of a 10-year-deal to hold an African Grand Prix in Rwanda comes after a campaign by President Paul Kagame to bring F1 to the continent for the first time since 1993. F1 said a purpose-built circuit was expected to be completed "early in the next decade" in Bugesera, about 40km from Kigali. The track will be built near an under-construction airport serving the capital, using hills and dips in the landscape to challenge drivers, F1 said. AP

{ WORLD } RJ MITTE

'Breaking Bad' actor dies by suicide at 34



Actor RJ Mitte, whose personal experience living with cerebral palsy informed his role as Walter White Jr, the physically disabled son of a drug kingpin in the landmark television series "Breaking Bad," died on Monday at age 34. News of Mitte's death in Brownsville, Texas, was announced in a statement released through his talent management agency. A publicist for the actor later confirmed news reports that Mitte took his own life. No further details about the circumstances were given. Mitte's performance as Walter "Flynn" White Jr, who walked with crutches and spoke with a slur, gained early attention from fans who dubbed him "the breakfast king" for his recurring appearances in scenes around the family breakfast table. REUTERS

India weathered global storm better than its peers, says IMF

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NEW DELHI: The Indian economy is expected to grow at 7% in 2026-27 and 2027-28, retaining its status as the world's fastest-growing economy, the International Monetary Fund said on Tuesday. The latest IMF projections also suggest that India's high growth run might outlast the waning of policy-induced cyclical tailwinds from income tax cuts and Goods and Services Tax rationalization. This feat comes at a time when most countries in India's cohort – energy importers and those outside the ongoing technology boom – are struggling with economic growth and facing macroeconomic disruptions. IMF's latest observations should put to rest the controversy about the June quarter GDP numbers lacking statistical integrity.

"In a world filled with uncertainty, India offers the assurance of reliability and stability," Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi. "In the April-June quarter of this year, India's growth rate stood at 7.8 percent. And this growth rests on a strong foundation," he added.

"India remains among the fastest-growing major economies, with growth in 2026 projected at 7.0 percent. This reflects stronger-than-expected momentum, supported by resilient domestic demand and robust services activity", IMF said in its October 2026 World Economic Outlook (WEO), which was released on Tuesday morning.

What makes India's performance even more praiseworthy is the fact that it has done so without enjoying the tailwinds of the ongoing technological boom, while braving the headwinds of higher than usual energy prices and without compromising its fiscal stability path.

The report underlines these facts favouring India. "...Primary deficits during 2020–25 in the largest advanced and emerging market economies remained, on average, substantially larger than before the pandemic. In most of these economies, with India an exception, stabilizing debt-to-GDP ratios at 2025 levels would require greater fiscal consolidation than currently envisaged under existing policies," it says.

"Global output is projected to expand at an average annual pace of 3.2 percent in 2028–31, a persistently lackluster performance compared with the pre-pandemic (2000–19) historical average of 3.7 percent. Relative to that in January 2026, the medium-term outlook has become increasingly uneven, with downgrades concentrated among economies directly affected by the conflict in the Middle East and energy-importing emerging market and developing economies elsewhere, excluding India. India stands out with upward revisions, reflecting sustained momentum and growing evidence of stronger growth potential supported by favorable demographic dynamics, a large and expanding domestic market, and continued structural reforms", the report adds.

IMF also noted India's achievements in carving out a way to negate the trade disruption in the global economy.

"Tangible progress in trade arrangements could reduce trade costs, improve policy predictability, make trading relationships more sustainable, and support global activity. In this context, efforts to negotiate or deepen new regional and bilateral trade agreements—such as the EU's recent trade agreements with India and MERCOSUR (the Southern Common Market) or the United Kingdom's agreement with India—could lower tariffs and nontariff barriers on traded goods and services among participating economies, facilitate adjustments to recent trade policy changes, and strengthen supply-chain resilience", the report said.

India's praiseworthy economic performance and outlook however is the proverbial silver lining of the dark clouds surrounding the global economy. IMF notes that while global growth has so far not collapsed the larger story is deeply uneven with "rapidly narrowing margins of adjustment in the near term". Continuing trade tensions, an unending war in West Asia and the energy shock which has followed continued to generate headwinds for the global economy. While this has been countered by some extent by the ongoing technology boom, the world economy is now divided into two camps.

"The interaction of these forces—geopolitics and technology—has produced a split global economy: Favourable terms of trade or technology-related exports and investment give some countries a cushion, whereas others face higher import bills and weaker demand", IMF said.

"The medium-term growth outlook remains lackluster by historical standards and uneven across countries, in part reflecting varying degrees of AI preparedness and robustness of the energy mix. Risks are skewed to the downside. A prolonged stalemate or further escalation in the Middle East could keep energy and food prices elevated and volatile, revive inflationary pressures, worsen fiscal and external balances, and weigh on growth...A reassessment of AI-related profitability and productivity prospects could sharply reduce investment, trigger equity market corrections, and tighten financial conditions, with spillovers to economies integrated into technology supply chains and stakes in technology stocks", the IMF report added.

To be sure, these adverse global economic conditions will inevitably pose downside risks to India's macroeconomic performance as well. While the immediate challenge is rising inflation -- retail inflation for 2026-27 is expected to stay at 5.2% according to RBI projections -- the effects will also translate into a higher fiscal burden if fuel prices are not increased in line with higher crude oil prices.

Another challenge is the withdrawal of foreign investors from Indian capital markets, driven by higher interest rates in advanced economies and the ongoing rally in AI related equities, which can potentially create external balance and negative wealth effect difficulties. It is important to remember that these challenges would be even more difficult to navigate had India's growth story and fiscal stability not been what they are right now.

CHART 1

Projections for GDP growth (%) India is among the fastest-growing major economies

Note: For India, data and projections are presented on a fiscal year (FY) basis, with FY 2026-27 (starting in April 2026) shown in the 2026 column.
Source: October 2026 World Economic Outlook, IMF

CHART 2

%age point deviation from cumulative growth in Jan 2026 Update

Medium-term growth outlook has seen downgrades since Jan 2026 across energy-importing markets, except India

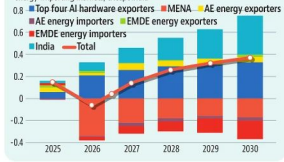
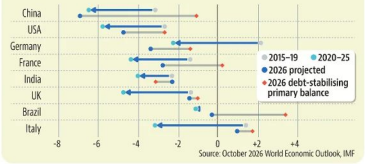


CHART 3

Primary deficit (% of GDP)

Most large advanced, emerging economies require better fiscal consolidation for stabilizing debt-to-GDP ratio, but not India



Source: October 2026 World Economic Outlook, IMF

PICK OF THE DAY

9 ACQUITTED IN 1996 JEHANABAD KILLINGS; COURT SLAMS PROBE, POINTS TO LAPSES

Arun Kumar
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PATNA: The Patna High Court on Tuesday set aside a trial court judgment convicting nine people in the 1996 Jehanabad killings and acquitted them for lack of sufficient evidence and identification. All nine had been sentenced to life imprisonment.

The court also criticised the Bihar Police for sluggish investigation and serious lapses in evidence collection, directing the state police chief to constitute a committee of senior police officers to review the investigation and assess accountability.

The incident took place on the intervening night of August 8 and 9, 1996, under Karpi police station, now in Arwal district, following a dispute over irrigation water. Four people were killed and several others injured in the attack.

On April 3, 2023, an additional district and sessions judge in Jehanabad convicted several accused and sentenced them to life imprisonment. Nine of them challenged the judgment before the high court.

A bench of justices Rajiv Ranjan Prasad and Kumar Manish observed that, despite the heinous nature of the incident, convictions must rest on strong legal evidence. It noted that the court had previously directed the state home department and the director general of police (DGP) to examine cases in which investigative lapses had led to acquittals, but said it was unclear whether those directions had yielded significant results.

"It is high time for the authorities to sit together and review its policy in this regard," the court said, adding that the investigation required scrutiny by a team of senior police officers.

The bench directed the DGP to constitute a three-member committee of senior officers of repute to review the investigating officer's work and take appropriate administrative action based on its findings within three months of receiving a copy of the judgment.

It also directed the Bihar home department to submit a detailed report on the findings and the accountability of officials found to have erred.

Tax exemptions not for same-sex couples: Centre

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BENGALURU: The Union government has told the Karnataka High Court that same-sex couples in India cannot be granted tax exemptions available to spouses and family members under existing tax laws because doing so will recognise same-sex marital relationships.

The government made the submissions before a bench of Justice B Shyama Prasad on Monday while opposing a plea filed by a same-sex couple seeking a gift-tax exemption available to married couples.

Solicitor General of India Tushar Mehta and Additional Solicitor General Arvind Kamath, who appeared for the Centre, told the court that the petitioners cannot use the Income Tax (IT) Act to secure a benefit linked to a marital status that the Indian law does not recognise for same-sex couples.

The government said the tax law refers to legally recognised relationships and that any challenge to their exclusion must target the laws governing marriage, rather than the tax provision. It also said extending the exemption would "indirectly recognise same-sex marriages" and could "create scope for tax evasion."

Mehta had earlier argued that interpreting "spouse" to include same-sex partners would effectively recognise their relationship as a marriage under Indian law. He said the exemption rests on the legal status of marriage, not the sex of individuals involved.

The government further said in its written submissions made before the court: "It is submitted that same-sex relationships are not equivalent to marriage and persons in same-sex relationships are not 'spouses' under the law. Hence, the benefit of the proviso would not be available to those in same-sex relationships."

The government was opposing a petition filed by Anurag Kalia and Akhilesh Godi, both residents of Bengaluru, who challenged the Constitutional validity of the "fifth proviso" to Section 56(2)(x) of the Income Tax Act, 1961. The provision exempts gifts between "spouses" from tax.

The petitioners, however, have argued that the IT Act effectively makes them pay tax for expressing their love for their partners, while married couples can exchange gifts without the same tax burden.

THE GOVT MADE THE SUBMISSIONS WHILE OPPOSING A PLEA FILED BY A SAME-SEX COUPLE SEEKING THE GIFT-TAX EXEMPTION AVAILABLE TO MARRIED COUPLES

Their counsel, advocate Dhruv Janssen Sanghvi, told the court that denying same-sex couples the tax exemption reflects unequal treatment of their relationships and penalises them for expressing love for their partners.

The court will now hear the matter on November 2 to seek "technical clarifications on documents filed in the case".

The case arose after Godi gifted Kalia a 22-karat gold bracelet, a family heirloom. The two were preparing their income-tax returns for the 2025–26 assessment year when the tax issue arose. They then moved the HC in September 2025 seeking the court declare the fifth provision to Section 56(2)(x) of the Act "unconstitutional." They also challenged the exclusion of same-sex partners from this benefit.

Advocate Sanghvi argued that the petition raises a narrower question than the one the SC considered in 2023, in the case of Supriya Chakraborty vs Union of India, where it had declined among other things, to recognise same-sex marriages. The question in the present case, he said, is merely whether a tax benefit available to spouses can be denied to same-sex partners solely because they cannot legally marry. He also said marital status cannot automatically justify every distinction in the law. Even if marriage provides a reasonable basis for classification in certain contexts, the government must show why the distinction serves the purpose of the particular law, he said.

{ IN PUNE }

Between trauma and legal delay, a woman's fight to end her pregnancy

Mayura Janwalkar
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MUMBAI: A 33-year-old Pune software engineer in the 24th week of her pregnancy finds herself caught in an increasingly surreal legal battle that not only complicates her personal situation but also throws up larger questions over laws governing termination of pregnancy.

In early July, she found out that her husband — who she met on a matrimonial website and married in 2025 — was married to another woman and their divorce was not yet finalised. Weeks later, the woman found out she was around 13 weeks pregnant. She then moved to terminate her pregnancy and approached clinics in Pune. However, under the Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act, 1971, at least two doctors need to clear an abortion when the pregnancy is beyond 12 weeks, which she was unable to procure. She said the clinics insisted she get a court order.

In August, she moved the Bombay High Court seeking permission for termination, arguing that the law makes exceptions for victims of rape and sexual assault. She accused her husband and his family of abuse and harassment in addition to betraying her, and that she no longer wished to bear the child of a man who had treated her so poorly. She also added that her pregnancy and circumstances had forced her to quit her job as a software professional and that she no longer had the means to raise a child singlehandedly.

However, the Bombay High Court, which heard her August prayer only last week, refused to grant her relief under the MTP Act, stating that she did not fall within any of the seven categories of women who can be permitted to undergo an abortion with the approval of a medical board constituted under the Act.

Her lawyer is now preparing to move the Supreme Court, where they may have to seek an urgent hearing.

The law provides exceptions for victims of rape, incest, or for women whose marital status may have changed at a later stage in the pregnancy like divorce or widowhood to be referred to a medical board for termination of the pregnancy past the 24th week.

The Bombay High Court has often underscored a woman's bodily autonomy in such cases, granting relief to minor victims of sexual assault. However, for the woman in this case, the court could only offer its empathy.

SHE FOUND OUT HER HUSBAND — WHO SHE MET ON A MATRIMONIAL WEBSITE AND MARRIED IN 2025 — WAS MARRIED TO ANOTHER WOMAN AND THEIR DIVORCE WAS NOT YET FINALISED

"Although we empathise with the predicament of the petitioner (woman), unfortunately, in the facts of the present case, we see no legal relief for her under the provisions of the MTP Act, 1971," a division bench of justices Bharati Dangre and Ashish Chavan said in their order last week.

However, the woman argued that the court's delayed hearing pushed her pregnancy past the threshold.

"I was 15 weeks pregnant when I approached the High Court. But I am past 24 weeks now. The delay was not on my part. But I am the one who has to suffer," the woman told HT. To be sure, the High Court judges took note of this — they wrote in their order that the woman learnt about her pregnancy after an ultrasound on July 26 and approached the court in August.

However, the case was placed before the judges for a hearing on October 6.

Her lawyer, Narayan Mishra, who also represents her husband's previous wife, said that of the various legal pursuits before the woman, the termination of her pregnancy is most urgent.

The sequence of events that led her to the court is etched in the woman's memory.

On the matrimonial website where she first encountered him in 2023, his marital status was described as "never married." They were of the same age but from different castes and separate regions. Their marriage was solemnised in February 2025. She told HT that she had a miscarriage in 2025 and that her husband and her mother-in-law began illtreating her and "hurling caste slurs."

She said the humiliation escalated dramatically after she grew suspicious of her husband's secretive use of his phone. One day she found his phone and saw a number of blocked accounts on his Instagram which carried the same surname. She followed up on her suspicions and eventually tracked down a man on Instagram who told her his sister was married to her husband.

"This man told me his sister had filed divorce and domestic violence proceedings against my husband in Mumbai but that the divorce had not been granted," the woman said.

After further verifying facts, she lodged an FIR against her husband on July 20 at the Kalepadal police station in Pune accusing him of bigamy and offences under the SC/ST Act.

Ever since, she has been trying to terminate her pregnancy and frets that with each passing day an abortion might become untenable.

"The law won't let me terminate it at this stage. Bringing this child into the world is going to be very hard. I am not prepared to be a single parent. I don't know what to do." The woman's elderly parents have moved to Pune from their village in Vidarbha to live with her. "I am living off my savings," said the woman. "My parents are elderly and none of this is easy for them either," she said.

Gynaecologist and medical activist Nikhil Datar said he had filed a case in the Supreme Court two years in which he had listed 22 different categories of women who are not covered by the 2021 amendment in the MTP Act. "The rules under the MTP Act make an exception for a divorced or widowed woman but not for a woman in a live-in relationship or a woman cheated by her husband. Her right to terminate pregnancy is linked to her relationship with her husband. What logic does that have?" he asked.

On the question of a woman's bodily autonomy, he said: "Up to the 20th week a woman can get an abortion if she says her contraceptive failed. Why does this change in the 21st week?"

DU clears ₹5.9Kcr hostel plan as older projects remain stuck

Gargi Shukla
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NEW DELHI: Delhi University's (DU) Executive Council on Tuesday approved a fresh set of hostel projects estimated to cost ₹5,889 crore, including new residential facilities and the reconstruction of two existing hostels, as the university seeks to expand accommodation for students amid a persistent shortage of affordable housing.

To be sure, the move comes even as several previously announced hostel projects remain pending, with work held up by funding constraints and construction challenges. Official data accessed by HT shows that seven projects are at various stages of delay, although the stated combined cost of these projects requires verification against the individual estimates.

The approvals on Tuesday include ₹4,027 crore for new hostels, expected to accommodate 15,758 students, and ₹1,862 crore for reconstructing two existing hostels, with a proposed combined capacity of 6,137 students. The university said the projects would provide residential facilities for 21,895 students.

DU vice-chancellor Yogesh Singh said the proposals, approved at an emergency meeting of the university's highest statutory decision-making body, would now be forwarded to the Union ministry of education for approval of grant-in-aid.

"According to the proposal passed by the EC, new hostels will be constructed at an estimated cost of ₹4,027 crore, providing additional accommodation for 15,758 students. Additionally, a proposal to reconstruct two existing hostels was passed, with an estimated cost of ₹1,862 crore; this will provide residential facilities for 6,137 students," the university said in a statement on Tuesday.

The proposed facilities include two additional hostel blocks for the Institute of Eminence hostels at the university's Dhaka Complex, separate boys' and girls' hostels at Veer Savarkar College in Roshanpura, Najafgarh, and hostels for men and women at DU's West Campus in Dwarka, Najafgarh, and East Campus in Surajmal Vihar, Kardardooma.

The reconstruction plan covers Jubilee Hall, established in 1947 and currently accommodating 212 students, and the Postgraduate Men's Hostel, built in 1975 with a capacity of 100 students. The redeveloped facilities are proposed to accommodate 3,795 and 2,337 students, respectively.

"The university's earlier hostels were built differently from the conditions expected in the future; therefore, planning is being done with the next 100 years in view," Singh said.

Older projects held up

The fresh approvals come as the university continues to grapple with delays in earlier residential projects. Among these are two projects at the Dhaka Complex — a Girls' Hostel/Studio Apartment Complex estimated to cost ₹233.35 crore and a Hostel-cum-Residential Block pegged at ₹318 crore. A university official, who asked not to be identified, said both were expected to be completed by December 2028.

The Nirbhaya Residential Accommodation Project, also at the Dhaka Complex, has seen its estimated cost rise from ₹272 crore to ₹400 crore. Its funding is yet to be disbursed by the Union ministry of women and child development, the official said.

"We have made several attempts to reach out to the women and child development minister, but the funds are yet to be released," a senior university official said, speaking on condition of anonymity.

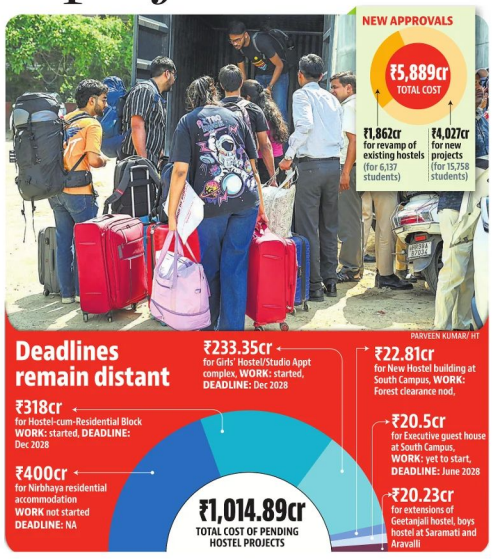
Other delayed projects include an executive hostel/guest house there, pegged at ₹20.5 crore, and the extension of Geetanjali Girls' Hostel, estimated to cost ₹11.23 crore. Both are scheduled for completion by June 2028.

Meanwhile, the proposed vertical extensions of the existing Saramati and Aravali boys' hostels and a new hostel building at South Campus, estimated to cost around ₹9 crore and ₹22.81 crore, respectively, have been put on hold because of construction challenges arising from their location in the Ridge area, the official said.

The delays have added to concerns over student accommodation. The issue has drawn renewed attention following the September 6 collapse of a five-storey building housing a boys' paying guest accommodation in Satya Niketan, which resulted in the deaths of five students.

Official figures show DU has 251,474 students enrolled in conventional programmes. More than half are estimated to be from outside Delhi, although not all would necessarily require university accommodation.

Against this student population, the university has 7,224 official hostel beds: 3,688 in college hostels for undergraduate students and 3,536 in university-run hostels for postgraduate students. The new projects would substantially expand capacity, but their implementation will depend on funding approval and construction timelines.



Seemapuri collapse: Building owner held

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NEW DELHI: The owner of the five-storey building that collapsed in east Delhi's New Seemapuri, killing at least four people, was arrested on Saturday, police said.

Mohammad Anwar, who had been absconding since the collapse last Wednesday, was arrested as part of the investigation into the incident, officers aware of the matter said.

A senior police officer, who did not wish to be named, said that the accused was hiding with a relative at his residence in the neighbourhood but had switched off his phone. "When the building collapsed, he was at home but did not sustain injuries. His wife Salma did. He visited the hospital as well but fled when he realised people had died and a case would be registered," the officer said.

During interrogation, the accused allegedly told police that he was aware that the foundation was old and weak. "He still went ahead and built four floors over it and used heavy lanters - unlike others in this neighbourhood. The walls are weak in these buildings," the officer said.

The collapse, which occurred around 3.30pm in the congested lanes of New Seemapuri, trapped at least 11 people, including residents and neighbours. Eight people were injured in the incident.

The death toll, police had said, could rise as investigators await forensic findings to establish the identities of five body parts recovered from the debris. Police have initiated DNA examinations to determine whether the remains belong to victims already identified or to additional people.

"The death toll remains at four but is likely to go up after the report is received," the officer said, adding that all the parts are preserved in the mortuary of GTB Hospital.

The post-mortem examinations of three women who died in the collapse had been conducted, officers said. The deceased were identified as Hazra Bibi, 56, her niece Nusrat, 33, and Gulafsa, 21, who was four months pregnant. A child aged around three or four years was also killed.

Anwar, who is in his late 50s, was not present in the building when it collapsed. His wife, son and three-year-old grandson were among those injured. Nusrat was his daughter.

Police registered a case at Seemapuri police station under sections 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder) and 110 (attempt to commit culpable homicide) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Charge sheet in rape-murder filed, gait analysis done: Cops

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NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has submitted a 365 page charge sheet, which includes mention of a gait analysis, in the gang-rape and murder of a 16-year-old girl, whose highly decomposed body was found in outer Delhi's Swaroop Nagar last month, officers aware of the matter said on Tuesday.

The incident took place on September 11 and four teenagers – three of them minors — were held in the case. Her body was found on September 13. According to the charge sheet, the accused allegedly raped the girl and stabbed her multiple times before dumping her body in a field in Khadda Colony. They allegedly decided to kill her after she threatened to report the sexual assault to the police.

One senior police officer said that the charge sheet includes the mention of a gait analysis — a study and evaluation of human walking or running mechanics using video recording — that they have conducted of the accused.

"The exhibits have been sent to the Central Forensic Science Laboratory and the report will be attached in the supplementary charge sheet," the officer said.

Gait analysis is rare and was undertaken in this case to help identify the perpetrators who were captured in CCTV footage, according to the officer.

The charge sheet also includes statements of 54 witnesses.

It details how investigators at Swaroop Nagar police station, who initially suspected that the body found on September 13 was that of a middle-aged man, eventually identified the victim and traced the alleged perpetrators by scanning CCTV footage, spotting a distinctive design on a delivery tempo and tracking down the vehicle in the early hours of September 16.

Police said that they have also sent another report to FSL in Chandigarh for matching of the accused DNA with the semen lifted from the girl's body.

"The postmortem report which confirms forceful penetration and stabbing has been attached," the officer said.

{ MCD DRIVE } SATYA NIKETAN AFTERMATH

PGs get 15 days to prove structural safety

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NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has directed zonal authorities to mandatorily seek structural safety certificates from over 2,400 paying guest (PG) accommodations across the city in the next 15 days, senior civic officials said.

A senior municipal official said that in the second phase of the exercise, following a survey in the first phase, directions have been issued to all of its 12 zones to seek structural safety certificates for 2,453 such buildings.

"The exercise found four visibly dangerous buildings and vacation notices have been issued to all of these four structures. Since most of these buildings lack approved building plans, we have asked them to get structural safety certificates. There should at least be baseline safety arrangements. Up to 15 days will be provided to the owners to complete this exercise," the official, who did not wish to be named, said.

In an exercise mandated by the Delhi High Court in the wake of the Satya Niketan building collapse, the engineering wing had earmarked 2,453 PGs across Delhi, with maximum concentration in Civil Lines, South and Karol Bagh zone.

However, previous attempts at structural safety audits have failed. In June 2020, the three erstwhile municipal corporations had fixed a six-month deadline for obtaining a structural safety certificate for high-risk buildings and older structures, but almost six years later, only a fraction of the properties have been covered.

Compliance has also remained an issue, with only a few thousand submitting structural audit, even as Delhi has more than five million buildings, with most developed without following any regulation. The Tejendra Khanna Committee, set up in 2006 to look into various aspects of unauthorised construction and misuse of premises in the city, found that 70-80% structures had violated building norms.

On September 25, MCD submitted to the high court that building plans of only 30% of these buildings could be found; they housed more than 50,000 and comprised more than 32,000 rooms, it said. The court was hearing a batch of public interest litigations raising several concerns about regulation of PG accommodations for university students in the city, in the aftermath of a building collapse at Satya Niketan that killed seven people, including five students. The court will hear the matter next on October 14.

The official explained that there are no licences issued for PG accommodation units, as it is not a regulated activity.

Aadhaar link mandatory to get electricity subsidy in city

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NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has made Aadhaar authentication or proof of possession of an Aadhaar number mandatory for consumers seeking electricity subsidy, according to a notification issued by the power department, as it prepares to introduce an opt-in system under which beneficiaries will have to renew their choice annually to continue receiving the benefit.

Officials said the new requirement will not immediately affect existing beneficiaries, who will continue to receive the subsidy until the proposed opt-in system is finalised. The government is likely to place the proposal before the cabinet next month and is aiming to roll it out around Diwali, although the modalities are still being worked out. "The government plans to collect consumers' Aadhaar details to ensure that subsidies reach eligible beneficiaries. During a review of the scheme, it was found that some dormant consumers were continuing to receive the benefit," an official said.

Under the proposed system, consumers will have to actively opt in for the subsidy through a dedicated online portal and renew their choice every year. The portal will be hosted and maintained by the power department, while distribution companies will validate consumers' account details, officials said.

Consumers are likely to log in using their 14-digit consumer account (CA) number and confirm whether they wish to avail themselves of the subsidy.

The notification, dated September 30 and published in the Delhi Gazette, states that consumers seeking the benefit under the government's electricity subsidy scheme will have to furnish proof of their Aadhaar number through a web portal or any other mode prescribed by the government.

The requirement will apply to beneficiaries covered by the scheme through power distribution companies BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd, BSES Yamuna Power Ltd and Tata Power Delhi Distribution Ltd, as well as the New Delhi Municipal Council and Military Engineer Services, in their respective areas.

Consumers who have not yet been assigned an Aadhaar number will also be eligible to seek the benefit. They can submit an application for Aadhaar enrolment and furnish their details along with the 14-digit enrolment ID number.

Officials clarified that having multiple electricity connections linked to a single Aadhaar number will not, by itself, lead to discontinuation of the subsidy. A consumer owning multiple houses and holding separate electricity connections will also remain eligible, subject to the scheme's applicable conditions.

Under the existing subsidy structure, eligible domestic consumers using up to 200 units of electricity a month receive a 100% subsidy on energy charges.

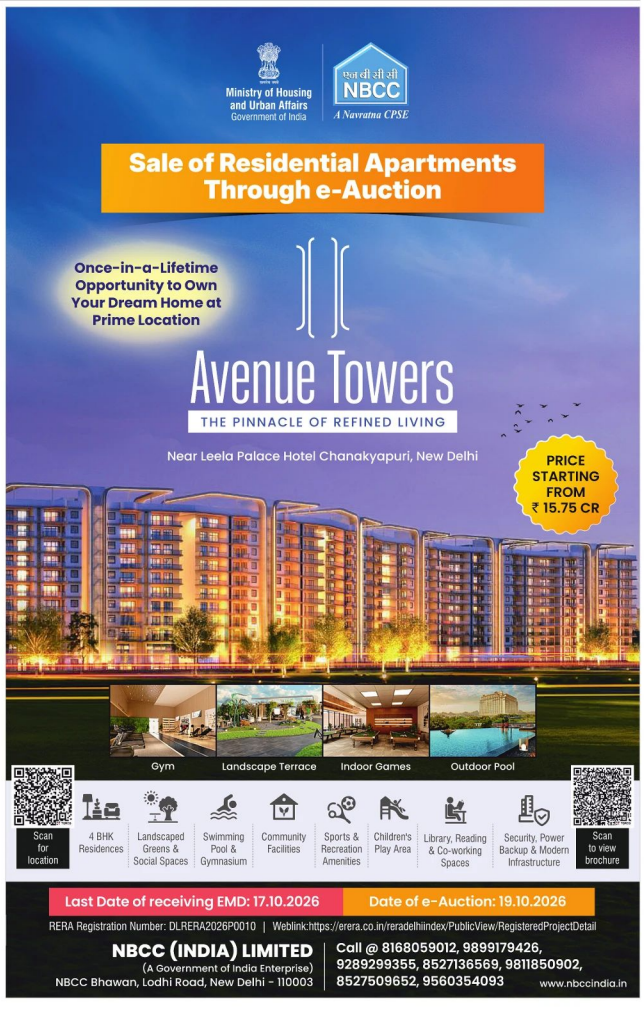
CM: DELHI GOVT TO INSTALL 50,000 CCTV CAMERAS FOR WOMEN'S SAFETY

NEW DELHI: Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta has announced that the government will install 50,000 CCTV cameras across the national capital to ensure the safety and security of people, particularly women, according to officials on Tuesday.

The chief minister, while interacting with student representatives of women's colleges on Monday, highlighted various steps taken by the government, including removal of dark spots, streetlights, regular police patrolling, and deployment of female police personnel on campuses, to address women's safety issues, they said.

Addressing CCTV-related concerns raised by elected representatives of Delhi University colleges, she said 50,000 new CCTV cameras are proposed to be installed across Delhi.

Proper functioning of these cameras will be backed by annual maintenance contracts to ensure regular maintenance and upkeep, she said, and outlined a plan for smart street lighting across Delhi. PTI



{ BURARI GROUND } NO MORE JUST A PLAYGROUND

A protest venue with fences, lack of access

Karn Pratap Singh
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NEW DELHI: On most days, Burari Ground is little more than a vast, nondescript expanse that thousands of commuters cross without a second glance beside the Outer Ring Road. For residents of north Delhi's neighbourhoods, however, the sprawling ground has long been a free, open space to play cricket, fly kites, learn to drive or simply escape the crush of the city. Now, with Delhi Police designating it as one of three new venues for protests, that everyday life faces an uncertain future.

Spread across nearly 23 hectares, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA)-owned ground, also known as Nirankari Ground, was notified on Monday as an alternative protest site after police de-notified Jantar Mantar. Located 18km by road from Jantar Mantar, it is more than twice as far from the Capital's protest hub as the crow flies as it is from Delhi's border with Uttar Pradesh.

The ground has the Nirankari Sarovar complex on one side. Burari and Majlis Park are the closest metro stations. Its expanse has served residents of Burari, Gopalpur village, Mukundpur, Nirankari Colony, Mukherjee Nagar, Kingsway Camp, Majnu Ka Tila, Jahangirpuri, and GTB Nagar.

For years, the ground has accommodated a mix of activities, often simultaneously.

Children and adults play cricket, football and gilli-danda, while learners practise on two-wheelers, three-wheelers, cars and even heavy vehicles. Kite-flyers, physical training groups and cattle grazing are also familiar sights. All of it has been available without an entry fee, despite the absence of basic facilities such as proper pitches, toilets and lighting.

"As there are no big open spaces available in our neighbourhood, this is our favourite playground since childhood. This one ground provides free space for multiple activities all the time," said Mohammad Adil, a 32-year-old from Mukundpur, who was playing gilli-danda with friends.

"On weekends, the ground is filled with 40-50 groups playing cricket, football, gilli-danda and other games," he said.

But as HT found during a visit on Tuesday, the ground has already started to change. Over the past few days, locals said access has been restricted, with barbed-wire fencing put up along its perimeter and wide pits dug at entry points to prevent vehicles from entering. Driving learners have been among those affected.

Around 25-30 children and adults were playing different sports. A handful of two-wheelers and scooters were still visible, while people said vehicle access for driving practice had been stopped.

Two guards from the Nirankari Mission were informing visitors about the restrictions. Sanjay Chaudhary, a guard, said people continued to approach the gates in the hope of entering. "As three sides of the Burari Ground have been fenced with barbed wires, people try to enter it from our side. Since morning, I have turned away 20 people. We told them our gates are permanently closed," he said.

Some residents linked the fencing to security concerns following last month's Aastha Kunj Park gang-rape case, while others viewed it as preparation for the ground's new role.

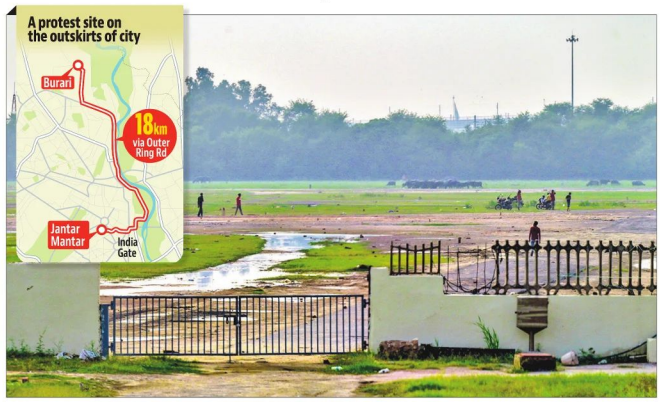
The proposed change has drawn mixed reactions. For some, the prospect of large demonstrations raises concerns about losing one of the few accessible recreational spaces in the area.

Others said the biggest concern is the impact on the already congested Outer Ring Road corridor, a key route for people travelling through north Delhi.

Prashant Chauhan, who runs a grocery shop in Sant Nagar, Burari, was more optimistic. "When people in large numbers gather in an area, they need food, water, transport and other basic services. Small shopkeepers and vendors could benefit from the additional footfall," he said.

The ground has previously been proposed as a venue for demonstrations. During the farmers' protests of 2024-25, authorities offered it as a possible location, but farmers' unions rejected the proposal, calling it an "open jail". They argued that its fenced-off, outlying location would isolate demonstrators from public view and diminish the impact of their agitation.

That concern is likely to resurface as Burari takes on its new role. Unlike Jantar Mantar, which is close to central Delhi and the institutions protesters seek to address, the ground sits well away from the Capital's administrative heart.



The ground is adjacent to Outer Ring Road in north Delhi, and is 18km away from Jantar Mantar. RAJ K RAJ/HT PHOTO

Only 4 of 27 bookings at Ramlila Maidan since 2024 for protests

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NEW DELHI: Ramlila Maidan, which has seen some historic rallies and hosted protests on a grandiose scale from the 1950s, has had few takers over the past few years, as there have been only 27 bookings between January 2024 and September 2026 and only four of them were for protests and demonstrations, according to data shared by the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD).

Among the rest, it was booked nine times for political rallies and public meetings in these three years, as per the data. The MCD manages the 10-acre ground, half of which is utilised for parking and half is currently booked for the Ramlila fair.

To be sure, the Ramlila Ground was designated a protest site for an expected footfall of 1,000 to 50,000 protesters, as per a standing order issued by Delhi Police. The fresh notification has led to multiple traders' bodies and transport unions urging the government to reconsider notifying the ground as a protest site.

An MCD official said, "Half of the Ramlila Maidan is being used for parking space for heavy vehicles and the remaining half is open for booking. We do not offer a small section or parts of Ramlila Ground to be booked. People can only book the entire section."

Among historic protests held here are Syama Prasad Mookerjee's Satyagraha in 1952 Jayaprakash Narayan's Anti-Emergency protest rally in 1975 and Anna Hazare's Anti-Corruption Movement in 2011.

In the past three years, LIC agents held a peaceful protest in March 2025, and Shikshak Shikshika Adhikar Manch held a protest in July 2025, besides other protests by teachers and aspirants. Political parties have maintained a distance from the historic assembly ground.

The MCD report shows that nine bookings for political rallies were made by the People's Party of India, Communist Party of India, Akhil Bharatiya Bishnoi Mahasabha, National Conference, and once each by the Aam Aadmi Party and the All India Congress Committee, among others.

Price to pay

Located around four kilometres from Jantar Mantar, Ramlila Maidan is the closest of the three designated venues to Lutyens' Delhi. But access there comes at a cost, and its availability will be severely limited during the festive season.

The senior MCD official cited above said booking the 12-acre venue costs ₹50,000 a day, along with a refundable security deposit of ₹55,000. Applicants must also obtain a no-objection certificate from the Delhi Traffic Police.

The requirement to book it could prove a hurdle for smaller groups that do not need such a large space. Unlike the tree-lined stretch at Jantar Mantar, the open ground offers little shade, potentially making prolonged demonstrations difficult in hot weather.

Delhi Vyapar Mahasangh on Tuesday submitted a representation seeking reconsideration of Ramlila Maidan as a designated protest venue in "view of public safety, communal sensitivity, hospital Access, Law & Order Challenges and possible disruption of Delhi's wholesale trade."

New Delhi Traders Association, Chamber of Trade and Industries, and All India Transporters and Goods Association, among others, have written to argue against the site. "NDTA welcomes this practical decision of the Govt to shift the designated protest site from Jantar Mantar ...Ramlila Maidan may however be Re-considered, being next to Old Delhi Market areas," NDTA said in a statement.

Jantar Mantar denotification based on SC's orders, HC told

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NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police on Tuesday told the Delhi High Court that they denotified Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site in the Capital following a Supreme Court order earlier this month that nudged authorities to consider alternative, better-equipped spaces where residents could exercise their democratic rights without hindering public safety.

"We denotified Jantar Mantar after Supreme Court's order dated October 9," the Delhi Police told the single-judge bench of justice Amit Mahajan.

The submission was made while the court was hearing a petition filed last week by Indian Youth Congress (IYC) president Uday Bhanu Chib against Delhi Police's denial of permission for a protest at Jantar Mantar.

Delhi Police was represented by additional solicitor general Chetan Sharma and standing counsels Ashish Dixit and Amit Tiwari.

The Supreme Court on October 9 called for a rethink of Delhi's decades-old arrangement of holding demonstrations at Jantar Mantar, recording that the Delhi Police commissioner and other competent authorities would consider designating an alternative venue with better facilities for peaceful protesters.

A bench comprising chief justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said the national capital needed a larger, better-equipped space where citizens could exercise their democratic right to protest without compromising public safety, access to emergency services or the interests of other residents. "It is high time that some other place with amenities for peaceful protestors need to be identified and designated," the bench said in its order.

Delhi Police on Monday denotified Jantar Mantar as a protest site, ending its 33-year-long designation as one of the country's demonstration hubs. They designated three alternative venues for protests: Ramlila Maidan, Burari Ground in north Delhi, and CBD Ground in east Delhi.

Security officials seen deployed near Jantar Mantar on Tuesday. ARVIND YADAV/HT PHOTO

The order, titled "Guidelines for Holding Protests or Demonstrations in Delhi", said the Union ministry of home affairs constituted a committee to "examine alternative proper venues for citizen's right for organising protest demonstrations in place of the existing 'designated site'".

"Based on the committee's recommendations, Jantar Mantar as a protest venue has been de-notified," the order said, adding that three new venues were designated for organising protests and demonstrations.

On Tuesday, Chib's lawyer Siddharth Luthra urged the court to issue notice in the prayers to reconsider its request by undertaking a fresh, reasoned and individualised assessment. With regard to the prayer against Delhi Police's October 1 denial to hold a protest at Jantar Mantar, the senior counsel sought time to amend the prayer in view of Monday's notification.

The law officer opposed notice being issued, saying the petition was infructuous in view of Monday's notification. He said that all the prayers emanated from Chib's prayer against the denial.

However, the bench issued notice on the reconsideration prayer and will now hear the case on November 17.

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD

SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION
CONSTRUCTION OF 2ND NEW RAILWAY LINE (DOUBLING WORKS)
E TENDER NOTICE NO. DYCECJAM-KNLS-OKHA-EPC-01

Dy.Chief Engineer (Construction), Western Railway, Jamnagar for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for following work: **1.Name of work with its location** : Construction of 2nd New Railway Line (Doubling works) between Section Kanalus(including) - Okha (Including) from Km:853.36 to Km:994.35 (Including all yards and stations falling in the section) covering all works that are Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS, All P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, All P. Way Fittings, Other Civil engineering works, Signal & Telecommunication and Electrical (General Services and OHE) complete Works in connection with Kanalus-Okha Doubling Project in Rajkot Division of Western Railway in the State of Gujarat on EPC mode. **2. Approx. cost of the work**: Rs. 1197,60,50,692.56 (Rupees Eleven Hundred Ninety-Seven Crore Sixty Lakh Fifty Thousand Six Hundred Ninety-Two and Fifty-Six Paise Only. **3. Completion Period**: 30 Months. **4. Earnest Money** : Rs. 239521100.00 **5. Date & time for submission of bid**: 11.02.2027 upto 11.00 Hrs. **Web site particulars Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office**: Office of the, Deputy Chief Engineer Construction Jamnagar /Western Railways, behind SSE /WORKS /HAPA office, near Hapa Railway station, Hapa, Gujarat-361120 **Website:- www.ireps.gov.in** CPM 085

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SEARCH FOR MISSING

Anchal

General Public is hereby informed that one Girl **Namely: Anchal D/o Kaushal Paswan R/o H. No. 1036 Near Neemwali Chopal Ladpur Village Delhi Sex:** Female, **Age:** 15 Years, **Height:** 5'1" **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Round, **Built:** Normal **Wearing:** White Colour School Dress White Colour Shoes in feet has been missing since 08.10.2026 from Govt. School Kanjhawala Delhi From The Jurisdiction of Police Station Kanjhawala Delhi, Delhi.

In this regard **513/2026 U/s 137(2) BNS Dated 09.10.2026** has been registered at **PS: Kanjhawala Delhi** Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out the missing Girl but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone have any information about this missing Girl Please inform to the following.

Website : http://cbi.nic.in
E-Mail ID: cic@cbi.gov.in
Fax: 011-24368639 SHO
DP/14528/RD/2026 **P.S.: Kanjhawala Delhi**
Mobile: 9821430473, 9015122520

SEARCH FOR MISSING

Seikh Sahil

General public is hereby informed that a Male namely **Seikh Sahil** S/o Seikh Hafuul R/o A-238, Gali No. 09, Afghani Chowk near Nazeer Masjid, Wazirabad, Delhi has been missing since 24.09.2026 at 07:30am from the area of his house. In this regard **FIR No. 451/2026 Dated 26.09.2026 U/s 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 has been Lodged at PS Wazirabad, Delhi.** Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace this Missing Male, but no clue has come to light, so far. The description of the Missing Male is as under:

Name: Seikh Sahil, **Gender:** Male, **Age:** 19 years, **Height:** 5'7" ft, **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Strong, **Face:** Round, **Wearing:** Blue Color Shirt & Blue Color Jeans and White Color Sports Shoes in Feet. If anyone has any information regarding this Missing Male, kindly inform SHO/ Wazirabad, Delhi.

E-mail : cic@cbi.gov.in
Ph.: 011-24368638, 24368641 SHO
Fax : 011-24368639 PS, Wazirabad, Delhi
DP/14208/N/2026 Ph. No. 8750870131, 9654964500

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found dead on 02.10.2026 Near Shishganj Gurudwara, Chandni Chowk, Delhi.** In this regard **DD No. 42A, Dated: 02.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Kotwali, Delhi.** The dead body has been preserved at Subzi Mandi Hospital Mortuary for 72 hrs. Physical Description of unidentified male dead body is as under:

Name: Unknown, Age: About 35-40 Years, Height: 5'5", Complexion: Wheatish, Face: Oval, Built: Thin, Wearing: Wornout Orange Colour Loincloth.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Kotwali, Delhi
DP/14431/N/2026 **Ph.: 8332089158, 8750870121**

SEARCH FOR MISSING GIRL

Sahiba Bano

General Public is hereby informed that one girl (depicted in the photo) namely Sahiba Bano **D/o** Shahid Mohd. **R/o** Khasra No. 751, Gali No. 6, A-Block Rajeev Nagar, Near Mohamadi Masjid. Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi **Aged**- 22 Years has been reported missing since 05.10.2026 at about 05:30 PM from her residence vide **FIR No.616/2026 Dated 06.10.2026 u/s 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita** registered at Police Station Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi. Her physical description is as under:-

Complexion: Wheatish, **Height:** 4'10", **Face:** Round, **Built:** Medium, **Clothing:** Blue Coloured Frock, White Coloured Pajami and Golden Coloured Slipper in feet.

If anyone gets any information or clue about the missing girl, please contact the below mentioned :-

E-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in
Website: http://cbi.nic.in
Fax: 24368639
Tel.: 24368638/24368641

SHO, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi
Tel.: 011-27811934, 27811933
7065036328
DP/14438/ON/2026

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified Male namely **Unknown S/o:** Unknown **R/o** Unknown, Whose Decomposed Dead Body was found on 08.10.2026, at Outer Ring Road Burari Flyover on the way to Kashmere Gate, Delhi. In this regard **DD No. 30A, Dated 08.10.2026,** has been lodged at **Police Station Wazirabad, North Distt., Delhi.** Identification of unidentified dead body of male is as under:

Sex: Male, **Age:** 45 Yrs, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Fair, **Wearing:** White Shirt & Blue Jeans. The dead body of deceased has been preserved for 72 hours in Subzi Mandi Mortuary, Delhi for identification.

If any one having any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be informed undersigned.

SHO,
Police Station Wazirabad, North Distt., Delhi
DP/14582/N/2026 **Ph.: 8758870131, 9999777520**

Appeal for Identification

General public is hereby informed that one male person **Namely:** Unknown, **S/o:** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age:** 20-25 Yrs. **Height:** 5'7", **Sex:** Male, **Complexion:** Fair, **Face:** Long **Built:** Thin **Wearing:** Cream Colour Shirt & Blue Colour Lower **Place of Recovery:** Footpath In front of Baraat Ghar Kachcha Bagh Chandni Chowk Delhi, The dead body has been preserved in Subzi Mandi, Hospital, Mortuary Delhi, for identification.

In this regard **DD No. 100A Dated: 09/10/2026** has been lodged at **Police Station: Kotwali, Delhi,** Any clue come to notice please inform undersign.

SHO
P.S.: Kotwali, Delhi
DP/14576/N/2026 **Phone: 8750870121, 9971558526**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that an unidentified dead body of a male Namely Unknown **S/o** Unknown, **R/o** Unknown **Age:** About 30 years, **Height:** Approx 5'7", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Injury:** Lacerated Wound present on Left Side of Parietal Bone and Left Side of Elbow, **ID:** Mole on Left Side of Forearm, **Wearing:** Blue Coloured Shorts and Blue Coloured T-Shirt was found dead on 25.09.2026 at about 4:07 PM from Shusurata Trauma Centre, LNJP Hospital, Civil Lines. In this regard a **FIR No.449/2026 Dated 25.09.2026** has been lodged at P.S. Wazirabad, Delhi.

If any one having any clue about deceased male may kindly inform the undersigned and contact on following numbers.

SHO
P.S. Wazirabad, Delhi
Ph.: 011-23810076, 23810073
DP/14597/N/2026 Mob.: 8750870131

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General Public is hereby informed that dead body of a male (depicted in the photo) Namely: **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found at H.No. 28/68, Kasturba Nagar, Delhi** on **08.10.2026** at **12.10 P.M.** In this regard vide **DD No.37A Dated 08.10.2026** has been registered at **P.S Vivek Vihar, Shahdara District, Delhi.**

The description of the deceased is given as below:

Name: Unknown, **Sex:** Male, **Age:** About 55 Years , **Height :** 5' 7", **Complexion:** Shallow.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to identify the man but no clue has come to light so far. Anyone having information about the person, please inform the undersigned.

SHO
P.S Vivek Vihar, Delhi
DP/ 14532/SHD/2026 **Ph. : 9311787921, 9582884074**

APPEAL FOR IDENTIFICATION

General public is hereby informed that a male namely **Unknown, S/o: Unknown, R/o: Unknown was found dead on 06.10.2026 From Platform No. 16, Old Delhi Railway Station.** In this regard **DD No. 38A, Dated: 06.10.2026** has been lodged at Police Station **Old Delhi Railway Station.** Physical Description of unidentified male dead body is as under:

Name: Unknown, Age: About 60 Years, Height: 5'7", Complexion: Wheatish, Wearing: Sky Blue Colour Shirt and Grey Colour Pant.

If anyone have any information or clue about this male deceased may kindly be inform undersigned.

SHO
Police Station Old Delhi Railway Station
DP/14526/RLY/2026 **Ph.: 011-23961522, 8750871302**

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

ARVIND

General public is hereby informed that one male namely **Arvind S/o Avdesh** R/o Vill. Bhagwanpur East, PO. Dhobkra, PS. Mohali Nagar, Distt. Sant Kabir Nadar, UP has been missing /kidnapped from Sukhr bazar road, C-80, Nagar ka makan, Delhi since 24.09.2026. In this regard, a case **FIR No. 488/2026 dt. 30.09.2026 U/s 140(3) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita has been registered at P.S. Jaitpur, New Delhi.**

The description of the missing male is as **Age:** 46 years, **Height:** 5'5", **Complexion:** Shallow, **Built:** Medium, **Face:** Round, **Wearing:** White colour Shirt and blue colour paint, **ID -** Who has mole under is right eye. Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace out his but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone has any information about the missing male then please inform **P.S. Jaitpur, New Delhi** at following Tel No./ e-mail: cic@cbi.gov.in and Website: http://cbi.nic.in, providing clue about the person.

Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641
Fax No.: 011-24368639 Sd/- S.H.O.
DP/14200/SE/2026 **Jaitpur, New Delhi**
Tel No.: 8750871645, 011-26666412

Appeal for Identification

General Public is hereby informed that a male dead body **Name:** Unknown, **S/o** Unknown, **R/o:** Unknown, **Age**: About 45-50 years, **Height:** 5'7", **Complexion:** Wheatish, **Face** : Round, **Built:** Medium, **ID Mark:** M.K.J Tattoo in Right Hand, **Wearing:** Blue Yellow Check Shirt & Cream Color pant with Black Belt. A Body with Head Injury in Train Accident was found Near Karkadi Mor Preet Vihar Pole No. 5/23 G to 5/21 G between Gaziabad to New Delhi Railway Line. He was taken by Private Ambulance Vide MLC No. 11784/26 to Hedgewar Hospital Emergency where Doctor declared him brought dead. In this regard, a **DD No. 01A, dated 12.10.2026 U/s 194 (1) (Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023)** has been lodged at PS Anand Vihar Railway Station, Delhi. The dead body has been preserved at GTB Hospital Morturay, Delhi for 72 Hrs identification.

Sincere efforts have been made by local police to trace out information about this person but no clue has come to light so far.

Any, person having any information or clue about this person may kindly inform to the following.

SHO
P.S., Anand Vihar Rly. Station, Delhi
DP/14572/RLY/2026 **Ph. : 011-22145601, 8750871314**

{ ANTI-CEC STIR } ALLEGATIONS OF DETENTION, FORCEFUL REMOVAL

Want a senior cop to explain: SC on assault of women journalists

Utkarsh Anand
utkarsh.anand@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday sought the personal presence of a senior Delhi Police officer on Thursday to explain allegations that women journalists covering the recent protests in the capital were assaulted and detained, stepping up its scrutiny of the police crackdown on demonstrators and mediapersons.

Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant made the observation after senior advocate Indira Jaising mentioned a petition filed by the Network of Women in Media, India (NWMI), seeking safeguards for journalists covering protests, particularly women journalists. The bench agreed to list the petition on Thursday along with the pending matters concerning alleged police excesses and restrictions imposed ahead of the protests.

"We would like some senior officer to remain present here and explain," said the CJI, making it clear that the police would have to respond to the allegations.

Raising informed the court that the copy of the petition and an advance notice had been given to solicitor general Tushar Mehta. The court's decision to seek the presence of a senior officer comes amid allegations that journalists were assaulted, manhandled and forcibly removed while reporting on protests against chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan also mentioned a contempt petition filed by Freedom Speech Collective, alleging that police personnel assaulted journalists in violation of the Supreme Court's October 10 order that mediapersons covering the protests must not be harassed. Senior advocate Chander Uday Singh mentioned a similar petition.

NWMI's petition seeks directions to ensure the safety and dignity of journalists covering protests and other public events. It argues that the existing inquiry into alleged police excesses does not specifically address journalists' access to protest sites, their detention or forcible removal, and the safeguards necessary for independent reporting and newsgathering. The plea demands directives to the Union government to ensure that women journalists engaged in bona fide reporting are not subjected to physical handling, intimidation, arbitrary detention or forcible removal merely because they are present at or near a protest, public assembly or crowd-control operation.

The court's intervention follows reports of journalists being detained during the protests over the weekend, despite identifying themselves as members of the press. On Sunday, Delhi Police detained at least 12 journalists covering demonstrations against Kumar, including Hindustan reporter Ashish Singh, who alleged that he was pushed and forced onto a bus despite wearing his press identity card.

The allegations have added a new dimension to the proceedings before the Supreme Court, which has already been examining claims of mass detentions, restrictions on public movement and curbs on metro and railway services ahead of the protests.

Police action under scrutiny

WHAT THE TOP COURT CONTENDED

Senior Delhi Police officer asked to appear before the court

Officer to explain allegations of assault and detention of women journalists

WHAT THE PETITION STATES

Alleged that existing inquiries do not adequately address journalists' access to protests, detention, forced removal

Sought directions to ensure women journalists engaged in reporting are not physically handled, intimidated, arbitrarily detained

At least 12 journalists were detained on Sunday, as per reports

Journalists were detained while covering protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls

Journalists hold march against police action

NEW DELHI: Mediapersons from across different platforms gathered at the Press Club of India (PCI) on Tuesday to condemn police action against journalists during the anti-CEC protests on October 10 and 11.

Few journalists alleged that despite carrying press IDs, they were stopped by police from carrying out their job. Rajdeep Sardesai, Paranjoy Guha Thakurta, Suhasini Haider and Sreenivasan Jain were among the participants.

Sangeeta Barooah Pisharoty, PCI president said, "The state cannot decide who is a journalist. They were asking for PIB cards meant for security clearance. This meeting intends to document what should not be done to journalists in a democracy."

Journalists also participated in a silent march around PCI. HTC

Cops file 4 FIRs over INDIA bloc's protest march to SC

Hemani Bhandari
hemani.bhandari@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have registered four First Information Reports (FIRs) in connection with the INDIA bloc's protest march against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar on Monday, on grounds of alleged violation of prohibitory orders in and around Connaught Place and the Supreme Court, a police officer aware of the development said.

Two FIRs have been registered at Tilak Marg police station, while Mandir Marg and Barakhamba Road police stations have registered one FIR each, the officer said on condition of anonymity.

The prohibitory orders were imposed under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS). Police have registered a case on charges of prohibiting an officer from performing his duties, violation of a prohibitory order under sections of Delhi Prevention of Defacement of Property Act, 2007.

The development came a day after thousands of protesters, including opposition parties, gathered in central Delhi, in one of the largest political mobilisations in the Capital in recent years. Monday's demonstration came following two days of police action against protesters.

On Monday, Congress MP Rahul Gandhi led the march from Constitution Club towards the Supreme Court, where he sought an independent, time-bound investigation into decisions allegedly taken unilaterally by Kumar and demanded that the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls be suspended pending the inquiry.

The march was initially scheduled to begin at 1.30pm but did not start until around 4pm. However, thousands of people, including activists and other supporters, began gathering at Barakhamba Road and Connaught Place intersection, raising slogans and carrying flags. Police personnel cordoned off the area, erected barricades and diverted traffic as the gathering grew.

Opposition leaders, including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee, Rashtriya Janata Dal leader Tejashwi Yadav and Communist Party of India (Marxist) general secretary MA Baby, met at the Constitution Club to finalise the petition before the march.

The petition, which named the Election Commission of India, Kumar and two other election commissioners as respondents, was flagged for 14 defects, including a shortfall of ₹220 in court fees, an illegible photocopy of Kharge's identity card and missing vakalatnamas for nine of the 11 petitioners. The legal team requested that the matter be listed on Thursday.

In a post on X, Gandhi thanked those who participated in the protest and supporters who backed the demonstration remotely at 3pm.

"Today was a very important day because we needed to show the government that the people of India are not going to be intimidated," he wrote.

CJP's Das, Ranka detained at Jantar Mantar

Hemani Bhandari
hemani.bhandari@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Fourteen Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) members, including co-convenors Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka, were detained on Tuesday after they scaled an iron gate of an office premises to enter the now-denotified Jantar Mantar protest site, which has been closed to entry since last week.

A senior police officer said that a case of trespassing had been registered at Parliament Street police station, without giving further details.

In videos taken by the group at the site and uploaded to social media, Ranka can be seen waving the national flag as the group raises slogans of "Bharat Mata Ki Jai", "Inquilab Zindabad" and "Ganesh Kumar Isteefa Do". Within seconds, police officers begin detaining them.

Das later shared a video from inside a bus, saying, "We have breached Jantar Mantar. We were at Jantar Mantar and now we are being detained."

The incident comes a day after the area was de-listed as the official protest site by Delhi Police. To be sure, the area has been cordoned off with police barricades since the last week of September, ahead of a planned CJP protest on October 10. Heavy security still remains deployed in the area and the entirety of central Delhi.

CJP members scaled a gate of an office premises to reach the now denotified Jantar Mantar site to protest on Tuesday. ANI

In a post on X later, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, who was not at the site, said, "Resistance cannot be de-notified."

All 14 CJP members were taken to Jafarpur Kalan police station, where they were still detained at the time of going to press.

CJP's legal head, Ratna Singh, said the station house officer (SHO) had refused to let their lawyer meet them, while their phones had been confiscated.

"Under what legal authority are they being detained, and why is their lawyer being denied access?" she said in a post on X.

The police did not respond to the allegations.

Meanwhile, the Congress-affiliated National Students' Union of India and another student organisation, Disha staged a protest in Connaught Place, and several members were detained.

SUPREME COURT DEFERS HEARING ON DELHI PROTEST TILL OCTOBER 15

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday adjourned to October 15 a clutch of petitions challenging alleged detentions, assault of protesters and sweeping restrictions on public transport ahead of a demonstration demanding chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, as one of the judges on the bench was unwell.

A bench, comprising Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, deferred the batch of around a dozen petitions after both sides agreed to an adjournment to enable Justice Mohana to recover.

The court also granted Delhi Police and other authorities time until Wednesday evening to file their responses to notices issued in contempt proceedings alleging disobedience of its earlier directions. HTC

{ DELHI POLICE } 'SPREADING MISINFORMATION'

500+ social media posts on protests taken down

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have registered four first information reports (FIRs) over social media posts allegedly spreading misinformation and inflammatory content related to the ongoing protests against chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the subsequent police crackdown. More than 500 such posts had been taken down by Tuesday evening, officials said.

A senior police officer said the FIRs were registered by the Delhi Police's Intelligence Fusion and Strategic Operations (IFSO) unit. "The FIRs have been registered against unknown persons under sections 336 (forgery), 353 (statements conducing to public mischief) and 356 (defamation) of the BNS, apart from relevant sections of the IT Act. A preliminary investigation indicated that several posts taken down so far originated from social media handles operating outside India, including in Pakistan, the officer said. "We are closely monitoring all social media platforms and taking down objectionable and AI-generated images, videos with the potential to incite public sentiment," the officer added.

Last week, police arrested a man from Haryana for allegedly creating and circulating AI-generated videos and images depicting police officers sexually harassing protesters. The fabricated content included AI-generated images of ACP Vivek Bhagat, who was named in a complaint filed by a woman alleging that he sexually harassed her during a protest, police said.

HIGH POWERED ENQUIRY COMMITTEE

(Constituted by the Hon'ble Supreme Court of India vide order dated 18.08.2026 in W.P. (Crl.) No. 280 of 2026 and connected matters)
ShikshaSadan, 17 Rouse Avenue, New Delhi

PUBLIC NOTICE

The Hon'ble Supreme Court of India, vide its order dated **18 August 2026** passed in Writ Petition (Crl.) No. 280 of 2026 and connected matters, constituted a five-member **High Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC)** to enquire into all aspects of the incidents relating to violence at JantarMantar, Delhi, and at places outside Delhi, during the month of July 2026, including the broader issues arising therefrom.

The HPEC shall examine all issues enumerated in paragraphs 12 and 13 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court's Order dated 18 August 2026, with priority being given to the issues mentioned in **paragraphs 12(i), 12(vi), 12(vii) and 13(iii)** thereof, as well as the issue mentioned in **paragraph 5(i)** of the order dated 10 September 2026 passed by the Hon'ble Court.

These issues include, inter alia, matters pertaining to the **use of pellet guns, targeted violence and harassment of female protestors, and excessive violence and destruction of property occasioned on either side.**

Copies of the orders dated **18 August 2026** and **10 September 2026**, containing the composition of the HPEC and the issues referred to the Committee, including the priority issues, are available on the HPEC portal at: **http://hpec.nic.in/supreme-court-orders**

The Hon'ble Supreme Court has granted liberty to the parties to the writ petitions to approach the HPEC and submit such relevant material, documentary evidence and suggestions as they may deem fit, in such manner as may be decided by the HPEC through its Chairperson.

The Hon'ble Court has also permitted **complaints, representations and other relevant material to be submitted anonymously,** so as to protect the identity of complainants and witnesses. Further, in its Order dated 10 September 2026, the Hon'ble Court has issued directions to the HPEC to extend due protection to vulnerable witnesses and to keep their identities confidential and undisclosed. The Hon'ble Court has also directed that **utmost confidentiality shall be maintained in respect of statements made and evidence submitted by such vulnerable witnesses before the HPEC.**

In compliance with the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court, and with a view to safeguarding the interests of vulnerable witnesses and facilitating the submission of material by affected persons and other concerned stakeholders, the HPEC has developed an online portal, which may be accessed at: **http://hpec.nic.in**.

For the convenience of concerned persons, witnesses and other stakeholders, the HPEC has also prescribed formats for submission of information and material.

Accordingly, **affected persons, witnesses and other concerned stakeholders may submit their complaints, representations, statements, documents and other relevant evidence** by accessing the HPEC portal and selecting the appropriate format, wherever applicable.

Apart from the above, any person wishing to provide information relating to the issues referred to the HPEC under the Orders dated 18 August 2026 and 10 September 2026 may also submit such information through the aforesaid portal. Thosewho wish to submit the complaints, representations and other relevant material physically, can do so at the Office of the HPEC at Shiksha Sadan, 17, Rouse Avenue Institutional Area, New Delhi 110002 between 1400 hrs. and 1600 Hrs. on all working days. Submissions can also be sent by post at the above address or by email at **hpec2026.enquiry@nic.in**

All such responses/submissions may be made without any delay.

Member Secretary
High Powered Enquiry Committee
New Delhi

CBC 19101/11/0016/2627

ADVERTISEMENT

The AMP South Delhi Story

A familiar address. A new chapter in the AMP story.

NEW CHAPTER. The new AMP Motors showroom in South Delhi, bringing Range Rover, Defender, Discovery and Jaguar under one roof.

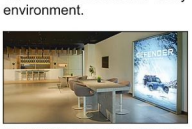
On October 12, 2026, AMP Motors opened a new chapter at an address that has been central to its JLR journey.

Since entering the JLR retail business in 2009, AMP Motors has grown into one of the country's leading JLR retail partners, building a strong presence across the North through a combination of customer relationships, retail excellence and long-term investment.

South Delhi has been an important part of that journey. Over the years, the address became familiar to generations of customers who returned not only to purchase their next Jaguar or Land Rover, but also to service, upgrade and continue their ownership journey. The new facility builds on that history while giving the relationship a new scale.

"The new facility builds on that history while giving the relationship a new scale."

Bringing Range Rover, Defender, Discovery and Jaguar together under one roof, the new South Delhi showroom offers customers a more comprehensive JLR experience, with each marque retaining its own identity within a cohesive modern luxury environment.



THE LOUNGE. A customer seating area within the new facility.

The South Delhi facility is also home to the biggest service bay in the country, extending the AMP Motors experience beyond the sale and into the ownership journey.

THE SERVICE BAY. The Biggest in the country.

But the new showroom is about more than a new address. It reflects AMP Motors' long-term strategy to deepen its stronghold across the North, strengthening its presence in established markets while creating a destination capable of engaging the next generation of luxury customers.

AMP MOTORS

Range Rover. Defender. Discovery. Jaguar.

Plot No. B1/H6, Mohan Cooperative Industrial Estate, Mathura Road, New Delhi +91 70421 23000

Pollution surveillance widened in Delhi with 13 new monitoring stns

Saloni Bhatia
saloni.bhatia@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Capital on Tuesday expanded its air quality monitoring network from 47 to 60 stations with the inauguration of 13 new continuous ambient air quality monitoring stations (CAAQMS).

The new monitoring stations have been installed at Ghummanhera, Chhawla, Karala, Hastsal, Jharoda Kalan, Burari, Narela, Maidan Garhi, Nangloi, Vasundhara Enclave and Badarpur, among others. They will continuously measure pollutants, including PM2.5 and PM10, alongside meteorological parameters. The data will be available through the Central Pollution Control Board's server and the SAMEER mobile application.

Union environment minister Bhupender Yadav and chief minister Rekha Gupta who reviewed measures to tackle air pollution at Anand Vihar, one of the Capital's major pollution hotspots, also visited the Delhi Pollution Control Committee's (DPCC) AI-enabled Integrated Command and Control Centre (ICCC) at Shastri Park for the virtual inauguration of the CAAQMS.

Yadav said the monitoring network was being expanded beyond population-based norms, with stations being installed across a five-kilometre-by-five-kilometre grid.

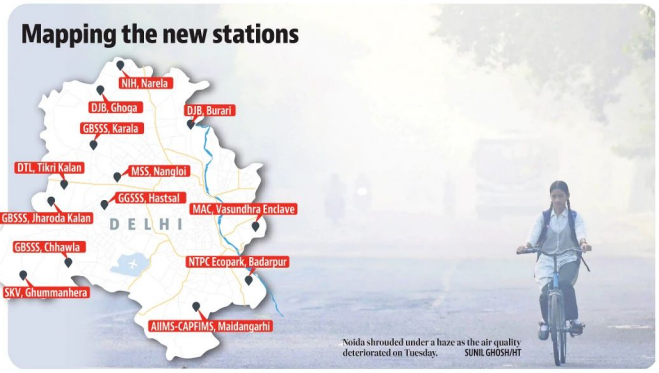
"The approach would help assess pollution levels in peri-urban and suburban areas, which are important for understanding the movement of pollutants into and out of Delhi," he said.

The ICCC is a centralised digital platform integrating data on air quality, dust-control measures, ambient noise, industrial emissions, stubble burning, citizen complaints and enforcement vehicles. Of the 15 external data systems planned for integration, nine have been connected, while the remaining six are being integrated in phases.

The centre employs artificial intelligence, advanced cameras, real-time data and GPS tracking to monitor pollution-control activities, including mechanical road sweeping, construction and incidents of open burning.

CM Gupta said pollution control remained a priority for her government, with efforts focused on monitoring, infrastructure and coordinated enforcement. She said modern technology and collaboration between the Centre and Delhi government would make pollution-control measures more effective.

Delhi environment minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said the ICCC was functioning as a "war room" against pollution, with more than 700 construction sites being monitored.



Noida shrouded under a haze as the air quality deteriorated on Tuesday. SUNIL GHOSH/HT

Union minister Bhupender Yadav flags off 150 new electric buses alongside Delhi CM Rekha Gupta on Tuesday. ANI

AIR WE BREATHE

Relief short-lived, AQI slips back to 'moderate'

HT Correspondent
htreporters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Delhi's air quality slipped back into the "moderate" category on Tuesday, a day after rainfall brought brief relief and pushed the air quality index (AQI) into the satisfactory range for the first time this month, according to Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) data.

The city's 24-hour average AQI stood at 158 on Tuesday, compared with 83 on Monday and 111 on Sunday. Monday's improvement followed early morning showers that also brought down temperatures.

CPCB defines an AQI between 0 and 50 as "good", 51 and 100 as "satisfactory", 101 and 200 as "moderate", 201 and 300 as "poor", 301 and 400 as "very poor", and 401 and 500 as "severe".

Meanwhile, Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 32.5°C on Tuesday, 0.7 degrees below normal, according to the India Meteorological Department (IMD).

The minimum temperature at Safdarjung, the city's base weather station, settled at 21.2°C, 1.6 degrees above normal.

IMD has forecast a generally cloudy sky over Delhi on Wednesday, with the maximum and minimum temperatures expected to settle at 34°C and 21°C, respectively. According to the Air Quality Early Warning System, Delhi's air quality is likely to remain in the "moderate" category on October 14 and 15 before improving to the "satisfactory" category on October 16.

Traffic across central Delhi hit by restrictions, checks

Karn Pratap Singh
karn.singh@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Vehicular traffic on Tuesday was affected in several parts of central Delhi in view of security arrangements for a possible fresh protest against the Election Commission and an event being organised at a luxury hotel in Chanakyapuri area.

In two separate advisories, the Delhi Traffic Police listed a series of restrictions and diversions in view of the event – Bloomberg New Economy Forum – at the Hotel Leela Palace that has led to closure of a few surrounding roads, including Sardar Patel Marg. "Traffic is expected to remain affected around that area on Tuesday, between 5pm and 10pm," the Delhi Traffic Police said on X.

It also listed dynamic diversions and restrictions that may be implemented on multiple roads in central Delhi, especially around Jantar Mantar, depending on the ground conditions related to a possible protest.

As both carriageways of the Sardar Patel Marg have been closed, traffic snarls were witnessed on the routes around Dhaula Kuan, especially the ones being used as the alternate routes. Traffic was also heavy on the carriageway of Golden Quadrilateral merging into the Ring Road from Dhaula Kuan side.

Similar traffic congestion was also visible on the Ring Road between RK Puram and AIIMS and between Durgabai Deshmukh South Campus and Sir M Vishweshwaraiah Metro stations on the same route. One carriageway of Africa Avenue Road going towards Satya Marg from the Ring Road was closed.

Vehicular traffic was also disturbed on the roads around the Jantar Mantar, which is still heavily barricaded in view of the protests the city has been witnessing since the start of this month. At least 22 stretches would be disrupted if the traffic police implement dynamic restrictions in central Delhi. One carriageway of the Ashok Road from Gol Dak Khana roundabout to Jantar Mantar roundabout also witnessed traffic snarls. Both carriageways of the Sansad Marg from CP Outer Circle to Ashok Road roundabout have been closed. Traffic police officers said they had deployed personnel to guide motorists.

Vehicular traffic was also disturbed on the roads around Jantar Mantar, which were heavily barricaded on Tuesday. ARVIND YADAV/HT

29-yr-old man dies after altercation at club in north Delhi; five arrested

Karn Pratap Singh
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NEW DELHI: A 29-year-old man died after he and his friends were allegedly assaulted at a nightclub near Ashok Park Metro station in north Delhi by the club's bouncers following an altercation, police said on Tuesday. Five people, including the club manager and his wife as well as three bouncers, have been arrested and booked for murder.

The incident took place in the early hours of Sunday. According to deputy commissioner of police (north) Niharika Bhatta, the brawl began over alcohol spilled on the wife of the club manager.

The victim, identified as Daljeet, a resident of Raghubir Nagar JJ Colony, returned home and went to sleep. "When he did not wake up during the day, his wife took him to hospital, where he died," she added.

An FIR has been registered sections 103 (murder), 109 (attempt to murder), 115 (voluntarily causing hurt), 127 (wrongful confinement), 351 (criminal intimidation) and 3 (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), said joint commissioner of police (central range) Madhur Verma, adding the entire incident has been captured on CCTV cameras.

Verma said the in-charge of Inderlok police post was sent to district lines for dereliction of duty, as the club was found to be operating until the early hours of the morning.

The victim, who worked as a private driver, is survived by his wife and eight-year-old son. His wife, Pooja, said he was the only breadwinner of the house "I want justice for me and my child."

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Date of Opening of tender : 30.10.2026	

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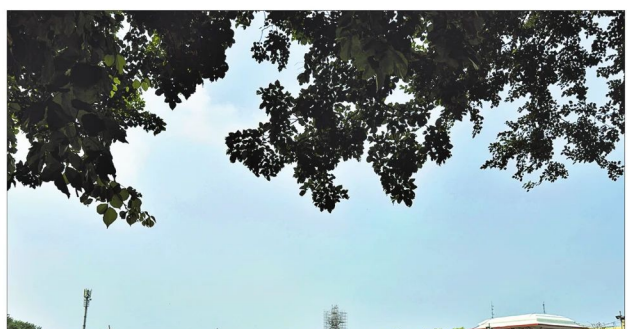

Jantar Mantar plus

On the city's protest sites

PUBLIC INTEREST

One evening, citizens dressed purposefully in black gather at Central Delhi's Jantar Mantar. They light candles to protest the Supreme Court decision to reverse a High Court judgment decriminalising same-sex relations. Indeed, here at Jantar Mantar, right next to the centuries-old solar observatory, queer Delhiwale have repeatedly found space among flags and hunger strikes, celebrating and protesting decisions that directly shape their lives.

That was 2013. Following the Delhi Police decision this week to denotify Jantar Mantar as a protest site and designate three spaces elsewhere, attention turns to the closest. It is Ramlila Maidan, a place this dispatch has visited before, and now obviously calls for an urgent return.

In the beginning, there was no Ramlila Maidan. There used to be Shahji ka Talaab and Shahji ka Baagh. After crushing the 1857 uprising, the British filled the lake, where the Kamla Market clock tower now stands, and destroyed the garden. Over time, the annual Ramlila, once held on the banks of the Jumna river, moved to the garden's site. And so Ramlila Maidan was born.

The ground with a capacity of 50,000 people lies between the Walled City and New Delhi. Its signature landmark is a white pavilion reached by a sweep of steps. No longer a stage for formal functions, the pavilion hosts men whiling away evenings over cigarettes and mobile phones. Prime Minister Nehru had commissioned it for Queen Elizabeth II's 1961 visit.

Other maidan memories come from elderly Old Delhi citizens whose fathers and grandfathers would hang out in the maidan, within walking distance from their congested galis and kuchas. In those long-ago days, Purani Dilli boys would play gilli-danda and cricket in the spacious ground, Persian traders would hawk handmade tools, and milkmen's buffaloes would graze at dusk.

The Persians no longer come. The buffaloes have moved elsewhere in the city with their milkmen (Okhla!). And the cricket players go to the jumna-paar grounds for their Sunday matches. But every year at this time, the maidan hosts both Ramlila and a mela at night. This Tuesday afternoon, a Ferris wheel rises behind red cloth enclosures, see photo.

On an earlier Ramlila night, actors at Ramlila Maidan waited backstage for their turn to face the audience. The man playing Raja Dashrath was sitting on a plastic chair, crown in place. In everyday life, he said he was a mobile company's area sales manager. While King Janak sitting beside him was a contractor, Marichh an operator in Kanpur Metro, and Narad Muni a hip-hop choreographer.

Some weeks ago, a barefoot man lay on the grass in a corner of the ground, his head resting on his palm. He said he had neither a home nor a job. The man's back was turned towards the Civic Centre's grey tower, which rises across the road, dwarfing every other structure nearby.

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Murugan resigns; 3rd Union minister to quit in 4 months

Smriti Kak Ramachandran
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NEW DELHI: Union minister of state (MoS) for information and broadcasting L Murugan on Tuesday announced his resignation from the Rajya Sabha and the Union council of ministers on Tuesday, saying he would return to Tamil Nadu to focus on politics in the southern state.

Murugan is the third minister after former MoS for railways and food processing Ravneet Singh Bittu and former MoS for minority affairs and fisheries, animal husbandry and dairying George Kurian to exit in less than four months, stoking speculation that a rejig in the council of ministers was imminent.

While there is speculation that the rejig may see several new faces, it is unclear whether minister of petroleum and natural gas Hardeep Puri and MoS for consumer affairs, food and public distribution, and minister of social justice and empowerment BL Verma — who did not get renominated to the Rajya Sabha earlier this month from Uttar Pradesh — will continue to serve as ministers.

When Narendra Modi took oath as prime minister for a third consecutive term on June 2024, the council of ministers had 71 members. Currently, there are 68 members. "It has been the greatest honour of my life to serve Bharat Mata and Tamil Nadu under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri @narendramodi Ji....Now, I wish to return to the grassroots, stand with our karyakartas and dedicate myself full-time to strengthening the BJP in Tamil Nadu ahead of the 2029 Lok Sabha elections," Murugan said on X.

Murugan – who also served as the junior minister of parliamentary affairs – was a former president of the BJP's Tamil Nadu unit and was elected to the Upper House from Madhya Pradesh in April 2024. This was his second term in the Upper House; he was first elected in 2021. His current term in the Rajya Sabha was to conclude in 2030.

L Murugan

In a five-page letter to PM Modi, Murugan said he was motivated by the his dedication to India, Tamil Nadu and the BJP and felt that he must now give more of himself to the work that first brought him into public life.

"With humility and a grateful heart, I therefore request you to relieve me of my responsibilities as minister of state and permit me to relinquish my membership of the Rajya Sabha, so that I may dedicate myself full-time to strengthening the party in Tamil Nadu. I want to go to every village and every street, meet our people, stand beside our karyakartas and help expand the party's presence in every part of the State. I want to carry your message of Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwaas to every person, and help every family see its place in the journey toward another term under your leadership..."

A Dalit leader from Arunthathiyar community, Murugan was credited with galvanising the BJP cadre in Tamil Nadu with his Vel Yatra, which was considered to have paved the way for the party carving out space as a key opposition party in Tamil Nadu. After he was moved to the Upper House, Murugan was replaced as state president by K Annamalai who was seen as a firebrand leader, but did not get along well with the party's ally, the AIADMK.

Murugan asserted that his decision was borne out of his desire to serve India and Tamil Nadu, but there was no clarity on why he chose to resign from the Rajya Sabha. State leaders, even office bearers, can be members of Parliament. "I come from a very poor family. My parents, who worked as daily wage labourers and cattle grazers, continue to lead a simple life in Konur village. They could never have imagined that their son would one day serve in the Union government," he wrote to the PM.

{ EX-AIADMK MLAS' DISQUALIFICATION PROCEEDING }

HC gives 2 months for speaker to act on pleas

Ayesha Arvind
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BENGALURU: The Madras high court on Tuesday directed Tamil Nadu assembly Speaker JCD Prabhakar to conclude within two months disqualification proceedings against six former All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) legislators, who quit the party and joined the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagham (TVK). It, however, upheld the speaker's decision to accept the resignations of the six MLAs.

A bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and justice G Arul Murugan held that the acceptance of the resignations was constitutionally valid and that the speaker did not need to conduct a "roving inquiry" into whether the resignations had been tendered voluntarily by the MLAs. It recorded that the speaker had conducted a limited inquiry to find out whether the resignations were genuine and voluntary.

The bench, however, made it clear that accepting the resignations did not bring the pending disqualification proceedings to an end automatically. Pointing out that acceptance of resignations and the disqualification proceedings that were pending against four out of the six MLAs were "distinct constitutional processes", the bench said the speaker was competent to accept the resignations notwithstanding the pending disqualification proceedings.

The present dispute arose after 25 AIADMK legislators allegedly defied the party whip and voted in favour of the TVK government's confidence motion on May 13 this year. A day later, the AIADMK sought their disqualification under the 10th Schedule of the Constitution, better known as the anti-defection law, for defying party whip.

DISQUIET IN AIADMK AFTER BYPOLL LOSS?

CHENNAI: A section of AIADMK leaders, including ex-ministers, held closed-door discussions at senior party leader SP Velumani's Chennai house for the fourth straight day on Tuesday, people aware of the matter said.

The meetings follow the AIADMK drubbing in the recent bypolls to Madurantakam and Dharapuram assembly segments, where the party came third.

Velumani had led a group of 25 MLAs in rebellion against AIADMK general secretary E Palaniswami after the party's poor show in assembly polls earlier this year. The meetings, the people cited above said, were efforts by the group led by Velumani to mount pressure on EPS to call a general council meeting. "He (EPS) should have taken steps to meet the leaders who are unhappy and should have sought their views but he did not take any steps in that connection," a leader said.

While the proceedings against some of the legislators took a separate course, six MLAs — S Jayakumar, Maragatham Kumaravel, P Sathyabama, Dr Esakki Subbaya, C Vijayabhaskar, and MR Vijayabhaskar — resigned from the assembly, quit the party and subsequently joined the TVK.

The speaker accepted their resignations between May 26 and June 29, prompting AIADMK whip Agri SS Krishnamurthy to move the high court. He challenged the acceptance of the resignations while disqualification proceedings remained pending, arguing that the resignations could circumvent the consequences of the anti-defection law.

The speaker defended his decision, maintaining that he had satisfied himself that the resignations were voluntary and genuine. The high court on Tuesday upheld the acceptance of the resignations but clarified that the pending disqualification proceedings must still be decided within two months.

The case brings to focus a recurring problem under the anti-defection law, especially the role of the speaker in deciding disqualification petitions against legislators accused of switching political allegiance or defying party whips.

In 1992, the Supreme Court, in the Kihoto Hollohan vs Zachillhu case had held that speakers while deciding disqualification petitions under the 10th Schedule act as tribunals and that their decisions are subject to judicial review.

In 2020, the apex court in the Keisham Meghachandra Singh v Manipur assembly speaker case held that disqualification petitions must ordinarily be decided within a reasonable period and that three months would generally be the outer limit, unless there existed exceptional circumstances.

In the present case, the high court said it had chosen to trust the constitutional institution entrusted with deciding questions of disqualification rather than allow political considerations to determine the outcome.

"The present batch of cases poses an unforeseeable dilemma before this court. The ongoing conflict between constitutional morality and political morality," the court said, adding it had consciously chosen to leave the question of disqualification to the speaker, trusting him to discharge his constitutional responsibilities under the Tenth Schedule.

Absence from draft roll doesn't mean name deleted: ECI

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PANAJI: A special intensive revision (SIR) is a fresh preparation of the electoral roll and the absence of a voter's name from the draft roll does not mean that it has been deleted, the Election Commission of India (ECI) told the Bombay High Court in Goa on Tuesday, distinguishing the exercise from a special summary revision (SSR) where the roll is only updated.

A bench of justices Valmiki Menezes and Amit Jamsandekar, which was hearing a petition filed by Goa resident Paresh Salgaonkar, claiming his name was taken off the electoral roll for having changed his address prior to the enumeration phase of the SIR exercise.

Senior advocate Ashutosh Kumbhakoni, representing ECI, told the Goa bench that unlike the routine SSR that merely updates an existing active roll, "Rule 25(2) of the RER, 1960 [Registration of Electors Rules, 1960] categorically mandates that where a roll is revised intensively, i.e. the process of SIR, it must be prepared afresh from the ground up."

"A core feature of the SIR is that the Electoral Roll is prepared afresh. Under the SIR, the existing roll is not carried forward automatically. The existing roll serves only as a reference base," said the ECI lawyer, arguing that as the roll is being prepared afresh, a name missing from the draft roll does not technically mean it has been "deleted".

A name enters the draft roll only if the elector's enumeration form is submitted, he said. "The draft, therefore, contains only those who have been enumerated. In SSR, only new or changed cases need to act, whereas in SIR, every elector must respond," Kumbhakoni said.

The poll panel's lawyer underlined that a voter who is not included in the draft roll "must file Form 6 to be included in the final ER, along with the prescribed declaration and supporting documents, during the claims and objections period."

THE POLL PANEL'S LAWYER TOLD THE BOMBAY HIGH COURT THAT A VOTER WHO IS NOT INCLUDED IN THE DRAFT ROLL MUST FILE FORM 6 TO BE INCLUDED IN THE FINAL VOTER ROLL

"A final roll is then published once these claims and objections have been decided. In effect, such a person is treated as a new applicant, a new voter, for the roll in issue. The fact that the name was on the earlier roll does not by itself secure a place in the new one," he argued.

In his writ petition, Salgaonkar, a resident of St Cruz constituency in North Goa district, claimed that his name along with six other members of his family were omitted from the draft roll even though they had submitted Form 8 (for change of address).

Advocate Vivek Rodrigues, representing the petitioner, however, said the process that was followed for the SIR was a departure from the process laid down under the law, a position that ECI's own officers had subscribed to.

"We have tried to point out that Form 8 cannot be just left out of the loop. My client's Form 8 was rejected on the last date of deciding the objections. So, my client had no chance to file an [appeal] against rejection of Form 8," Rodrigues submitted.

The bench questioned whether the procedure as adopted by the poll panel was in consonance with the Representation of the People Act and the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960 and its provisions for revision exercises.

Salgaonkar has refused to fill form 6, saying that doing so would amount to filing a false declaration as he is neither a first-time voter nor shifted to another constituency.

After the arguments concluded, the high court reserved its verdict in the plea.

DEPUTY ECs TAKE STOCK OF 5 STATES HEADING TO POLLS

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: As the Election Commission readies to hold high-stakes assembly polls in five states, its senior officers led by deputy election commissioners have started taking stock of preparations there with a poll authority team currently on a visit to Uttarakhand. Commission officers will visit Manipur and Punjab in the coming days, senior functionaries said.

While a field visit to Goa was also on the agenda, the tour dates are being reworked now. There is no word yet on the officers' visit to Uttar Pradesh which elects 403 MLAs. Usually, the "full Commission", comprising chief election commissioner and fellow commissioners, visits poll-bound states in the end ahead of announcement of election schedule.

While the term of the Uttar Pradesh Assembly ends on May 22 next year, the terms of the 60-member Manipur, 40-member Goa, 117-member Punjab and 70-member Uttarakhand assemblies end on different dates in March, 2027. The Provisions of The Representation of the People Act, 1950 allow the EC to hold polls "earlier than six months before the term expires". As part of poll preparation, Uttar Pradesh and Goa have initiated 'first-level checks' (FLC) on electronic voting machines and paper trail units to be used in polling.

Expelled SP MLA says he along with 2 others will join UP BJP today

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

LUCKNOW: Expelled Samajwadi Party (SP) MLA Rakesh Pratap Singh on Tuesday said he along with two other party legislators will join the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Wednesday at a programme in Amethi, which will be attended by the presence of state BJP chief Pankaj Chaudhary and national general secretary Smriti Irani.

Talking to reporters in Amethi, Gauriganj MLA Singh said he will join the BJP along with Gosainganj (Ayodhya) MLA Abhay Singh and Kalpi (Jalaun) MLA Vinod Chaturvedi.

The proposed joining of the three MLAs — all from the key OBC communities in Awadh and Bundelkhand —will strengthen the BJP ahead of the 2027 assembly polls, as the party seeks to consolidate votes from all sections.

A three-term MLA, Singh won Gauriganj in 2022 defeating the BJP candidate by 6,963 votes. His differences with the Samajwadi Party widened after he crossed party lines and voted for the BJP candidate in Rajya Sabha elections in 2024.

The Akhilesh Yadav-led party expelled him in June 2025, after which he remained unattached member of legislative assembly.

RAKESH PRATAP SINGH, ABHAY SINGH AND VINOD CHATURVEDI ARE SET JOIN THE BJP ON WEDNESDAY

"It became difficult to continue in party where questions were raised over existence of Lord Ram and incidents of burning and tearing of Ramcharitmanas took place. Caste and family interests were given priority over nation and society," Singh claimed.

He alleged that caste and family interests were given priority over issues concerning the nation and society within the principal opposition party in Uttar Pradesh.

The Gosainganj MLA was first elected in 2012 and again in 2022, whereas Chaturvedi is a second-term MLA.

BJP district president Sudhanshu Shukla said besides Smriti Irani and Pankaj Chaudhary, state ministers Dara Singh Chauhan and Pratibha Shukla will also join the event.

Uttar Pradesh will go to assembly polls early next year.

'Protesters detained for past violations, patronising Khalid'

PANAJI: The Goa Police has told the Bombay HC in Goa that they had detained protesters affiliated to the CJP on Sunday in view of their history of "violating conditions laid down by the authorities" and for "patronising Umar Khalid." In his response filed before the court on Monday, police inspector of Panaji Vijaykumar Chodankar said the protesters were detained because they did not have any permission to hold any protests from the competent authority.

SC takes note of Brittas' letter on 'police assault'

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has taken note of a letter written by Rajya Sabha lawmaker John Brittas to Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, alleging "brutal police assault" near Connaught Place, in a raft of petitions in the handling of protests in New Delhi, the Communist Party of India (Marxist) leader said.

The Supreme Court has not made public what directions, if any, it will issue on the application, and it is not clear when the matter will be listed.

HC STAYS INQUIRY AGAINST K'TAKA BJP LEADER IN VOTER DELETION CASE

Ayesha Arvind
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BENGALURU: The Karnataka High Court on Tuesday stayed further investigation into an FIR against BJP leader Ravi Basalingappagowda Patil over allegations that he attempted to fraudulently delete the names of 198 Muslim voters from electoral rolls by submitting bulk Form 7 objections during the SIR process in the state.

Justice Venkatesh Naik T of the Dharwad bench of the Karnataka High Court passed the order, relying on a similar case in which a coordinate bench had stayed an investigation on the ground that electoral authorities had not yet adjudicated the objections seeking deletion of voters' names.

The court said the "factual circumstances in the two cases were similar." "In view of maintaining judicial discipline, it is just and proper to stay the investigation till the next date of hearing. The respondent-State is permitted to file an application for modification of the order if necessary," the court said.

The court will hear the matter next on October 29.

Senior advocate Aruna Shyam, who appeared for Patil, argued that rival political parties had engineered the FIR and that the police could not conduct a parallel investigation into the matter.

'Cong must examine its record of favouring ex-ECs'

HT Correspondent
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NEW DELHI: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Tuesday countered the Opposition's allegations of electoral irregularities against the Election Commission of India (ECI), saying the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government had given the poll panel complete autonomy to function independently.

Addressing the media, Union minister Piyush Goyal said ECI officials had not been "offered political benefits, but allowed to work honestly" and retorted that the Congress should examine its own record of accommodating former election commissioners.

"One CEC was given a party ticket, one was inducted into the Union Cabinet, two CECs were appointed as Governors, and when a CEC said that an Election Commissioner working under him was acting like a Congress agent, there was a refusal to remove him. Such favouritism has rarely been seen under any government," Goyal said.

He described Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, as the "biggest red flag" for the Congress.

He also posed 10 questions to Gandhi on the Supreme Court-monitored Special Summary Revision (SIR), the electoral process and allegations of vote theft.

"I challenge Rahul Gandhi to answer these 10 questions. Several people consider Rahul Gandhi the biggest red flag because of whom the Congress is losing again and again... Many Congress leaders are voicing their opinions against Rahul Gandhi. (MP) Shashi Tharoor himself said that the Congress won the election in Kerala because of SIR. Ramesh Chennithala said that the Congress won the election in Kerala because of SIR," Goyal said.

While the Congress has accused the ECI of irregularities that led to over 9 million people being left out of the electoral rolls in West Bengal, Goyal said the party's leader and former MP Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury had also praised the ECI for conducting elections well in the state.

Goyal also said the Congress questioned the ECI's impartiality while engaging in intimidation and disregarding its own actions and past record.

"...How was the first Election Commissioner selected? The government chose. Whoever they wanted, they made the Chief. The Congress often praised the integrity of Chief Election Commissioner TN Seshan. But in 1999, he was given the opportunity to contest against Advani ji on a Congress ticket. Was this not an attempt to reward him? MS Gill was Chief Election Commissioner from 1996 to 2001. In 2000, the sitting Chief Election Commissioner was awarded the Padma Vibhushan. Was this not a reward for his flattery and actions?" Goyal said.

SC stays Rahul's defamation trial over 'chowkidar' remark

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NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Tuesday stayed criminal defamation proceedings against Leader of the Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi in connection with his alleged "*Chowkidar Chor Hai*" (watchman is a thief) remark against Prime Minister Narendra Modi in 2018.

The order was passed by a bench of justices Vikram Nath and Aparesh Kumar Singh on a petition filed by Gandhi challenging a Bombay High Court order from September 8 refusing to quash the proceedings.

Appearing for the Congress leader, senior advocate Abhishek Manu Singhvi informed the court that the petitioner seeks a stay of the proceedings because they are not maintainable.

The bench issued notice to the Maharashtra government and the complainant Mahesh Srishrimal, who claims to be a member of the BJP, and posted the matter after four weeks.

Rahul Gandhi

"In the meantime, further proceedings before the trial court shall remain stayed," the court order said.

Gandhi had approached the high court against the summons issued by a Girgaon court in Mumbai on August 28, 2019, based on a complaint filed by Shrishrimal for initiating criminal defamation proceedings (Section 500 of the Indian Penal Code) against him.

The complainant objected to Gandhi's 2018 speech made at a public rally in Rajasthan where he said, "*Gali gali mein shor hai, Hindustan ka chowkidar chor hai.* (There is a clamour in every street, India's watchman is a thief)." It was also stated that these remarks were aired across news channels, social media platforms and newspapers.

Subsequently, the complainant alleged that Gandhi commented on a video and published a post the same year saying, "The sad truth about India's Commander-in-Thief."

Srishrimal stated in his complaint that the aforesaid defamatory statement labelled not just the PM Modi as a "Commander-in-Thief," but directly accused "all BJP members and Indian citizens associated with him of theft".

HC seeks Centre's reply on SOPs for protests

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NEW DELHI: The Delhi high court on Tuesday sought the Centre's response in a petition seeking implementation of Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) to regulate protests and prevent disruptions to traffic and businesses amid demonstrations demanding the resignation of chief election commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar.

A bench of acting chief justice Nitin Sambre and justice Sanjay Sharma asked Centre's lawyer additional solicitor general Chetan Sharma to seek instructions and listed the petition filed by advocate Rishabh Saxena, a traders body and Santosh Kushwaha, a street vendor for Friday.

"In the meantime, we direct the respondents to take instructions in the matter," the court said in the order.

Senior advocate Sacchin Puri and Sanjay Poddar, appearing for the petitioners, submitted that the protests were disrupting business activities and urged the court to direct that demonstrations be held at designated sites to ensure that professionals and businesses are not affected.

The petition stated that the Supreme Court, in Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan v. Union of India, had directed the Commissioner of Police to formulate a regulatory mechanism for protests. Following the directions, binding conditions were laid down for demonstrations, including a prohibition on blocking traffic, office gates and arterial roads. Saxena's petition further said that on October 12, while travelling to the Competent Authority's office on Barakhamba Road he encountered a gathering of people occupying the carriageway and the central traffic island near the Mandi House roundabout.

Cong MP refutes charges, BJP steps up suspension demand

Pragati Chawla and Smriti Kak Ramachandran
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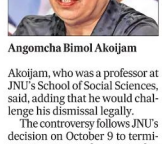
NEW DELHI: Congress Lok Sabha MP and expelled Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) faculty member Angomcha Bimol Akoijam on Tuesday refuted the allegations of sexual harassment levelled against him, terming the entire process a "witch hunt" driven by political vendetta to silence his voice on Manipur and the Northeast, even as a group of women MPs from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) met President Droupadi Murmu and sought his suspension from Parliament.

"They expect people from Manipur and the Northeast in general to remain silent, docile and submissive...That is why they are trying to silence me, but they will not succeed...I am telling you, this has been a 'witch hunt' from the very beginning,"



Angomcha Bimol Akoijam

Akoijam, who was a professor at JNU's School of Social Sciences, said, adding that he would challenge his dismissal legally.

The controversy follows JNU's decision on October 9 to terminate the services of Akoijam, after at least 11 students lodged complaints against him in May, accusing him of sexual misconduct.

Meanwhile, the Delhi Police on Monday registered a first information report (FIR) against him in connection with the allegations on a complaint by university's chief security officer.

Akoijam, who represents Inner Manipur parliamentary constituency, argued that the allegations against him concern academic issues rather than sexual harassment and that the inquiry into the allegations disregarded established rules and procedures.

"The matter concerns academic issues and pedagogy. How does that become a sexual harassment case? It simply does not stand. They knew that, which is why they manipulated the entire process," Akoijam said.

After meeting Murmu on Tuesday, BJP Mahila Morcha chief Roop Kumari Choudhary said the President had assured the delegation that she would have the matter investigated. "The President has assured us that she will have the matter investigated and ensure appropriate action is taken," she said.

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Last-minute paper generation can kill incentive to leak, says Nilekani

Sanjay Maurya
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NEW DELHI: Generating examination papers at the last minute from a "massive question bank" will eliminate the "economic incentive" behind paper leaks, Infosys chairman and head of the high-powered task force (HPTF) on examination reforms Nandan Nilekani said on Tuesday. He also suggested expanding the computer-based testing (CBT) infrastructure across the country.

"The moment you have a question paper then that creates an economic incentive for that to be sold. So the way to do that is to really have a massive bank of questions and only at the last minute generate the question paper for that day and therefore then the question of having a question paper goes away and there is no economic incentive for that," he said while addressing the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi.

To be sure, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), in its first charge sheet filed in a Delhi court in May in the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case, said question papers for the May 3 examination were sold and purchased by the accused for amounts ranging from ₹25,000 to ₹25 lakh.

Nilekani added that expanding the network of testing locations was another priority. "We have 150,000 locations (of CBT centres) where a young boy or girl can take a test that needs to be expanded. So I think these are all systemic issues, which we will address in our committee," he said.

When asked if he could envision a future where AI spontaneously creates examination papers on the actual day of the test, Nilekani responded with affirmation. He further said that using technology and looking at the root causes of exam leaks and irregularities systematically could solve the problem. "They are solvable issues."

The government-appointed six-member HPTF, constituted on July 27 with a three-month mandate, was set up after the

Nandan Nilekani

cancellation of NEET-UG 2026 on May 12 by National Testing Agency (NTA). At least 120 questions in a guess paper — a compilation of suggested questions based on previous trends and patterns — were found to match the May 3 examination paper, triggering widespread protests and eventually the resignation of then education minister Dharmendra Pradhan on July 25.

An October 5 affidavit filed by the Department of Personnel and Training in the Supreme Court said the panel had held about 18 meetings and more than 40 consultations including one with Union health ministry on whose behalf NTA conducts the test for admission to UG medical courses, and remained "on track" to submit its report within the prescribed timeframe.

The debate over shifting NEET-UG from pen-and-paper testing (PPT) to CBT has, however, exposed significant infrastructure and policy hurdles.

More than 2.2 million candidates registered for the 2026 examination currently held in pen and paper mode, requiring question papers to be printed, packed, transported under security, stored in vaults and distributed to examination centres. The lengthy supply chain, involving printers, transporters, storage facilities, centre coordinators and invigilators, creates multiple potential vulnerabilities for paper leak.

In CBT, encrypted questions are electronically distributed to examination infrastructure under strict access controls, reducing dependence on physical transportation. The format is already used for JEE-Main, CUET and UGC-NET.

INFOSYS CHAIRMAN CALLS JOB FEARS 'HOGWASH' AS AI SPURS BUSINESS

NEW DELHI: Infosys chairman Nandan Nilekani shrugged off worries about AI eliminating jobs and said the technology will instead galvanize small businesses and fuel demand for new skills.

While tasks such as coding can increasingly be handled by artificial intelligence, other roles will emerge to manage the technology's deployment and its risks, Nilekani, 71, said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi on Tuesday. The idea that AI will displace human workers is "hogwash," he said.

Nilekani is more optimistic about AI's impact on employment than others, with International Monetary Fund Director Kristalina Georgieva warning that AI is a "slow-moving tsunami" for the labor market. Nilekani, one of Infosys' seven co-founders, sees new jobs emerging for ensuring that AI is safe and reliable.
BLOOMBERG

Fake heirs exploit freedom fighter quota for MBBS seats

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DEHRADUN/MUSSOORIE: In 1942, Dharamveer Verma spent a month in jail in Dehradun for participating in Mahatma Gandhi's Quit India Movement.

In September this year, 84 years later, Verma was in the news again with at least six persons showing themselves as his descendants to claim admission in Uttarakhand medical colleges under the "Freedom Fighter" quota.

In between, in 2014, at the age of 84, Verma passed on leaving behind a family that is now shocked by the venality on display in the current controversy.

"We were shocked when local revenue officials came to our home and asked whether we took benefit of the quota," said his son, Manoj Kumar Verma, 58, speaking at his residence in Dehradun's Arhat Bazaar.

Dharamveer was just 12 at the time of his arrest, as per his freedom fighter certificate. "No one from our family has ever used the quota to seek government benefits," said Manoj Verma, one of Dharamveer children.

After perusing the documents of the candidates, Manoj Verma told officials that the six certificates were fake as Dharamveer Verma's father's name was mentioned as Khajan Das instead of Manohar Lal. It was his subsequent complaint triggered an investigation, leading to the detection of nine more fake certificates just in Dehradun, and the arrest of five persons.

The racket is larger, claimed activist Pradeep Bahuguna, son of noted environmentalist Sunderlal Bahuguna, putting the number of candidates who benefited from such certificates at 370.

Uttarakhand's rules provide for reservation of 85% of 1,525 MBBS and BDS seats in the government medical colleges and 50% of seats in private institutions to state residents. "I examined first round of the current counselling session and found 24 candidates had claimed seats under the freedom fighter quota," Bahuguna said.

He also discovered that in several cases the freedom fighter and domicile certificate (essential document to get admission under state quota) were issued a few days before the counselling.

He found that five female candidates and a male one claimed to be the descendant of one freedom fighter with the same non-existent residential address.

"A local resident told me that Dharamveer worked as a driver in Survey of India and was not aware whether he was a freedom fighter or not," Bahuguna said. He found two Dharamveer Vermas in official records, neither fitting the profile used in the forged admission applications. He then lodged a complaint with the state's medical education minister and the District Magistrate.

On September 18, the Uttarakhand government formed a seven-member Special Investigation Team led by Superintendent of Police (Dehradun Rural) Jaya Baloni.

So far, the SIT has lodged three FIRs and arrested five persons from three states including Rupesh Pandit, a resident of Purnia district in Bihar who runs an education consultancy in Meerut and Dheeraj Kumar Srivastava, a resident of Bhopal who runs a medical admission consultancy. The two are suspected to be the brains behind the operation.

Also arrested were Sanjay Kumar of Varanasi, Girish Singh of Pithoragarh, and Arvind Kumar, a resident of Haridwar whose daughter was among the beneficiarie. A senior police officer aware of the investigation said Rupesh Pandit allegedly guaranteed MBBS admissions under the freedom fighter quota for a fee of ₹45 lakh per candidate with ₹20 lakh taken as advance payment.

"Pandit had been collaborating for over two years with Dheeraj Kumar Srivastava in Bhopal to manufacture high-quality forged documents, including fabricated state domiciles, government dependency certificates, and fraudulent identity documents," the official said on condition of anonymity.

Baloni said almost every phone being seized has been formatted and nearly all financial transactions were conducted entirely in cash. "We are focusing on locating the key intermediaries who were in direct contact with local revenue officials to facilitate these forged certificates," she said.

A senior revenue official said that Dehradun revenue official (Patwari) Jagdish Rathore admitted during questioning that documents were processed without rigorous physical verification because of excessive work load. Sub-Divisional Magistrate Apurva Singh said two revenue Revenue Sub-Inspectors have been suspended for negligence.

A similar racket was busted in Udham Singh Nagar district leading to registration of at least six separate FIRs, booking over 20 individuals and arresting five suspects. Two local revenue officials were placed under suspension for negligence during certificate verification, said Udham Singh Nagar Superintendent of Police (Crime) Anusha Badola.

In response to reports compiled District Magistrates across various jurisdictions, Haridwar Nanadan Bahuguna Uttarakhand Medical Education University has cancelled at least 20 provisional seat allotments.

Director of Medical Education Dr Ashutosh Sayana said state counselling is conducted via an automated online portal where candidates upload self-attested documents, which are verified against state databases. "If doubts arise during physical reporting, documents are sent for verification to the issuing authority," he added. Medical education minister Subodh Uniyal wasn't available for comment.

RTI activist and advocate Vikesh Singh Negi alleged that an unchecked network of touts, fraudulent applicants, and compliant revenue officials has operated for over two decades across the state. "I have filed a PIL in the High Court highlighting the violations," he said. A PIL seeking a CBI investigation is listed for hearing on Tuesday.

In all this, Verma felt that his father's legacy as a freedom fighter built on sacrifice, courage and love for the country has been hurt.

"These seats were meant for deserving students. What hurts most is that this not only robs deserving students of their opportunities but also dishonours the very freedom fighters whose struggles gave us this country," he said.

B'LURU TECHIE FOUND DEAD AT HYD APARTMENT

HYDERABAD: A 29-year-old software employee allegedly died by suicide late on Monday at an apartment complex in Hyderabad's Nanakramguda, police said on Tuesday.

The deceased worked in an IT firm in Bengaluru and was in the city to stay with a friend who lives at the complex, said police.

Police recovered a purported suicide note which contained apologies to his parents but did not specify the cause for the decision, said an officer

A case was registered and further investigation was underway, said police, adding that the focus was on identifying the cause of the incident. PTI

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IIIT-Ranchi suicide case: Govt forms probe panel

Sanjay Maurya
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Union education ministry has constituted a three-member committee to examine the circumstances surrounding the death by suicide of a first-year student at the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT), Ranchi, according to an official statement.

Meanwhile, people familiar with the matter said the students continued their protest for the third consecutive day on Tuesday, accusing the institute administration of negligence and alleging delays in providing emergency medical assistance to the student, who died on October 10.

The committee, chaired by Prof Rajni Abbi, director of the University of Delhi's South Campus, has been given 15 days to submit its report. The panel also includes Dr Jitendra Nagpal, a senior psychiatrist at Delhi's Moolchand Hospital, and Heera Lal Poonia, deputy secretary in the ministry's department of higher education. A police probe into the incident is also underway.

"The Ministry of Education has taken cognizance of the unfortunate incident... In furtherance of this objective, the Competent Authority has approved the constitution of a Committee comprising the following members," the order issued on Monday said.

"The incident necessitates a closer examination of the implementation of these measures at the institutional level and identify any deficiencies requiring corrective action," it added.

7th Pocso case lodged against Veeramani

CHENNAI: The Special Investigation Team probing the sexual assault cases against prominent granite trader R Veeramani has lodged a seventh Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (Pocso) Act, 2012 case against the businessman, police said on Tuesday. The case was registered based on a complaint by a victim who was a minor when she was assaulted, police said.

Yechury Foundation inaugural event on November 22

NEW DELHI: The CPI(M) will hold an inaugural event marking the formation of the Sitaram Yechury Foundation (SYF) in Kolkata on November 22 which will commemorate the late MP by presentation of papers on "Imperialism in the Present Age", a release said, adding: "The abstract (of the paper) should be emailed to syfessays@gmail.com by October 26."

U'khand bans sale, manufacture of gutkha for one year

DEHRADUN: Uttarakhand government on Tuesday prohibited the sale, storage, and manufacture of gutkha, pan masala and other food products containing tobacco and nicotine for one year. The state Food Safety and Drug Administration, issued the order under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006 and the Food Safety and Standards (Prohibition and Restriction on Sales) Regulations, 2011.

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महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, हरियाणा की अपील

ऐसा न करें...

किसी भी नवजात शिशु अथवा बच्चे को सड़क, सुनसान स्थान, पेड़, कूड़ेदान, अस्पताल के बाहर या किसी अन्य असुरक्षित स्थान पर न छोड़ें।आपका एक गलत कदम एक मासूम की जिंदगी को खतरे में डाल सकता है।

ऐसा करें...

यदि किसी कारणवश आप बच्चे की देखभाल करने में असमर्थ हैं या बच्चे को अपने पास रखना संभव नहीं है, तो बच्चे को असुरक्षित छोड़ने के बजाय सुरक्षित रूप से सौंपें।

सुरक्षित पालना केंद्र (Cradle Points)

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, हरियाणा द्वारा प्रदेशभर में 141 स्थानों पर Cradle Points (सुरक्षित पालना केंद्र) स्थापित किए गए हैं, जिनमें निम्न शामिल हैं:

CHILD CARE INSTITUTIONS (बाल देखभाल संस्थान) | PRIMARY HEALTH CENTRES (PHCS) (प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केंद्र) | CIVIL HOSPITALS (सिविल अस्पताल) | अन्य निर्धारित संस्थान

आप बच्चे को इनमें से किसी भी निकटतम सुरक्षित पालना केंद्र पर छोड़ सकते हैं।

सशक्त महिला - सुरक्षित बचपन -समग्र हरियाणा

Cradle Point उपलब्ध न हो तो?

बच्चे को प्रत्येक जिले में गठित Child Welfare Committee (CWC) के समक्ष भी सुरक्षित रूप से समर्पित किया जा सकता है।

आपकी पहचान गोपनीय रखी जाएगी।

बच्चे को सुरक्षित रूप से सौंपने के लिए आगे आने वाले व्यक्ति की पहचान को गोपनीय रखा जाएगा, ताकि वह बिना भय या संकोच के बच्चे की सुरक्षा सुनिश्चित कर सके।

बच्चे को छोड़ें नहीं, सुरक्षित सौंपें! हर बच्चे को एक सुरक्षित कल मिल सके

आपका एक सुरक्षित कदम — एक मासूम की जिंदगी बचा सकता है!
आइए, मिलकर सुनिश्चित करें कि कोई भी नवजात या बच्चा लावारिस और असुरक्षित स्थिति में न मिले।

महिला एवं बाल विकास विभाग, हरियाणा
बेज नंबर 15-20, सेक्टर 4, पंचकूला, हरियाणा-1341124.. फ्रोन: 0172 256 0349.
वेबसाइट: wcdhry.gov.in टेलफाइन: 181 | 1098

MANIPUR UNIVERSITY
CANCHIPUR : IMPHAL-795003, MANIPUR
TENDER NOTICE
Dated 12th October, 2026
No.MU/LIB/09(EPB)/2026: Manipur University invites sealed tender for Empanelment of Vendors for supply of Books. Details are available at the University website : www.manipuruniv.ac.in
Purchase Officer, Manipur University

संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण
टी.टी. नगर स्टेडियम, भोपाल (म.प्र.)
ई-निविदा सूचना
संचालनालय खेल और युवा कल्याण, मध्यप्रदेश, द्वारा "आइस मशीन, हाइड्रोकोलेटर एवं AED के वार्षिक रख-रखाव (AMC) हेतु" ई-निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र व निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें www.mptenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है। ई-निविदा प्रकाशन उपरांत निविदा में कोई संशोधन व परिवर्तन किया जाता है तो वह मात्र उपरोक्त उल्लेखित ई-टेण्डर पोर्टल पर ही उपलब्ध रहेगा।
म.प्र. माध्यम/128541/2026 संचालक

NOIDA
New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Main Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar, (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in
E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per scheduled mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & http://etender.up.nic.in. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.
(A)
1. 33/GM(E/M)/SM(E/M)-I/E.T./2026-27, Hire Charges of Hyva and JBC for Work Circle-01 to 05, Noida. Cost Rs. 109.91 Lacs.
Which can be uploaded by date: 27.10.2026 at 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: 28.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.
General Manager (E&M)
Noida
CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD
(SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION)
VARIOUS WORKS FOR CONSTRUCTION OF NEW RAILWAY LINE BETWEEN VAYOR-LAKHPAT
TENDER No. DyCE-C-BHUJ-NL-EPC-01
Dy. Chief Engineer (C) Bhuj for & on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for the following work: (1) Name of work: Construction of New Railway Line between Vayor-Lakhpat (including all yards falling in the section) covering all works of Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS all P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, P. Way Fittings (excluding Rails, steel girder), other Civil engineering works, Signal, Telecom and Electrical (General Services and TRD) complete Works in Ahmedabad Division of Western Railway in the Gujarat State on EPC basis. (2) Approx. cost of work: ₹ 984,30,42,826.82 (3) Bid security: ₹ 19,68,60,900.00, Type of Tender: Two Packet System, Completion period: 2 Years (6 Months)/913 Days (including monsoon period), (4) Closing time & Date: 09-02-2027 at 11:00 AM Hrs.. Date & Time for opening of E-Tender: Any time after 11:00 AM Hrs. on 10-02-2027 (5) Website particular and Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office: Complete details of tender including eligibility criteria are available on Western Railway website www.ireps.gov.in Office of Deputy Chief Engineer (C)Bhuj, Nirman Bhavan, 1st Floor, Opp. GCS Hospital, Naroda Road, Near DRM Office, Ahmedabad: 382345 in case of any clarification the firm may contact at the above office during the working hours in person or at office Mobile No.9724093262.
CPM-086
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उत्तराखण्ड लोक सेवा आयोग
हरिद्वार
पिन कोड-249404
संख्या :: 203/04/E-2/DR/CIVIL JUDGE/2024-25 दिनांक :: 13 अक्टूबर, 2026
विज्ञप्ति
उत्तराखण्ड न्यायिक सेवा सिविल न्यायाधीश (कनिष्ठ श्रेणी) परीक्षा–2023
एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि उत्तराखण्ड न्यायिक सेवा सिविल न्यायाधीश (कनिष्ठ श्रेणी) परीक्षा–2023 के अन्तर्गत दिनांक 21.04.2026 से 24.04.2026 तक सम्पन्न मुख्य परीक्षा का परिणाम दिनांक 03.07.2026 को जारी किया गया, जिसमें सफल घोषित कुल 32 अभ्यर्थियों से ऑनलाइन आवेदन पत्र में किए गए दावों के सापेक्ष प्रमाण–पत्रों/अभिलेखों की स्वसत्याप्रति छायाप्रति मंगायी गयी थी। अभ्यर्थियों द्वारा प्रेषित प्रमाण–पत्रों/अभिलेखों की सम्निरीक्षा के आधार पर साक्षात्कार परीक्षा का आयोजन दिनांक 02 नवम्बर से 04 नवम्बर, 2026 तक किया जाना है।
अभ्यर्थियों हेतु अनुक्रमांकवार साक्षात्कार कार्यक्रम, साक्षात्कार ज्ञाप एवं साक्षात्कार संबंधी अन्य प्रपत्र आयोग की वेबसाइट psc.uk.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।
अभ्यर्थी उक्त का अवलोकन करते हुए मूल अभिलेखों सहित साक्षात्कार तिथि को आयोग कार्यालय में उपस्थित होना सुनिश्चित करें। यह भी सूचित किया जाता है कि अभ्यर्थियों को साक्षात्कार ज्ञाप डाक के माध्यम से पृथक से प्रेषित नहीं किये जायेंगे।
(अशोक कुमार पाण्डेय) सचिव।

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
For and on behalf of the President of India, The Deputy Chief Mechanical Engineer, Northern Railway Mechanical Workshop Amritsar invites Open E- tender, single packet on official website www.ireps.gov.in. Name of Work: Work of Preservation, Treatment, Digitalization, Renovation & Development of Heritage Gallery and Centre of Excellence for welding in Northern Railway Mechanical Workshop Amritsar. Approx. cost: Rs. 48,09,007.40/-(Rupees Forty Eight Lacs Nine Thousand Seven, Paisa Forty Only.) Tender Form Cost: Rs. 0/- Earnest Money: Rs. 96,200.00/- Period of Contract: 06 months. Last Date & Time for submission of Tender: 04/11/2026 till 15:00 hrs. Opening of Tender: Tender opening will be done immediately after the tender closing time. The tenderers (s) are not required to be present during the opening. Railway reserves the right the open the tender any time after closing of tender. Documents may be downloaded from the official website. Detail tender Notice & Tender Document: Please check the official website of Railway i.e.www.ireps.gov.in. For further details kindly follow the notice placed on the Tender Notice Board at N. Rly. Mech. Workshop, Amritsar.
No. 6-S-O-HERITAGE-ASRW-26-27 Dated: 13/10/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3558/26

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
For and on behalf of the President of India, the Deputy Chief Mechanical Engineer, Northern Railway, Charbagh Workshop, Lucknow invites following e-tender from reputed firms for works as given below:-

Tender No. :	W-CB-D07-FireExtin-2026
Name of Work :	Inspection, Maintenance, Refilling, and Hydro Pressure Testing of Fire Extinguishers at Rolling Stock Workshop Charbagh Lucknow for a Period of Two Years.
Estimated Cost of Work :	Rs. 20,94,401.36
Earnest Money :	Rs. 41,900/- only
Cost of Tender Form :	Rs. 0/- only
Period of Contract :	24 Months
Date & Time for Submission of Tender :	from 19.10.2026 to 02.11.2026 upto 15:00 Hrs.
Date & Time for Opening of Tender :	after 15:15 Hrs. on 02.11.2026

• The tender form may be submitted on the website www.ireps.gov.in from 19.10.2026 to 02.11.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs.) • Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, any such mannual offer received shall be ignored. • Contractors are allowed to make payment against this tender towards tender document cost and earnest money/Bid security only cash through e-payment gateway or as mentioned in tender doucments. • The tender will be opened on specified date and time as above. In case the above date is a holiday the tender opening would be conducted at the same times on the next working day. • No post tender correspondence for submission of additional documents shall be entertained after opening the technical & commercial offers. Even suo-moto post tender letters shall be treated as NULL & Void.
No.: W-CB-D07-FireExtin-2026 Date: 10.10.2026 3564/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	HSAMB KURUKSHETRA	CONSTRUCTION OF NEW LINK ROAD FROM PEHOWA KURUKSHETRA ROAD TO CAMBRIDGE WORLD SCHOOL KURUKSHETRA IN MC PEHOWA (ROAD ID : 12936) +1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 23.10.2026	1,80,68,939/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01744231420 xenkir2022@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaseprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/40/50137/119/7

India rebuts China over Ladakh, location names

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: India on Tuesday rejected China's contention that it has "never recognised" the Union Territory of Ladakh as well as its opposition to New Delhi's naming of features in the region, and emphasised that the Chinese side's actions cannot change the established fact that Ladakh is "an integral and inalienable part" of the country.

The strong response from external affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal came hours after his Chinese counterpart Mao Ning described the Indian government's recent move of announcing standard names for 28 locations in Ladakh as "illegal and invalid" and contended that Beijing does not recognise the Union Territory of Ladakh.

The exchange reflected continuing tensions between India and China over a disputed border as the two sides work to normalise ties, which fell to an all-time low due to a military standoff on the Line of Actual Control (LAC) that began in 2020 and lasted more than four years. As part of this process of normalisation, the two sides have held talks aimed at resolving their long-standing boundary dispute.

INDIA'S RESPONSE CAME HOURS AFTER CHINA DESCRIBED INDIA'S MOVE OF ANNOUNCING STANDARD NAMES FOR 28 LOCATIONS IN LADAKH AS "ILLEGAL AND INVALID"

"It is reiterated that the UT of Ladakh is an integral and inalienable part of India. No amount of denial by the Chinese side can change this established fact," Jaiswal said while responding to Mao's comments on Ladakh.

Jaiswal said the Union home ministry's October 2 announcement on standard names for 28 places and features in Ladakh was self-explanatory as these locations had been "identified with standard place and feature names on the official map of Survey of India". This, he said, was done in consultation with the Union Territory of Ladakh and local stakeholders.

"Identifying these places formally on the Survey of India map of UT of Ladakh is aimed at facilitating their accurate recognition and better awareness among the public at large," Jaiswal said.

The Union home ministry's announcement regarding the standard names for the 28 features and places in Ladakh was seen as part of a new policy of responding to similar moves by China over the past few years to assert its claim on territories along the LAC held by India. The first such list of standard names for 27 locations in Arunachal Pradesh was issued in August.

When Chinese foreign ministry spokesperson Mao was asked about the development at a regular media briefing in Beijing, she replied: "China has never recognised the so-called 'Union Territory of Ladakh' unilaterally and illegally established by India, and firmly opposes India's publication of so-called 'standard place names'.

"India's move is illegal and invalid, and cannot change the objective fact that the western section of the China-India border has always belonged to China," she said.

The Indian government had split the state of Jammu and Kashmir into the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh when it scrapped the region's special status in August 2019.

The Union home ministry's announcement on standard names for locations in Ladakh included 10 peaks, two passes, three mountains, seven "land areas", two glaciers, two water bodies, a valley and a river.

In recent years, China has repeatedly announced "standardised names" for dozens of places in Arunachal Pradesh as part of its claims on Indian territory. China refers to Arunachal Pradesh as "south Tibet" and there have been instances of Chinese authorities issuing stapled visas to residents of Arunachal Pradesh.

China has sought to rename dozens of locations in Arunachal Pradesh, including towns, rivers and geographic features, but India has argued that such actions will not change the reality.

RSS OFFSHOOT URGES CENTRE TO BLOCK STARLINK

Smriti Kak Ramachandran
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) offshoot Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM) on Tuesday urged the Centre to deny tech billionaire Elon Musk's Starlink permission to roll out commercial satellite broadband services in India, citing national security concerns.

SJM national co-convenor Ashwani Mahajan, in a statement, claimed that India is "grappling with various law-and-order challenges" and "internet-based social media often fuels rumours and anti-national narratives". "Disrupting internet services frequently becomes essential to maintain law and order during instances of separatism, terrorism, riots, protests, and similar events."

He also echoed concerns that Indian internet traffic could be more difficult to legally monitor if it bypassed domestic gateways and travelled through foreign infrastructure and condemned Musk's earlier statements on the issue. "Elon Musk has chosen to make allegations on Indian businesses and the government indirectly...it seems Elon Musk is either attempting to secure the license by creating public pressure or is making these statements out of frustration," Mahajan said.

Pjb anti-drug activist shot dead, AAP faces Oppn fire

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: Anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh alias Jhota was shot dead in broad daylight in a busy market in Punjab's Mansa district on Tuesday, police said, adding that they have launched a manhunt for Ashwani Kumar, a medical store owner who allegedly opened fire on Jhota and his companions after they questioned him for allegedly selling addictive drugs to an elderly man.

The accused allegedly used his licensed weapon, police said. Four of Jhota's companions were also injured. "He was killed by drug traffickers. We demand that the Government of India dismiss the Punjab government. Drugs are openly sold here. My son Parvinder Singh Jhota was killed by drug traffickers," the activist's father told reporters.

Tensions escalated in Mansa after the murder, with Jhota's supporters vandalising the medical shop and his family refusing to cremate his body. A heavy police force was deployed out-

Parvinder Singh

side the Civil Hospital, where the body was kept.

The accused and Jhota had a history of conflict.

In 2023, Jhota and his supporters had garlanded Kumar with shoes and paraded him through the market after a man was found with banned capsules allegedly procured from his shop.

A video of the incident that surfaced online showed Jhota confronting Kumar over the alleged sale of drugs and asking him to put down his pistol. The shopkeeper then allegedly opened fire.

Another video showed Kumar pursuing Jhota with a weapon and firing again. Jhota sustained three bullet injuries — two in his abdomen and one in his thigh. He was declared brought dead at the hospital.

Deputy inspector general Harjit Singh said police received information about the incident around 10.30 am. An associate who allegedly helped Kumar escape has been arrested. Preliminary investigation suggested the murder stemmed from personal enmity linked to the 2023 incident, he said.

The killing drew condemnation across party lines.

AAP leader Baltej Pannu promised strict action. "No one is permitted to take the law into their own hands. Strict action will be taken against the guilty," he said.

BJP national president Nitin Nabin said the murder exposed "the alarming state of law and order" in Punjab.

Congress MP Amrinder Singh Raja Warring called the killing a consequence of the government's "failed law and order".

"His broad daylight murder exposes serious failures of the AAP government," Warring said.

WOMAN TRIED TO BREACH MAMATA'S CORDON, SAYS TMC

KOLKATA: The Mamata All India Trinamool Congress claimed that an intoxicated woman with a knife allegedly tried to breach former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee's security cordon near her Kalighat residence while claiming to be her niece.

Party MP Dola Sen, in a complaint to the Kalighat police, alleged that the incident took place at around 6pm. Sen claimed that the woman tried to sneak into the security cordon and when she failed, she lied down on the road and hurled abuses. "It was then that we saw that she had a knife," she said. No senior police officers responded to HT's requests for comment till the time of going to print. HTC

{ LEGISLATION MOVED IN THE ASSEMBLY }

Keralam Bill to mandate care for elderly

Vishnu Varma
letters@hindustantimes.com

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: The Keralam government on Tuesday introduced a bill for the protection of senior citizens from abuse and exploitation and ensure better access to healthcare and social security, proposing imprisonment up to three years and fine up to ₹50,000 for physical or mental cruelty, mandatory registration of care centres, training and certification of home caregivers and special cells in police stations to tackle cybercrime complaints as some of its provisions.

The Keralam Senior Citizens (Care and Protection) Bill, 2026, introduced by chief minister VD Satheesan in the state assembly, seeks to protect the rights and dignity of senior citizens, ensuring capacity-building of senior citizen care centres and simpler access for the elderly population to government and police services.

THE BILL FIXES PENALTIES FOR MENTAL, PHYSICAL ABUSE OR CRUELTY TOWARDS SENIOR CITIZENS

"As a state, we cannot overlook the demographic changes taking place here. The share of young persons is decreasing due to various factors. At the same time, the longevity of our population is rising. It is estimated that by 2036, the number of senior citizens in Keralam will be double the national average," said Satheesan in the assembly, while moving the legislation.

According to the bill, the state will ensure that senior citizens have access to income-generating activities, access to food security programmes and healthcare facilities and have appropriate right to make a "living will" regarding the future ownership of their assets.

The bill fixes penalties for offences against senior citizens. A family member, legal heir or staff of a care centre causing physical or mental abuse or cruelty towards senior citizens can be imprisoned up to three years and fined ₹50,000. Those abandoning senior citizens without their consent can also be jailed up to three years and fined ₹50,000.

The bill states that the government will set up state-level and district-level senior citizen care protection units who will monitor schemes and policies for elderly persons. To tackle rising cases of elderly persons falling victim to cybercrime, the bill provides for setting up a senior citizen cyber cell in all cyber police stations in the state.

The Bill, after a brief debate in the assembly on Tuesday, was referred to the finance subject committee for further scrutiny.

Andhra IAS among four booked for assault on B'luru cop: Police

Arun Dev
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: An IAS officer of the Andhra Pradesh cadre and three others have been booked for allegedly assaulting a police inspector and obstructing police personnel during a late-night inspection at a Bengaluru bar and restaurant, according to an FIR registered on October 10.

The alleged incident took place between 1 am and 1.30 am on October 10 at Cavore on Residency Road, within the limits of the Cubbon Park police station. The case names Vikas Marmat, Special Officer of the Kuppam Area Development Authority, and Abhay Uday Singh, Nitish and Roshan.

According to the complaint filed by Arun Salunke, a police

ACCORDING TO THE COMPLAINT, THE INCIDENT TOOK PLACE WHEN A POLICE TEAM WAS CHECKING BARS AND RESTAURANTS

inspector with the Special Enquiry Wing of the Central Crime Branch (CCB), he and his team were checking bars and restaurants within the Cubbon Park and Ashok Nagar police station limits on the directions of the Bengaluru city police commissioner.

"When the team reached Cavore at around 1.30 am and began checking customers' identity cards to verify their age, the four men allegedly picked a quarrel with the police personnel. They abused and assaulted the inspector and his colleagues, threatened them and obstructed them from discharging their duties," said an officer briefed on the investigation.

Salunke received medical treatment following the alleged assault before approaching the Cubbon Park police to lodge a complaint, an officer aware of the matter said.

The case has been registered under Sections 115(2) (voluntarily causing hurt), 351(2) (criminal intimidation), 352 (intentional insult with intent to provoke a breach of peace), 132 (assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharging duty) and 3(5) (common intention) of the BNS , 2023.

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY
Auction/Corrigendum Notice No. 17/2026-27
Amendment in published e-Auction dates of October-2026.
Following correction/amendment is carried out in published e-auction dates of October-2026, **Published e-Auction dates :** 27 October-2026, **Amended e-Auction dates :** 28 October-2026, **Jurisdiction of lots :** Dy. CMM/GSD/IZN, Other e-Auction dates and terms and conditions, as published vide Auction Notice No. 14/2025 - 26, will remain unchanged. This notice is also available on N. E. Railway website on **www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in**
CPROS - 71 Principal Chief Materials Manager
"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

NORTH WESTERN RAILWAY
NOTICE OF INVITING E-TENDER
DRM (S&T)/ North Western Railway /Jaipur, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite E-Tenders from registered tenderer/bidders for the following work **E-Tender Notice No. SNT-JP-28-2026-27 Date: 08.10.2026** 1.Name of work with its location : Signalling work in Connection with Provision of TWS-290 sets in Passenger running loop lines in Rewari-Madar Section of Jaipur Division. **2. Approx. Cost of work (Rs.)** : Rs. 5,87,06,220.71/- **3. Bid Security (Rs.)** : Rs.11,74,100/- **4. Date & Time for submission up to on www.ireps. gov.in** : 02.11.2026 Up to 15.00 hrs. **5. Website Particulars & Notice board location** : www.ireps.gov.in and DRM office/NWR/ Jaipur.
1454-DE/26
Please join us on NWRailways NWRailways

ENGINEERING WORKS
Tender Notice No. CON/2026/AUG/02; Dated: 08-10-2026. Open tender through e-tendering system is invited from experienced and reputed contractor (s)/firm(s) for the following works. **Tender No.** CE/CON/NK/MB/2026/03. **Name of work:** Left over works of supply, fabrication and launching of Girders (2x24.40 CG + 1x106.70m OWG) of Br. No. 756, launching of PSC slab (6x6.10m) and protection work of Br. No. 750, drain between UP an DN Main Line, Km 1170/0-1730 and other ancillary works, in Azara - Kamakhya section in c/with New Bongaigaon-Goalpara Town-Kamakhya DL project. **Approximate Value:** ₹31,87,27,450.70/-; E-tender will be closed at **14:30 hrs.** on **05-11-2026** and opened at **15:30 hrs.** on **05-11-2026.** For details of Tender and any corrigendum, please visit **www.ireps.gov.in.**
Chief Engineer/Con/Kamakhya Project/Maligaon
Northeast Frontier Railway
(Construction Organisation)
"Serving Customers with a smile"

HINDUSTAN TIMES CONSUMER CONNECT INITIATIVE
The Festive Edge
LEADERS' LENS
As part of HT Media's Festive Edge initiative, Leaders' Lens brings together industry perspectives on the consumer shifts, market trends and brand priorities shaping the festive season.
POOJA BAID,
Chief Marketing Officer, Versuni India
What is the one shift in how Indians are shopping this festive season that feels meaningfully different from last year?
The biggest shift is that festive shopping is becoming more intentional. Consumers are researching earlier, comparing more and seeking the right basket, not necessarily the biggest one. Value now goes beyond price, encompassing performance, experience, aesthetics and convenience. For brands, festive success means offering more than discounts: a clear, compelling reason to choose them.
Where are consumers willing to trade up this festive season and where is value still winning over aspiration?
Consumers will trade up when a premium delivers tangible value. Better performance, convenience, innovation, design and lifestyle fit can justify paying more. Indian consumers have become more discerning, evaluating the entire experience rather than just utility or durability. The winning proposition is where aspiration meets value.
Where does a festive purchase really get decided today - at the showroom, a phone screen, or in a conversation at home?
The consumer journey is no longer linear. A product may be discovered through a creator, researched online, experienced in-store and validated with family before purchase. Each touchpoint plays a different role. That's why brands cannot be simply digital-first or retail-first. They need to be consumer-first, ensuring every interaction works together seamlessly.
In a festive season crowded with offers, screens, scrolls and messages, where can a brand still earn attention and belief and what makes that environment credible?
The challenge today is not gaining attention, but earning belief. With consumers exposed to endless advertising, brands need more than festive noise. Distinctive ideas must be backed by credible product truths. Ultimately, relevance comes from understanding consumer needs and offering a reason to believe.

POPULATION RESEARCH CENTRE (PRC) UNDER MOHFW, GOVT. OF INDIA
CENTRE FOR RESEARCH IN RURAL & INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT
Sector 19-A, Madhya Marg, Chandigarh-160 019
RECRUITMENT
Population Research Centre (PRC) at CRRID, Chandigarh invites applications for the post of Assistant Professor (01) and Associate Professor (01). Further details may be seen at: **www.crrid.res.in**

Advertisement No. 110/2026
Government of India
Public Enterprises Selection Board
invites applications for the post of
Chairman & Managing Director
in
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited (GRSE)
Last date of submission of online application by applicants is by 15:00 hours on **02nd November, 2026**
Last date of forwarding of applications by the Nodal Officers on online system of PESB is by 17:00 hours on **11th November, 2026**
For details login to website **https://pesb.gov.in**
Link for registration of Nodal Officers / Competent authorities is available on PESB website.

Hindustan Times
Navratri holds a special place in my heart: Lauren Gottlieb
HT City
CHECK OUT TODAY'S EDITION

UPTRON POWERTRONICS LIMITED
Ground Floor, Near Gomti Barrage, Gomti Nagar, Lucknow-226010
(A U.P. Government Undertaking)
e-TENDER NOTICE
Opportunity for Empanelment as Service Provider/Startup with Uptron Powertronics Limited
Online e-bids are invited from registered and experienced Companies/Firms of proven capabilities in the following areas/fields separately for their empanelment:-
(i) **as Service Provider** or Software Development, IT Enabled Services, Hiring Web/Cloud Server Services on rental basis etc.
(Bid Ref.: UPL/Empl/2026-27/SP, Tender ID: 2026_UPPOW_1177931_1)
(ii) **as Startup** for Solution Design, Development of Application Software/Website, Web Based Application, Data Processing, IT/ITES Services and Scanning & Digitization work
(Bid Ref.: UPL/Empl/2026-27/SU, Tender ID: 2026_UPPOW_1177975_1)
The last date for submission of e-bids is **30-10-2026** upto **3:00 p.m.** The bids shall be opened next working day at **3:00 p.m.** The complete bid document can be downloaded from the e-procurement website **https://etender.up.nic.in.** The Uptron Powertronics Limited reserves the right to cancel any or all the e-bids/annul the bidding process without assigning any reason.
MANAGING DIRECTOR

भारतीय विमानपत्तन आर्थिक विनियामक प्राधिकरण
Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India (AERA)
भारत सरकार / Government of India
3rd Floor, Udaan Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi - 110003
Ph.: 011-24695044
PUBLIC NOTICE
STAKEHOLDERS' CONSULTATION MEETING ON DETERMINATION OF TARIFF FOR THE AERONAUTICAL SERVICES FOR ALLURI SITARAMA RAJU INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT, BHOGAPURAM (VTZ) FOR THE FIRST CONTROL PERIOD (01.04.2026 - 31.03.2031)
Airports Economic Regulatory Authority of India (AERA) has issued Consultation Paper No. 06/2026-27 on 01.10.2026 (which is available on AERA website at URL **www.aera.gov.in**) w.r.t the Tariff Determination for the Aeronautical Services for Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport, Bhogapuram (VTZ) for the First Control Period (01.04.2026 - 31.03.2031).
In accordance with the provision of Section 13(4) of the AERA Act, 2008, the various tariff proposals of the Authority contained in the Consultation Paper, are put forth for Stakeholders' Consultation. A Stakeholders Consultation Meeting in hybrid mode (Physical/Online) in this regard is scheduled on **16th October, 2026 (Friday) at 3.30 PM** at:
Stakeholders Room, 3rd Floor, Udaan Bhawan, Safdarjung Airport, New Delhi-110003
All stakeholders like Passengers/Passengers' Associations, General Public, Airport Operators, Airlines, Industry Associations/Bodies, Independent Service providers for Cargo, Ground Handing Fuel Farm etc., are requested to join the said meeting and give their valuable suggestions/comments/views on the aforesaid Consultation Paper on tariff proposal of Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport, Bhogapuram (VTZ).
Participants joining in person may send their confirmation to AERA before the above-mentioned date of meeting with Name, email address, mobile number, vehicle number by email (to **director-ps@aera.gov.in** and **rajan.gupta1@aera.gov.in**). Online link will be shared on AERA website (**https://aera.gov.in**) before the Stakeholders meeting under Tab **"News and Announcements"**.
Sd/-
CBC 03112/11/0016/2627
Secretary, AERA

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	HSAMB YAMUNANAGAR	ESTABLISHMENT OF CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE (COE) FOR BERRIES AT RAJKIYA BAGH AND NURSERY, CHHACHHRAULI, DISTRICT YAMUNA NAGAR + 4 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 30.10.2026	16,06,99,735/-	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9270010001 xenynr.hsamb2023@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in
RO NO 13/2027/40/50138/1/19/7

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hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

Shah bats for joint attack on drug, terror networks

Prawesh Lama
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: BIMSTEC countries on Tuesday approved a series of measures to step up coordinated attacks on cross-border criminal and terrorist networks, terror financing and narcotics smuggling, as well as steps to improve emergency response mechanisms to deal with natural disasters in the region.

Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) is a regional grouping comprising Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand. It aims to promote economic and technical cooperation among countries bordering the Bay of Bengal and in its neighbourhood.

On Tuesday, Union home minister Amit Shah chaired the first BIMSTEC Ministerial Meeting of Home Ministers in New Delhi. "We are committed to full implementation of the BIMSTEC Convention on cooperation in combating challenges such as international terrorism, transnational organised crime, and illicit drug trafficking," Shah said in his address before the meeting commenced.

Union home minister Amit Shah with his counterparts from BIMSTEC member countries at the meeting on Tuesday. HT PHOTO

Emphasising that India has the policy of "zero tolerance" against terrorism, Shah said: "Our shared resolve must be to ensure that no part of the region provides any scope for terrorist networks to seek shelter, recruit members, undergo training, raise funds, or carry out activities against neighbouring countries."

On disaster management, the Union minister said that during the 6th BIMSTEC Summit held in Bangkok last year, Prime Minister Narendra Modi had proposed setting up a BIMSTEC Disaster Management Centre in India. "The centre is planned to be established in Jamnagar, Gujarat, underscoring India's role as a first responder in disaster management across the region," he added.

A statement from the Centre said the meeting's highlights included approval of an action plan proposing joint efforts by member countries in regional risk planning, joint exercises, early warning systems, disaster mapping, training centres, information sharing, research, technological innovation, and tsunami risk reduction.

Shah also sought to highlight the need for international coordination to deal with drug smugglers generating illicit funds for organised crime and terrorist activity. "The security of one member country strengthens the security of the entire region, guided by this principle, India remains committed to a peaceful, secure, and prosperous Bay of Bengal region," he said.

Referring to the so-called Golden Triangle—the drug smuggling route encompassing Myanmar, Laos and Thailand— Shah said there was "nothing golden about the trafficking of narcotics."

"This cannot be tackled by the efforts of a single country alone. We must adopt a whole of region approach," he said.

Sharing of intelligence and legal resources was key to ensure delivery of justice for criminals and terrorists, said Shah.

He said PM Modi had described BIMSTEC as a model for inclusive development and security during the 2025 summit in Bangkok urged all home ministers present to translate cooperation into practical mechanisms to strengthen citizen safety.

MAN KILLS TWO SISTERS TO 'CURE' HIMSELF, HELD

Debashish Sarkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAMSHEDPUR: A 45-year-old man has been arrested for allegedly hacking his two sisters to death with an axe as part of a ritual he believed would cure him in East Singhbhum district of Jharkhand, police said on Tuesday.

According to police, the incident took place in Babaida village under the Dhalbhumgarh police station (PS) area where the accused killed his two sisters, aged 55 and 50, locked his house and walked 15 km to the police station and surrendered.

One of the victims' husband said the accused had called both his sisters to his house on Sunday on the pretext of a sorcery and a special puja to "cure" himself.

The accused's third sister said: "He had called me too for the puja but I didn't go. Thank God, I have been saved. Both our sisters had come to take his care and help him get cured." She did not divulge details of his illness.

Police station in-charge Dhiraj Kumar Mishra said: "The 45-year-old man has been arrested and he admitted to killing his two sisters allegedly due to superstitions. Many medicines have been found from his house and was under the treatment of a village sorcerer for various illnesses. The axe has been recovered from the crime scene."

11 minors killed, several still missing in Bihar boat capsize

Avinash Kumar
avinash.kumar@htlive.com

PATNA: At least 11 people, all of them minors, died and several went missing on Tuesday after a boat capsized in the Raghopur Diara area of Vaishali district in Bihar, police said, adding that rescue agencies, led by state and national disaster relief forces, have launched a search operation.

Initial reports suggested the capsize was caused by an imbalance, however, the actual reason will be ascertained after a probe into the incident, the police said.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi termed the incident "deeply painful". "An ex gratia of ₹2 lakh from the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund would be given to the next of kin of each of those who lost their lives. The injured would be given ₹50,000," Modi said in a post on X, adding that he was "praying for the speedy recovery of the injured".

Chief minister Samrat Choudhary also condoled the loss of lives in the tragedy and announced financial aid of ₹4 lakh each for the families of the deceased. "The news of the innocent lives lost in the boat accident in Raghopur, Vaishali, is extremely heartbreaking and soul-wrenching. In this difficult time, my deepest condolences are with the bereaved families... From the state government, financial assistance of ₹4 lakh (ex gratia amount) will be provided to the families of the deceased. Instructions have been given to the administration to swiftly complete relief and rescue operations and ensure better treatment for the injured," he posted on X in Hindi.

> An ex gratia of ₹2L from the PM's National Relief Fund would be given to the next of kin of each of those who lost their lives
> **NARENDRA MODI,** PM

According to police, the accident took place in the Ganga river around 8.30 pm when the country-made boat was ferrying passengers from one hamlet to another near the village of Rampur Shyamchand, under Raghopur police station jurisdiction.

A senior police officer said around 20 people were on the boat, most of them on their way to attend a feast organised as rituals after the death of a person as per Hindu tradition, popularly known as Shraddh rituals. Officials said some of them swam ashore. "People on the boat were heading to join a feast. Amidst the rising water level and strong currents of the river, the boat suddenly sank into deep water and crashed, causing most of the people to drown," a police officer said.

Vaishali district magistrate Varsha Singh confirmed 11 deaths so far, while seven passengers have been rescued. "There were around 15 to 20 persons on the boat as per our information so far. Out of that 11 persons, all minors around the age of 15, have died. Seven persons including the boat owner have been saved. We are carrying the rescue operations and they would continue all night," he said.

The DM said boat operation in night hours is restricted and there would be a probe.

Leader of the Opposition in the state assembly Tejashwi Yadav expressed sorrow over the deaths. "Tragic and unfortunate news... May God keep everyone safe. A directive has been issued to coordinate with local people, the administration and officials to speed up relief, rescue and treatment operations," Yadav, who represents Raghopur, said.

Odisha: SUV rams into 10 vehicles, one killed

BHUBANESWAR: A 25-year-old man was killed and three others critically injured after a speeding SUV allegedly driven by an intoxicated man rammed into at least 10 vehicles on a busy road in Odisha's Bhubaneswar on Tuesday, police said. The Scorpio, driven by one Daya Shankar Panigrahi, first rammed into vehicles while travelling from the Kalinga Studio area towards Kalinga Vihar at 10 pm, and then crashed into a road divider, leaving one person dead and three injured, police said.

2 Myanmar-linked drug smugglers among 10 arrested

IMPHAL: Security forces arrested eight active cadres of four different banned militant outfits and two suspected drug traffickers, including a Myanmar national, in separate operations in Manipur, officials aware of the matter said on Tuesday. "The arrested cadre is involved in kidnapping for ransom," an official said.

Three killed in firing in UP after row over Ramlila expenses

PILIBHIT: Three people were killed and another injured in a bout of firing that erupted during a dispute over the funds for a Ramlila fair in UP's Pilibhit on Monday, police said on Tuesday, adding that the prime accused, Kaushal Gupta, has been arrested. The victims were identified as Ankit and Mohit Gupta and Kunal Srivastava.

Court orders temporary curbs on video clip after Siddaramaiah plea

Arun Dev
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: A Bengaluru court on Tuesday temporarily restrained 42 media organisations, including a YouTube channel named Karnataka Honey Trap, from publishing or disseminating a video that former chief minister Siddaramaiah said raised defamatory allegations against him.

Judge B Pushpanjali of the 18th City Civil and Sessions Court passed the order on applications seeking the removal of the video and the blocking of access to it. "The plaintiff has specifically disputed about the authenticity, credibility, intention and the propriety of circulation without verification.... Therefore, this Court is of the opinion that the plaintiff has made out prima facie case for grant of ad-interim order of ex-parte temporary injunction," the court said.

Siddaramaiah had approached the court seeking an interim restraint on the publication of details or broadcast of the video, which he claimed was part of a campaign to damage his reputation.

The suit concerns a video allegedly uploaded by the YouTube channel Karnataka Honey Trap on September 27, 2026. The former chief minister disputed the authenticity and credibility of the material and questioned its circulation without verification. His suit also cited the gap of about 15 years between the alleged incident and the video's publication in 2026 as a reason to question the allegations.

The legal action follows allegations by Union minister and Janata Dal (Secular) leader H D Kumaraswamy that then deputy chief minister and current CM D K Shivakumar had used compromising material obtained through a purported sting operation to force Siddaramaiah to step down in May. Shivakumar rejected the claims, saying attempts had also been made to trap him through sting operations after he became chief minister. He said he possessed photographs and documents identifying those allegedly involved and warned Cabinet colleagues and government officials to remain vigilant.

Siddaramaiah said on Monday that he had approached the court because false propaganda was being circulated on social media. He said he was aware of sting operations in Karnataka and called for those responsible to be identified.

Lucknow bizman death: Search on for accused

Aakash Ghosh
letters@htlive.com

LUCKNOW: Police have intensified the search for model and social media influencer Shraddha Dubey, her sister Rashmi, and their driver, in connection with the death of a 28-year-old cafe owner in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, with a reward of ₹25,000 being announced for each of them, deputy commissioner of police (central) Vikrant Vir said on Tuesday.

The prime accused, Dubey, remains at large, with police teams dispatched to Delhi and the Nepal border following intelligence on her possible escape routes. None of the accused have been arrested yet, a police officer said.

Shiva Sharma, the cafe owner, died on October 9 allegedly after falling from fourth floor of the Awadh Green Apartment near Balu Adda, where he had allegedly been living with Dubey for three to four months. His mother, Ranjana Sharma, accused Dubey, her sister and several others of assaulting, harassing and blackmailing her son before his death. Hazratganj police registered a murder case under Section 103(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Findings in the post-mortem report establish the severity of the injuries the 28-year-old sustained due to he fall but do not, by themselves, determine whether Sharma was pushed, jumped or fell accidentally, a person familiar with the details said.

"Police are probing the circumstances surrounding the fall and the allegations made by the family," ACP, Hazratganj, Rajneesh Verma had said earlier.

BJP RETAINS ALL 3 GUJ URBAN LOCAL BODIES IN POLLS

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

AHMEDABAD: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) retained all three urban local bodies that went to polls on Sunday in Gujarat, winning 38 of 44 seats in the Gandhinagar Municipal Corporation (GMC) and netting majorities in Thara and Okha municipalities on Tuesday.

The Congress won five seats in Gandhinagar, while an Independent bagged one. The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), which had won one seat in the last election, failed to open its account. "This massive victory in Gujarat reflects the mood of the voters, showing that the voters of Gujarat and India stand rock-solid with PM Narendra Modi even today," said Union home minister Amit Shah.

कार्यालय उप महाप्रबन्धक (सिविल), निर्माण खण्ड-प्रथम
उत्तर प्रदेश औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
गाजियाबाद। website: https://onlineupsida.com

अल्पकालीन ई–निविदा सूचना

एतद्द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि प्राधिकरण के विभिन्न जनपदों में स्थित औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों में सिविल कार्यों, विकास एवं अनुरक्षण रख–रखाव के कार्यों हेतु सरकारी / सार्वजनिक उपक्रमों / निगमों / प्राधिकरणों / परिषदों / स्वर निकायों में पंजीकृत फर्मों / ठेकेदारों से अल्पकालीन ई–निविदायें आमंत्रित की जाती हैं।

क्र०	कार्य का नाम	संवर्गवार शर्तें
1	Providing and Fixing Cantilever Gantry Sign Board Road Direction Board and Guide Map in I.A. Meerut Road Site-3 Distt. Ghaziabad.	12.82
2	Providing and Fixing Cantilever Gantry Sign Board Road Direction Board and Guide Map in I.A. Loni Road Site-2 Distt. Ghaziabad.	12.82
3	Construction and Beautification of Park and Footpath Repairing work at Sports Goods Complex near Amar Ujala at Delhi Road Meerut, Distt. Meerut.	46.99
4	Construction of Boundary Wall, Footpath, Nesting Hut & Horticulture work with 2 Years Maintenance of Park at I.A. Udhyog Kunj Dasna Distt. Ghaziabad.	42.23
5	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous Civil Works at I.A. Begrajpur, District-Muzaffarnagar	45.59
6	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous Civil Works at I.A. Loha Mandi Distt. Ghaziabad	42.76
7	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous Civil Works at Industrial Estate Loni Distt. Ghaziabad.	21.94
8	Annual Repair and Maintenance of Miscellaneous Civil Works at I.A. Udhyog Kunj Dasna Distt. Ghaziabad.	49.61

1. क्रमांक 01, 02, 03 एवं 04 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदायें दिनांक 15.10.2026 को 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 22.10.2026 को सायं 05.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है। क्रमांक 01, 02, 03 एवं 04 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदायें दिनांक 22.10.2026 को सायं 05:15 बजे खोली जायेंगी। निविदादाताओं द्वारा शासपत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ दिनांक 23.10.2026 को 05.00 बजे तक पंजीकृत डाक / व्यक्तिगत रूप से कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती है।
2. क्रमांक 05, 06, 07 एवं 08 पर अंकित कार्यों की निविदायें दिनांक 16.10.2026 को 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 23.10.2026 को सायं 05.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है। क्रमांक 05, 06, 07 एवं 08 पर अंकित कार्यों की निविदायें दिनांक 23.10.2026 को सायं 05:15 बजे खोली जायेंगी। निविदादाताओं द्वारा शासपत्रों की मूल प्रतियाँ दिनांक 24.10.2026 को 05.00 बजे तक पंजीकृत डाक / व्यक्तिगत रूप से कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती है।
नोट : 1. निविदादाता सभी निविदाओं में समस्त कार्यों सहित एवं अंकित कार्य। जीएसटी अलग से देय होगा। 2. निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी वेबसाइट https://onlineupsida.com पर स्थापित लिंक यूपीएसडी की website: https://etender.up.nic.in पर देखी जा सकती है।

(वरिष्ठ भाषा) उप महाप्रबन्धक (सिविल), निर्माण खण्ड-प्रथम, मो:- 9205691068

GOVERNMENT OF RAJASTHAN
OFFICE OF THE MEDICAL SUPERINTENDENT, SAWAI MAN SINGH HOSPITAL, JAIPUR
[Sawai Man Singh Road, Tonk Road, Jaipur, Rajasthan - 302 001]
{Phone: 0141-2518308, 0141 2565647, Email- ms.smshospital@gmail.com}

No. 2580 Store/SMS/MH/2026 — Jaipur dated, the 3.10.26

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for two years rate contract for procurement of Disposable Laboratory Items are invited from interested bidders up to **06.11.2026 on 03.00 P.M.** Other particulars of bid may be visited on the procurement portal **(http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.raj.nic.in)** of the state.

UBN. No. MCJ2627GLOB00079 — **Medical Superintendent S.M.S. Hospital, Jaipur**

DIPR/C/17546/2026

भारतीय रिज़र्व बैंक
RESERVE BANK OF INDIA
www.rbi.org.in

Department of Communication, Central Office, Mumbai

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Reserve Bank of India, Department of Communication, Central Office invites Open Tender bids through e-tendering on CPPP portal (https://etenders.gov.in/eprocure/app) from eligible bidders for the following:

"Empanelment of vendor for Brand infringement and Reputation Management Service for Reserve Bank of India"

For details, please visit the Tenders Section of RBI website (https://www.rbi.org.in/Scripts/BS_ViewTenders.aspx). The last date for submission of bids is **November 13, 2026, 12:00 hrs.** RBI reserves the right to reject any or all the bids for the tender.

Chief General Manager
Department of Communication
Reserve Bank of India

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in, (Contact Number: 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 13/2026 — **Dated: 08.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No. D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three-part bid system for banking of power from interstate utilities/traders, Traders having valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States from **1st November 2026 to 10th October 2027**. For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 08.10.2026 onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **http://eproc.punjab.gov.in**

C976/26 — RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16126

PUBLIC NOTICE

PROPERTY BEARING NO. S-382, SITUATED AT GREATER KAILASH -1, NEW DELHI, MEASURING 204 SQ. YDS.

Be it known to all that **Shri Alok Gupta S/o Late Sh. Rajender Gupta AND Shri Sajal Gupta S/o Shri Alok Gupta,** both having their residence at S-382, Greater Kailash -1, New Delhi, [say **'OWNERS'**] jointly representing themselves to be the absolute owners of entire freehold built up property bearing **No. S-382**, situated at **Greater Kailash -1, New Delhi**, alongwith the ownership rights in the plot of land measuring 204 sq. yds., have agreed jointly to sell the same in its entirety to my client. Any other person(s)/entity having any right/title/claim against, into or upon the said property or any part thereof by virtue of sale, inheritance, agreement, contract, mortgage, lien, charge, or otherwise howsoever and of whatsoever nature is hereby required to notify the same in writing along with supporting documentary evidence to the undersigned within 15 days, from the date of publication of this notice, failing which my client shall conclude the sale and any claim and/or objection if any shall be considered as waived and abandoned and shall not be binding upon my client.

Sidharth Arora (Advocate)
PH:9811183806 Email: arorasidharth@hotmail.com
ADD: A-219, Basement, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024

GOVERNMENT OF NATIONAL CAPITAL TRERRITORY OF DELHI
DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS
2ND FLOOR, F-BLOCK, VIKAS BHAWAN, I.P. ESTATE, NEW DELHI-110002
Phone No. 23370225, Email ID: dge.2011@gmail.com

FORM 16
(See Rule 22(1)(b))

NOTICE OF FINAL PUBLICATION OF ELECTORAL ROLLS

It is hereby notified for public information that the list of amendments to the draft electoral roll for Ward No. 1 to 46 have been prepared in accordance with the Delhi Sikh Gurdwara Management Committee (Registration of Electors) Rules, 1973 and a copy of the said roll together with the said list of amendments have been published and will be available for inspection at ERO/AERO offices of respective wards and also on the website of this Directorate i.e. **https://gurudwara.delhi.gov.in**

Place: Delhi
Date: 09.10.2026

ELECTORAL REGISTRATION OFFICERS
WARD 1 TO 46
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0252/26-27 — **DIRECTORATE OF GURDWARA ELECTIONS**

HARYANA SCHOOL SHIKSHA PARIYOJNA PARISHAD
(Regd. Under Societies Registration Act. 1860)
Shiksha Sadan, 3rd & 4th Floor, Sector-5, Panchkula-134109
Tel: 0172-2590505, 2586026 (F)
E-mail: sciencessaharyana@gmail.com
Website: www.hsspp.in

No. SS/PC(SC)/2026/-14134 — **Dated: 12.10.2026**

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Request for Proposal (RFP) for selection of an Implementation Agency for conducting standardized psychometric assessments covering aptitude, interests, personality, behavioural attributes and career readiness of students of Classes X and XII in 250 PM SHRI Schools in Haryana.

Bids shall be submitted online through the Haryana e-Procurement Portal at **https://etenders.hry.nic.in** along with online payment of the tender fee, e-Service fee and EMD, as applicable, latest by **02.11.2026 up to 02.00 PM.**

Sd/- **Associate Consultant (Admn.)**
Haryana School Shiksha Pariyojna Parishad
Shiksha Sadan, Sector-5
RO No. 1054/11/101/2027/50131/C/19/7 — **Panchkula, Haryana**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in, (Contact Number: 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 15/2026 — **Dated: 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No.D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Non Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power **(www.Powermin.nic.in)** and PFC Consultancy Limited **(www.pfcindia.com)**. For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com**

C978/26 — RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16128

Govt of Gujarat
N.W.R.W.S. & Kalpasar Deptt

ON LINE TENDER NOTICE NO.12 Total Work:8
Estimate Cost:- 3.43 Cr. To 4.46 Cr.
Tender Upload Date:14-10-2026 To 29-10-2026
Last Date Download of Tender:29-10-2026
Time:18.00 Hrs.

Executive Engineer, Kakrapar Right bank Canal Division, Surat, 1st Floor, Sinchai Bhawan, Athwalines, Surat - 395 007 (0261 2669048)

Visit: www.statetenders.gujarat.gov.in & https://tender.nrprocue.com

No.Mahiti-Surat/739/2026

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall Patiala)
Corporate Identification Number (CIN): U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in, (Contact Number: 9646123323)

Tender Inquiry No. PPR - 14/2026 — **Dated: 13.10.2026**

Chief Engineer/PP&R Organization, Shed No.D-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender under three part bid system for supply of electrical energy (RE-Solar) from interstate/intrastate sources viz. Generators, Traders having Valid Inter State Trading License issued by CERC for interstate trading of energy, intrastate trading license issued by PSERC for intrastate trading of energy, State Electricity Boards, State Electricity Utilities, States, IPPs & CPPs from 1st November 2026 to 31st March 2027. The link for the e-Bidding portal is **www.mstcecommerce.com** and is also available on the website of Ministry of Power **(www.Powermin.nic.in)** and PFC Consultancy Limited **(www.pfcindia.com)**. For detailed NIT & tender specifications please refer to **www.mstcecommerce.com** from 13.10.2026 onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **www.mstcecommerce.com**

C977/26 — RO NO. 1079/12/2026/27/16127

निर्वाही यन्त्रीक कार्य्यालय — **25001/1314/2627**
ଗ୍ରାମ୍ୟ ଜଳ ଯୋଗାଣ ଓ ପରିମଳ ଖଣ୍ଡ, ସୋନପୁର
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
RURAL WATER SUPPLY & SANITATION DIVISION, SONEPUR
Pin-767017, Phone-06654-220259 (O) / Email: eerwss.sonepur@gmail.com

OFFICE ORDER No. 3510 — Date. 09-10-2026

The Bid identification No.01 of 2026-27 Dt.07.10.2026 the work Construction of 04 nos of 'E' type quarter (G+F) at RWS&S Division Sonepur for the year 2025-26, which was issued to I&PR Deptt. on Dated. 07.10.2026 has been cancelled due technical issue.

(Er Muna Kalundia)
Executive Engineer
RWS&S Division Sonepur
OIPR - 25001/25037/1/26-27/0003

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

INDIA TRUSTED PARTNER...

"In a world filled with uncertainty, India offers the assurance of reliability and stability...It is clear that whenever the world needs a steady pillar, India extends its hand in support, recognising its responsibility. We do not grow at anyone's cost. We grow with the world, and for the world," he said.

Modi said the last six years witnessed several disruptions starting with a global pandemic, followed by wars in different regions. Disruptions emerged in trade, critical minerals, and energy supplies, he said. "Things that once connected the world are now being turned into weapons. Supply chains, energy, minerals, payment systems, and technology are increasingly becoming instruments of pressure and dominance," he said.

Hours ahead of Modi's address, the International Monetary Fund raised its growth forecast for India to 7% for fiscal 2027, up from 6.4% projected in July.

"The routes created by globalisation over past decades have, in many cases, become chokepoints. Amid all this, Artificial Intelligence is transforming the way every sector functions. At the same time, many countries are facing rapidly growing challenges related to ageing populations. In such circumstances, the world is confronted with a fundamental question: trust," he added.

"Trust that supplies will continue during times of need. Trust that promises made will also be fulfilled. Trust that a partner country will stand by you during moments of crisis. And it is here that India stands before you with a different outlook and a different way of thinking."

The PM said India's development journey was inclusive, citing the examples of affordable medicines, digital public infrastructure (DPI) and skilled manpower. "One out of every five generic medicines comes from India. When solutions for digital identity and payments are required, the world looked to models developed in India. When the world needs talent, it places its trust in India's skilled youth. Today, India is home to more than 2,000 Global Capability Centres (GCCs) that are providing services to companies across the world," he added.

"The vision I have come with is power to empower; Beyond the power to control, power to enable; Beyond the power to compete, power to collaborate; Beyond the power to succeed, power to help others succeed," he said.

Modi didn't comment on the ongoing protests by the Opposition but showcased India's legacy as the "mother of democracy," home to a free media and hundreds of millions of YouTube and Instagram users who debate issues openly.

"India has more than one hundred languages, nearly eighty thousand registered newspapers and publications, and more than one thousand satellite television channels. And not only that, in this age of social media, India has more than five hundred million YouTube users and more than five hundred million Instagram users. In our country, people openly debate different issues, and citizens discuss diverse viewpoints. In the present era, one factor that has played a major role in enabling this is digital power," he said.

In the April-June quarter of this year, India's growth rate stood at 7.8%, he said, giving credit to the strong foundation of the Indian economy for steady growth.

"Twelve to thirteen years ago, India's current account deficit was more than four percent of GDP. Last year, it declined to approximately half a percent, standing at 0.61 percent. Today, our foreign exchange reserves exceed 700 billion dollars. Our banking system is in its strongest position in many decades. It is because of this strength that India's sovereign ratings are being upgraded. Today, India's confidence is at an unprecedented high. We are pursuing reforms with a clear policy direction. Through GST, we transformed a complex web of taxes into a national market. We enacted the insolvency law. Twenty-nine labour laws have now been consolidated into four simple labour codes. Hundreds of minor business-related offences have been decriminalised. And we have not stopped there. India's reform express continues to move ahead at high speed. For us, reforms are not a compulsion. Reforms are our conviction," he added.

A large chunk of his speech was spent underlining India's economic journey and its strides in expanding digital payments, mobile phone and internet penetration, and philanthropic initiatives. He said that domestic digital capabilities were continuously shared with the Global South and other partner countries to help them build their own digital public infrastructure. "Our capability should empower humanity," he said.

He also celebrated the nation's startup growth, pointing out that nearly half of the 250,000 startups in India originated from smaller cities and that over 45% featured female leadership, proving that the power to solve problems was reaching all segments of society. "Meaning, opportunities for Innovation are reaching more people," he noted.

"Our constant endeavour is to ensure that India's capabilities open new doors of opportunity for other countries as well...India's progress is rooted in collective growth and shared opportunities," he said.

This year's Bloomberg Economic Forum was focused on the new powers emerging around the world, he said. Every era has had its own sources of power and its own definition of power. But in the 21st century, especially in this third decade, a major transformation is taking place. Today, technology is power, data is power, knowledge is power, innovation is power, he said.

"Let us walk together. Let us speak together. Let us strive to understand one another. Because when we walk together, our strength grows. Through dialogue, our understanding deepens. And by understanding one another, we can jointly solve great challenges. This is the essence of power to empower. It means not limiting our power solely to our own progress, but using it to create new opportunities for others as well," he said.

RAHUL, SHAH ON EC STIR

not through mere allegations and propaganda, but through public outreach and public service," he said.

Earlier in the day, the Opposition announced a "mission to restore democracy" that might include a political fight against the Union government's decision to de-notify Jantar Mantar as a protest site. The parties also agreed to wait for the Supreme Court's decision on their petition filed on Monday before another stir in Delhi.

The leaders hailed Monday's march to the Supreme Court as a major achievement and decided to form an INDIA plus group to accommodate political parties, activists, students and other organisations. It even discussed plans for a mock Parliament and flash agitations.

"We are all standing here together as one. As I said yesterday, there are no parallel protests. There is one singular protest, and the protest has one mission: restoration of democracy in India. Democracy has been destroyed in this country. The election system has been destroyed. The Constitution has been torn up and thrown away. We are fighting together to restore democratic rule, genuine democratic rule in this country," Gandhi said after hosting leaders from 12 parties, civil society members and student organisations at his 5, Sunehri Bagh Road residence.

"The one method of expression of democracy was Jantar Mantar and now the government has decided that Jantar Mantar can no longer be used to express democratic feelings. Well, we are going to challenge that idea. It is not going to be so simple for the government to decide that the Indian people will not fight for their voice. The people who have done this, they need to understand that the net is closing around them. It is not going to be so simple that you can destroy the Indian Constitution and get away with it," Gandhi added.

The developments came after a week of protests where tens of thousands of people hit the streets, braving expansive metro closures, internet shutdown, prohibitory orders and 40,000 security personnel who turned the Capital into a virtual fortress and sparked controversy by dragging, manhandling and detaining many agitators. While the Opposition is seeking the removal of Kumar and scrapping the controversial special intensive revision, the BJP blames them for trying to destabilise constitutional bodies to deflect attention from their own political and electoral failures.

Shah invoked the BJP's victories in Gujarat municipal elections and said the state's voters still stand "rock-solid with Modi even today."

"Today, elections for three municipalities and municipal corporations were held in Gujarat. In two municipalities and one municipal corporation, the BJP has achieved a resounding victory by winning 90 out of the total 104 seats. In the Gandhinagar Municipal Corporation, which falls within my constituency, the BJP has won 38 out of 44 seats, while the Aam Aadmi Party contested 32 seats and had their deposits forfeited in all 32 seats," Shah said.

Pointing out that the BJP did not face anti-incumbency even after four decades in power in Gujarat, Shah said the Congress had not won a single election in the duration. "I also want to ask Rahul, is this the result of SIR? Do you dismiss the popularity of the BJP and Modi's popularity by calling it the result of SIR? The success of the BJP and NDA in the local bodies and by-elections in Gujarat, Rajasthan, Tripura, and other states reflects the support of the people," he said.

The minister said the Congress should reflect on why it did not win a single seat in by-elections that were held in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, and Puducherry. He also lashed out at Gandhi for criticising SIR and said the opposition to the exercise was an "action plan to protect infiltrators".

"I also want to tell Rahul Gandhi ji and his companions that in the 2029 general elections, the NDA will return to power with a resounding majority, and the Congress will face defeat for the fourth consecutive time. The people of this country are with Modi ji, with the BJP, with the NDA," Shah said.

Earlier in the day, opposition leaders met for more than two hours, and spoke against the government's decision to remove Jantar Mantar as a notified protest site. Ramlila Ground, Burari ground and CBD ground in east Delhi as new designated protest sites.

"Yesterday you saw an expression, not of the political parties standing here, but an expression of the people of India. We were there, but what happened yesterday could not have happened without the expression of the average citizen of this country, non-political citizen of this country. So, the first thing as a group we would like to do is we would like to thank the people of Delhi, the people of India who stood with us against what is being done. This is not about us, this is about the people of India, this is about the future of the people of India. And we, all of us together, because we love you and we respect you are going to fight to the end to restore the democratic process in this country. It is our commitment, the people who have done this, are going to be brought to justice," Gandhi said.

Apart from Gandhi, Congress parliamentary party chief Sonia Gandhi and party president Mallikarjun Kharge attended the meeting. Jammu and Kashmir chief minister Omar Abdullah, Peoples Democratic Party chief Mehbooba Mufti, Rashtriya Janata Dal leaders Tejashwi Yadav and Manoj Jha, Samajwadi Party leaders Anand Bhadauria, Harender Malik and M Nadvi, Jharkhand Mukti Morcha's Mahua Maji, Communist Party of India (Marxist) general secretary MA Baby, Communist Party of India's D Raja and party MP Sandosh Kumar, Communist Party of India (Marxist Leninist) leader Dipankar Bhattacharya, Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) lawmaker Supriya Sule, Jose K Mani of the Kerala Congress, Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi chief Thol Thirumavalavan were among those present, alongside student leaders Neha Bora and Aishe Ghosh.

According to three senior leaders who attended the meeting, all expressed satisfaction over the mass mobilisation on Monday. "It has been decided that before taking out another massive march in the heart of Delhi, the INDIA bloc will wait for the Supreme Court's view on our petition. The logic is that we have already gone to court so we must wait for the SC's orders," said a fourth leader.

This position, however, will not deter the Opposition from protesting at Jantar Mantar. "Our decentralised programmes will continue to take place in Jantar Mantar. We do not agree with the government's view that protests can't be held at that place," said a fifth leader.

According to functionaries, the leaders even discussed a sketchy plan to hold a mock Parliament against Modi, Shah and Kumar. Gandhi also told everyone to remain alert for "surprise movements" at 24 hours' notice, said another leader present at the meeting.

MA Baby said that after vote chori (vote theft), the government had done "chori of Jantar Mantar." "Gyanesh Kumar has joined the ruling party's team... He steals votes, protest site and democracy," added Baby.

Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut compared Kumar to a mafia. Neha Bora said the people were fighting one enemy of democracy and the Constitution. "The common people of this country, who have fought and sacrificed their lives to make India a democracy and defend the Constitution, are not ready to settle for a stolen mandate or a compromised democracy," she added.

Defence ties in focus

Defence minister Rajnath Singh meets Czech Republic First Deputy Prime Minister and minister of industry & trade Karel Havlicek in New Delhi on Tuesday. "Both leaders reviewed the entire spectrum of defence industrial cooperation between the two countries," the defence ministry said. @RAJNATHSINGH/X

Indore school moves SC, seeks curbs on use of social media by kids

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

THE PETITION COMES AMID A GROWING INTERNATIONAL PUSH TO RESTRICT KIDS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL MEDIA

NEW DELHI: An Indore-based school has moved the Supreme Court seeking restrictions on children's use of social media platforms, arguing that protecting minors from online harms is a constitutional responsibility of the State and cannot be left solely to parental supervision or voluntary safeguards adopted by technology companies.

Emerald Heights International School and its director Siddharth Singh have filed a PIL seeking a comprehensive and enforceable regulatory framework to protect children from risks associated with social media, including cyberbullying, sexual exploitation, exposure to harmful content, compulsive use and mental health problems. The Supreme Court is yet to assign a date for hearing the petition. Invoking Articles 14, 15(3), 21 and 21A of the Constitution, the petition contends that the State's continuing failure to provide effective protection against foreseeable social-media harms violates children's fundamental rights.

The respondents include the Centre and the ministries of electronics and information technology, women and child development, and law and justice, besides the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights.

The petition comes amid a growing international push to restrict children's access to social media. Australia became the first country to enforce a minimum age of 16 for accounts on designated social-media platforms in December 2025, requiring companies to take reasonable steps to prevent younger children from accessing them. France, through a 2023 law, provided for parental authorisation for social-media accounts of children below 15.

In India, the Centre has been weighing similar restrictions, with the Economic Survey 2025-26 recommending age-based safeguards, including age verification and age-appropriate defaults on digital platforms. In February, HT reported that the government was considering restricting access for children below 16 through amendments to the IT Rules, while holding consultations with social-media platforms. India's existing Digital Personal Data Protection law provides for verifiable parental consent before the personal data of children below 18 is processed, but it does not have a minimum age for accessing social media.

ALL INDIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES, REWARI-123102
(A Central Autonomous Body under PMSSY, MoH&FW, Govt. of India)

VACANCY NOTICE

EMPLOYMENT NOTIFICATION NO. FAC./02/2026

All India Institute of Medical Sciences, Rewari, invites Applications in the prescribed format through offline mode from eligible candidates for filling up the posts of **FACULTY (GROUP- A) on Direct Recruitment basis** in various departments.

Important Dates	
Date of publishing of Advertisement on website	**08th October, 2026**
Last date to submit hard copy of application form	**07th November, 2026** (till 05.00 p.m.)

Important: For further details like Essential Qualifications, Experience, Age limits, Terms & Conditions etc., please visit AIIMS Rewari website: **https://aiimsrewari.edu.in**

Sd/-
Deputy Director (Admin.)
On behalf of ED & CEO, AIIMS Rewari

14001/168/2627

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Utkalika H.O - D 2/3 & 4, Rasulgarh Industrial Estate, Bhubaneswar, Odisha 751010

OIPR - 14001/14009/226-27/0022

37001/57/2627

INVITING
APPLICATIONS FOR PARTICIPATION

16th INTERNATIONAL SAND ART FESTIVAL

1ST-5TH DECEMBER 2026

CHANDRABHAGA BEACH,
KONARK, ODISHA

Shri Sudarsan Pattnaik (Padma Shri Awardee)
BRAND AMBASSADOR,
INTERNATIONAL SAND ART FESTIVAL, KONARK

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odishatourism.gov.in

ODISHA
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OIPR - 37001/37001/2/26-27/0014

The Hindustan Times
ESTABLISHED IN 1924

{ OUR TAKE }

Practical issues in allowing crackers

If the State cannot check before sale whether a cracker is green, misnomer notwithstanding, it should not be sold

The Supreme Court wants a "pragmatic and practical" way to regulate firecrackers. On Monday, a bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant said it would respect religious sentiments and warned that people would see a restrictive order as coercion. It then tied the Delhi-NCR case to the national one before Justice MM Sundresh, whose bench cleared "next-generation" *laris* (string fireworks) across the country on September 30, and both will be heard on October 15.

The most practical words in the courtroom came from the *amicus curiae*, senior advocate Aparajita Singh. "It is nice to say that crackers should be burst for (only) two hours. Cops cannot be there on every street," she told the bench, and asked that the Commission for Air Quality Management report on the matter.

Last year bears her out. In October 2025, the court allowed green crackers in Delhi-NCR for three days, within fixed hours. Conventional firecrackers were sold openly beside boxes stamped "green" with no certification behind them, licensed makers sold the QR codes meant to vouch for genuine products, and Delhi had no laboratory to test any of it. The Capital went on to record its worst Diwali pollution peak since 2021, despite weather conditions that would normally reduce pollution.

Workable enforcement has to start where a firecracker can still be caught. Before it reaches a street, a firecracker passes through a factory, a wholesaler's godown and a licensed shop, and at each of these points, the State can take samples, seal stock and cancel licences. Once it is in a household's hands, enforcement depends on a beat constable standing on the right street, which, as the *amicus* pointed out, is impossible.

To be sure, the supply chain leaked last year too, with QR codes resold and firecrackers coming in from outside the region. Fixing it requires testing laboratories, which Delhi lacked, and inspections that actually take place. The court should demand that before it permits a single additional firecracker, not resort to fuzzily warm statements about religious sentiments. CAQM's report should begin with what the State can enforce: how many samples it can test before Diwali, how many shops it can inspect, and what it will do with the fakes it finds. A regime that leaves the policing to millions of households has not kept Delhi's air breathable before, and there is no reason to expect it will now.

If the State cannot check before sale whether a cracker is green, however much of a misnomer that is, it should not be sold.

Of protest sites and power corridors

When Maharaja Sawai Jai Singh II built the Jantar Mantar in 1724, little did he imagine that his astronomical observatory would one day be synonymous with dissent in the world's largest democracy. Since 1993, the lane behind the site has housed thousands of ordinary Indians with extraordinary dreams — women fighting for a more equal world, victims demanding justice, LGBTQIA+ communities dreaming of dignity, youth hoping for a future free of corruption and students angry at the callous handling of their careers.

The Centre's decision to denotify Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site has called time on that legacy. The intentions behind the October 11 order — which also designates three new spots, all requiring tens of thousands of rupees to pre-book and two of which are on the fringes of the city — are clear. The new sites are sprawling, some host various commercial activities, and they are far from the nerve centre of the power corridor — no doubt an important consideration for the authorities who have privileged maintaining order over upholding the right to protest. Clearly, the administration believes protests to be an irritant and reducing their visibility and access is a way to smother their reach. There is no doubt that protest sites in the heart of a city hold some risks of congestion and law and order. Yet, major world capitals designate sites near their seats of power because free expressions of dissent provide moral legitimacy to power in a democracy. The unfortunate impulse to take this away — which is responsible for shifting protesters out of the Boat Club, then India Gate and now finally Jantar Mantar — pervades every ideological spectrum and is decades old. It refuses to recognise that the proximity of Jantar Mantar to Parliament is a feature of a democracy, not a flaw.

Preparing for a super, monster, Godzilla El Niño

The aim is to act on evidence that already exists, before the price index or the next dry well spells out the damage

The effects of El Niño could creep into coming seasons through crops, water, heat, food prices, forests, and seas. AP

Roxy Mathew Koll

Mohammad Rafiuddin

We are lost for names and adjectives, as an exceptionally strong El Niño evolves in the Pacific Ocean.

The Pacific Ocean usually goes through a cycle of warm and cool phases every few years. An El Niño is its warm phase and a La Niña is its cool phase. When a large part of the ocean warms, it changes where clouds form and rain falls. The changes reach far beyond the Pacific, altering the chances of drought or heavy rain in different parts of the world. In India, El Niño often weakens the summer monsoon.

So, what is special about this year? Many earlier El Niños peaked with central Pacific waters about 1°C warmer than usual. Several in recent decades have exceeded 2°C. The current El Niño, however, has already exceeded earlier observed peaks. Forecasts indicate that the central Pacific could be nearly 4°C warmer than usual by November or December, when El Niño usually peaks.

And why does this matter now? Human-caused global warming has heated up our oceans, which absorb over 90% of the excess heat trapped by greenhouse gases. El Niño releases some of that extra ocean heat into the atmosphere, and the effect often lasts for months after the event peaks. Meteorological agencies predict that 2027 will be the warmest year on record, as a result of unabated global warming and an exceptionally strong El Niño. This means that the coming seasons may unfold in a world unlike any in the past several thousand years.

The southwest monsoon closed with a 13% rainfall deficit. Punjab, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, and the northeastern states recorded stark rainfall deficits. Meanwhile, Odisha received 30% more than usual. Bihar and Assam experienced severe floods in a monsoon that remains markedly deficient overall.

The effects could creep into coming seasons through crops, water, heat, food prices, forests, and seas. In parts of Maharashtra, soybean farmers have already had to contend with long dry spells. A late shower cannot save a crop that lost moisture at a critical stage, and rain at harvest can cause fresh damage. The winter (*rabi*) crops that follow, including wheat, chickpea, and mustard, will depend on the moisture left in the ground and the water available for irrigation.

The economic costs begin before a harvest is counted. Less fodder raises the cost of keeping livestock. More pumping for water means more spending on electricity or diesel. A smaller harvest reduces farm income and spending in local shops, while shortages of particular foods can raise prices in towns and cities. A household may face dearer pulses or vegetables even when the national foodgrain total looks reassuring.

In August, the Reserve Bank of India flagged El Niño and uneven rainfall as risks to agriculture and inflation. It projected consumer inflation at 5% for 2026-27 and pointed to grain stocks and timely supply management as buffers. In the El Niño drought of 2009, the monsoon was 22% below normal. Foodgrain production fell by 17 million tonnes and wholesale food inflation reached 20% in December 2009. The drought was not the only cause, as bottlenecks in the supply of essential commodities also mattered.

India in 2026 has more ways to respond than it did in 2009. Irrigation covers about 56% of the gross cropped area. Grain stocks, food security law, crop insurance, farm credit and better forecasts give governments more options. Decisions about water, crops and food supply can address shortages before they appear in an inflation reading. These tools need to reach farmers and districts whose losses do not show up in national totals.

October-December brings the northeast monsoon, the main rainy season for Tamil Nadu and parts of the southeast coast. El Niño can bring more rain there, sometimes in intense spells. A state dealing with water shortage after the summer monsoon may also need to prepare for floods.

In the north, the coming winter brings a different risk. A CEEW analysis found slightly weaker winds over Delhi during El Niño than La Niña winters, which can make pollution harder to disperse. If *kharif* harvesting is delayed, the time before *rabi* sowing becomes even tighter, adding pressure to burn crop residue. Farmers need timely help to manage residue, while cities must cut local emissions.

The water that remains after winter will matter in the summer heat. If soils, reservoirs and aquifers enter the pre-monsoon months with less water, heat will place additional demands on people, crops and electricity. Health departments can prepare clinics for heat illness and identify older people and patients with heart or kidney disease who may need help early. Cities can provide drinking water and public cooling spaces, and keep electricity reliable during the hottest spells.

The Indian Ocean can remain unusually warm after the Pacific El Niño begins to fade, influencing weather into the following year. Marine heatwaves may put coral reefs around Lakshadweep and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands under stress. Changes in the sea can affect where fish are found and how far boats must go to catch them.

In September, we were among 188 researchers who called on India's ecologists to follow this El Niño through forests, grasslands, rivers, wetlands and reefs. The point is not only to observe what changes, but also to protect what is already under strain. Preparation for fires in dry forests, care for freshwater habitats and rapid checks on reefs are practical tasks for the coming months. A forecast can be useful to ecosystems as well as farms, if the work begins before the damage is obvious.

Before winter sowing, districts can put actual reservoir storage, groundwater conditions, crop stages and likely drinking-water needs on one public map. Crop-loss assessments, credit and insurance support can reach farmers before they take on debt for another season. The aim is to act on evidence that already exists, before the price index or the next dry well spells out the damage.

Roxy Mathew Koll is a climate scientist at the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology, lead author of recent IPCC reports, and scientific advisor to the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW). Mohammad Rafiuddin is programme lead at CEEW. The views expressed are personal

Moving governance from welfare to empowerment

"The land north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains is called Bhārata, where the descendants of Bharata dwell." — *Vishnu Purana*

In February 2016, Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi touched the feet of a woman more than a hundred years old. Kunwar Bai Yadav of Kotabharri village, in Chhattisgarh's Dhamtari district, owned about two dozen goats — the savings of a long life. She sold seven of them to build a toilet at home. Her example helped her village end open defecation.

For any household in India, four things decide whether life is secure: the kitchen, the toilet, the doctor's bill, and the means to earn. For generations, each was a source of drudgery or dread for poor households. In the Andamans, A Venkatalakshmi cooked on a wood-fired *chulha* until a gas connection under Ujjwala freed her from harmful smoke.

In Meghalaya, Pooja Thapa paid nothing for kidney-stone surgery under Ayushman Bharat. In Manali, a Mudra loan of ₹2.5 lakh enabled a vegetable-seller to open a ration shop of her own. All these women lacked access, not aspiration. For decades, the poor were handed relief without choice or voice.

Our nation-builders never accepted this development model. Mahatma Gandhi wanted an India "in which the poorest shall have an effective voice". Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya put forward the idea of *antyodaya*, the rise of the last person. PM Modi has turned this philosophy into a method of governance. Its focus is the poor, women, the young, and farmers. Its standard is saturation for every eligible household. Its instrument is direct delivery, so that what the State sends is what the citizen receives. In 1985, the then PM admitted that only about 15 paise of every rupee meant for the poor reached them. Today, through Jan Dhan, Aadhaar and the mobile phone, nearly ₹50 lakh crore has gone straight to beneficiaries' accounts. The scale has no parallel in any democracy.

The governance focus has changed from welfare to empowerment. Each scheme removes one barrier. Together, they form a ladder: from security to capability, opportunity, self-reliance and, finally, to participation. Ujjwala began in the kitchen and ended up changing the household. More than 105 million poor women have received deposit-free LPG connections. Swachh Bharat restored dignity. Rural India became defecation free by 2019. Nearly 120 million household toilets have now been built, and with the provision of *izzat ghars*, daughters need no longer wait for nightfall.

Under Ayushman Bharat, 120 million hospital admissions have availed of the scheme's cashless cover of up to ₹5 lakh a year per family, bringing down out-of-pocket health spending from 64% in 2013-14 to about 43% in 2022-23. MUDRA, through its silent revolution, opened the doors of the bank. It provides funds to all eligible, who were once deemed un-bankable.

More than 590 million collateral-free loans have been sanctioned; this credit comes through India's own Mudra Card, a RuPay card, which ensures that the data of all transactions remains within India. With free accident insurance of up to ₹2 lakh and no merchant fee, the indigenous RuPay payment card has taken a significant leap from local to global — empowering India's last mile to be accepted in over 180+ countries worldwide.

Beneath all this lies an economic transformation of a scale India had never seen. In rupee terms, the economy has nearly tripled since 2013-14, to ₹331 lakh crore, powered by a massive expansion in road networks to take farmers' produce to distant markets, 223,000 startups that have created over 2.3 million jobs, and women's participation in the workforce almost doubling in six years, among other factors. More than 30 million rural women have become Lakhpati Didis through self-help groups.

A bank account for every home, money that moves without middlemen, and a ration card that works for a migrant worker in any state are what Nobel-winning economists Daron Acemoglu and James Robinson call "inclusive institutions" that are the bedrock of prosperous nations.

Jyotiraditya Scindia

When citizens see that the nation works for them, their sense of belonging deepens, and that belonging becomes the foundation for the next round of reform.

Swachh Bharat turned that belonging into a public movement — Jan Bhagidari, a governance model in which citizens are active producers of economic and political capital.

This is at the heart of the PM's vision of Viksit Bharat: Inclusive and Collective. "Resolve for a Viksit Bharat will be fulfilled only when development reaches the last person," he says, emphasising that Viksit Bharat will be realised through *sabka prayas* (with the contribution, efforts, and participation of 140 crore people of our nation). This is a nation whose progress will be written by many hands.

Japan, South Korea, Singapore, and China achieved unprecedented change only when each gave its last citizen something to own, something to learn, or something to decide. "This is the period in the history of India," the PM has said, "when the country is going to take a quantum leap." That leap must be made with the consent of the governed, which is why the goal is not only a Viksit Bharat, but a Sashakt Bharat.

Former president APJ Abdul Kalam asked Indians to dream, because dreams become thoughts and thoughts become action. This tenet has been lived by PM Modi in its truest sense. There are, as Robert Frost wrote, "miles to go before I sleep," and the journey will be complete only when every citizen has some ownership in it. Kunwar Bai Yadav passed away in 2018, at the age of 106. With seven goats, she brought dignity to her family, and her example moved a whole village.

Schemes give citizens like her the tools to build the nation. That is nation-building in the true sense. That is the Bharat we are building together: not only *viksit* but also *sashakt*.

Jyotiraditya Scindia is Union minister of communications and minister of development of north eastern region. The views expressed are personal

{ ELINA VALTONEN } MINISTER FOR FOREIGN AFFAIRS, FINLAND

It is not right that Russians can travel to Europe to enjoy the freedoms here while Russia bombs the Ukrainians

Calling for a EU ban on Russian tourist visas

HT

New conflict in Ethiopia can become a global problem

As conflict returns to Ethiopia after a fragile peace of four years — a devastating civil war started in 2020 and ended only in 2022 after the Pretoria Agreement was signed in November 2022 — and threatens to widen, it is important to remember what is at stake here. One, Ethiopia is part of the Horn of Africa; its proximity to the Red Sea — one of the most important corridors for global maritime trade — means a wider conflict here can potentially disrupt global commerce further even as the Strait of Hormuz stalemate continues. And two, given the nature of the conflicts in the broader region, including parts of West Asia, the threat of deepening radicalisation can't be completely eliminated.

Ethiopia is currently witnessing fighting in its Tigray province that borders Eritrea, renewed tensions in Amhara, and the formation of an extraordinary alliance of armed groups opposed to Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed's government. What makes the situation particularly dangerous is that the old battle lines have shifted, and regional alignments around Ethiopia have been redrawn.

Gurjit Singh

The Pretoria Agreement, signed under the African Union (AU)'s auspices, provided a framework for ceasefire after the two-year civil war, but did not settle fundamental questions such as the status of Western Tigray, displacement rooted in the war, and the mistrust between the federal government and the Tigrayan leadership. In May 2026, the Tigray People's Liberation Front (TPLF) reasserted political authority and control in the region, while Addis Ababa accused it of violating the peace agreement.

A striking feature of the current crisis is the shift in Ethiopia's internal alliances. During the earlier war, the federal forces fought alongside Amhara militias against the TPLF. After the war, Abiy's attempt to dismantle regional special forces and strengthen federal authority alienated sections of the Amharas, fanning a separate insurgency in the province. Meanwhile, the Oromo Liberation Army has continued its armed struggle in Oromia.

Now, seven armed groups, including the TPLF and the Amhara Fano National Movement, have announced the Ethiopian Peoples' Forces Alliance for Survival, seeking to remove Abiy's government. The coalition includes groups from Oromia, Afar and Benishangul-Gumuz. Forces that fought each other during the last civil war are now allied. At its heart is the unresolved tension between Ethiopia's federal structure, based substantially on ethnic and regional identities, and Abiy's effort to create a stronger, centralised national order.

The regional dimension further complicates the situation. Eritrea, which fought alongside Abiy against the TPLF in the earlier war, is now at odds with Addis Ababa. The relationship deteriorated after Eritrea was excluded from the Pretoria settlement and as Abiy increasingly asserted Ethiopia's interest in obtaining access to the Red Sea. Asmara views Ethiopia's sea-access ambitions with suspicion. Ethiopia, on the other hand, has accused Eritrea of supporting armed groups, including Fano. The accusations demonstrate how Ethiopia's internal conflict is becoming entangled with the strategic contest over the Red Sea.

In the larger Red Sea region, Egypt has another set of calculations. Its principal strategic concern remains the Nile and the Grand Ethiopian Renaissance Dam. The dam's inauguration has not resolved the dispute between Addis Ababa and Cairo over water management and downstream security. So, Egypt has cultivated closer relations with Ethiopia's regional rivals. Now at the Alamein consultations, Egypt led Eritrea, Sudan and Somalia in aligning on curbing Ethiopian ambitions on several counts.

Sudan, similarly, adds another layer of instability. Its civil war has provided space for arms networks, refugees, and armed actors to move across the Ethiopia-Sudan border: the conflict in the two countries could increasingly interact rather than remain separate.

Gulf States' rivalry may also play a role. The UAE rivalry with Saudi Arabia prompted Abu Dhabi to build a relationship with Addis Ababa. At the same time, it has strategic and commercial interests across the Red Sea and the Horn, as well as Sudan and Somaliland. Gulf powers have their own interests, and their relationships often cut across African rivalries.

Where, then, do African institutions fit in? The AU has called for immediate restraint and direct talks. The Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD) has called for immediate return to the Pretoria framework, while urging neighbouring States not to contribute to escalation. The problem is regional organisations can mediate only when their members have sufficient political convergence; the Horn today is characterised by precisely the opposite.

Ethiopia now needs a political settlement that addresses the federal question, disputed territories, regional security forces, displaced populations and the relationship between the centre and Ethiopia's constituent regions. At the same time, the country's neighbours must resist turning Ethiopian divisions into another arena for regional competition.

Gurjit Singh is an author and a former Indian ambassador to the African Union. The views expressed are personal

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PRINTED & PUBLISHED BY MANHAR KAPOOR for and on behalf of HT Media Ltd. 18-20, Kasturba Gandhi Marg, New Delhi-110001 and printed at HT Media Ltd. Presses at Plot No.-8, Udyog Vihar, Greater Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar. (UP). Pin-201306.
BOARD: (011) 23361234 ● EDITORIAL: (011) 66561234 Extn. 1254, 1268 ● CIRCULATION: (011) 66561111 ● ADVERTISING: (011) 66561389 ● FAX: (011) 66561270.

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WORLD

US may have gone too far in killing Iran's leaders: Trump

HTC and Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON/NEW DELHI: US President Donald Trump said on Monday (local time) that the has hit Iran so hard militarily that it may have created a new problem: there is nobody left in Iran's leadership whom the US knows how to negotiate with.

Speaking about the impact of US strikes at a campaign rally in Youngstown, Ohio, Trump said Iran had suffered devastating losses to its naval forces and political leadership. "They're right now resting beautifully at the bottom of the sea, every single one of them," Trump said, referring to Iranian ships.

He said Iran had been left without significant military capabilities or leadership. "They got no ships. They got no nothing. They got no leaders even. That's the problem. We might have gone too far with the leaders because we don't know who the hell we're dealing with anymore," Trump said.

Trump also said Iranian officials were reluctant to assume leadership positions and potential successors were unwilling to take charge.

"Nobody wants to be the president of Iran," he said, before adding that the US was having difficulty determining whom to engage with. "We're having a hard time figuring out who the hell to deal with, to be honest with you. I think we went too far...Could have stopped it level one, level two. And level two and a half was probably going too far," Trump said.

In a Truth Social post late on Monday, he said that he did not believe that China and Russia were helping Iran "at all," adding that Moscow and Beijing had "too much to lose" if they enabled Tehran, Reuters reported.

Trump said in his post that he had seen comments from his critics and opponents that China and Russia were helping Iran.

"If they are, it's at a very low level, but I don't believe they are at all. They have too much to lose, and we would know about it, and know about it very fast," Trump wrote.

Trump said in July he trusted China and Russia not to help Tehran in the Iran war, but warned that if they did get involved "it would be very bad for them."

The US and Iran have been at war since February 28. US-Israeli strikes on Iran and Israeli attacks on Lebanon have since killed thousands and displaced millions.

Trump has previously described Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin as "neutral" during the Iran war.

Iranian drone attacks on CIA facilities in the Gulf have prompted US intelligence analysts to investigate whether Russia provided targeting information or advanced drone technology. European foreign ministers pressed the case in a March meeting with US Secretary of State Marco Rubio. The Washington Post and the Wall Street Journal that month reported that Russia was providing Iran with targeting information.

Moscow and Beijing maintain close ties with Tehran. Russia has said the Iran war could lead to a nuclear arms race in West Asia. Beijing has condemned Washington's attacks on Tehran as a brazen violation of Iran's sovereignty.

Last month, Trump warned Xi against providing support to Iran when the Chinese leader visited Washington, and received assurances that China would not do so, the US ambassador to China said at the time.

The warning came amid reports that China had supplied Iran with shoulder-fired air-defence missile launchers and that Tehran had found ways to evade sanctions on its oil sales with Chinese help.

US President Donald Trump at a campaign rally in Youngstown, Ohio on Monday. AP

Trump asks his Greece envoy to resign over bribery claims

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: Trump appointee Kimberly Guilfoyle, the US ambassador to Greece, has been asked to resign from her post after coming under severe criticism over allegations she has engaged in improper and possibly illegal conduct before and during her tenure in Athens, new White House press secretary Katie Zacharia said Tuesday.

Zacharia, in her first press briefing, said Guilfoyle "has been a wonderful asset to the team, and we wish her well."

The development comes days after reports said that President Donald Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio are "extremely pissed off" by Guilfoyle's reported conduct and will likely decide on her future this week.

Kimberly Guilfoyle

In a series of stories dating to late last month, The Wall Street Journal has reported questionable conduct by Guilfoyle, including an alleged threat to a host country official, accepting improper gifts and services and offering to use her influence inside the administration in return for the payment of a large credit card bill.

In a statement late Sunday, Guilfoyle's lawyers denied she had done anything wrong. In late September, WSJ reported that Guilfoyle had told guests at a reception that the US could undermine the Greek government if it chose to, promoted the business interests of one particular Greek construction and energy company, and allowed its lobbyist into private diplomatic meetings. While Rubio was in Athens, the Journal reported — citing text messages — that Guilfoyle had asked a Trump donor and supporter to pay a $100,000 credit card bill just before her confirmation hearing, promising him access to administration officials if he did.

No link between diesel deal, war stance: Russia

Reuters
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MOSCOW: The Kremlin said on Tuesday that it did not see any direct link between a deal on exporting Russian diesel to the United States and Moscow's own stance on the Ukraine peace talks.

It was commenting on a Reuters source-based story, which reported that US President Donald Trump's envoys had told Ukrainian officials on Friday that the deal to allow Russian diesel exports was part of an attempt to draw Russia back into negotiations over a possible peace settlement in Ukraine.

"I don't see any direct connection here," Kremlin spokesman Peskov told a daily conference call with reporters.

"This is in fact a highly mutually beneficial area of Russian-American cooperation. It serves the interests of the United States, the global energy markets, and the Russian Federation. That is why it is happening."

Substantive negotiations to end the war have stalled, and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio said on Thursday that he believed the conflict had reached a dangerous stalemate even as he pledged that Washington would keep working to try to find a way to end the fighting.

Peskov also rejected European criticism of the diesel deal as "cynical", given that Europe continued to buy some Russian oil and liquified natural gas.

Russia still supplies a small portion of oil to Slovakia and Hungary via Ukraine through the Soviet-built Druzhba pipeline.

"Russia is supplying its competitive commodities to global markets, and we will continue to do so," Peskov said.

The Kremlin also said on Tuesday that contacts about the energy ceasefire between Russia and Ukraine which Trump announced on Sunday were continuing, but that it had nothing more to say on the matter for now.

Peskov did not specify who Russia was talking to about the ceasefire.

Trump's surprise announcement, which he said was "effective immediately," took Ukraine by surprise according to President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, and Russia has not said whether it was informed about Trump's announcement beforehand or not.

Russia's defence ministry said on Tuesday its forces had not hit any Ukrainian energy-related targets in their overnight attacks.

An apartment building hit by a Russian strike in Kharkiv. REUTERS

11 missing after ships struck off Bulgaria in latest Black Sea hit

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

SOFIA: Eleven people were missing after two merchant ships were struck off the Bulgarian coast on Tuesday in the latest sign of increasing spillover from the Ukraine war in the Black Sea.

Bulgarian Prime Minister Rumen Radev summoned the Russian ambassador after drones struck a Ukrainian-owned cargo ship, while another vessel was also hit and sank further north off the coast of the Nato and EU member.

Black Sea shipping has been hit by growing fallout from the Ukraine-Russia war in recent months.

Radev said the Ukrainian-owned cargo ship Chelsea 3 was "hit by three aerial drones", and shortly afterwards another ship was "struck" and sank.

"We lack solid, clear evidence to level accusations against any specific party; however ... logic suggests the outcome works to the advantage of the Russian Federation," he wrote, calling the attack "unacceptable".

The presidency later identified the sunken ship as the HS Dignity, a Guinea-Bissau flagged cargo vessel.

Rescued crew members in Varna, Bulgaria. REUTERS

Elon Musk

Musk harassing European leaders online, says France

PARIS: French foreign minister Jean-Noel Barrot Tuesday accused Elon Musk of "massive online harassment campaigns against European leaders aimed at influencing national debates by exploiting the viral nature of his social network" in the context of foreign interference in polls. AFP

Cornell suspends frat parties after alleged gang rape

NEW YORK: Cornell University suspended fraternity social events for the academic year, it said Tuesday, following outcry over an alleged gang rape in 2024 at one of the all-male clubs. AFP

AI helps British lawmaker find voice in House

LONDON: House of Lords peer Jane Campbell, who struggles to speak due to spinal muscular atrophy, on Tuesday got permission and used AI to recreate the sound of her voice, as it used to be, to read a speech she wrote herself. AFP

NYT, Economist among 40 in AI copyright group

PARIS: Forty major media groups including NYT, The Economist and AFP joined a global coalition of publishers seeking to prevent AI firms from using their content without permission. The group already includes BBC and AP news agency. AFP

New WH press secy's debut heavy on Trump praise, light on queries

Agence France-Presse
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: New White House Press Secretary Katie Zacharia made her briefing room debut Tuesday by taking remarkably few questions from journalists while leaving no doubt who she believes has all the answers — Donald Trump.

"I get to do what I was doing on the outside already, which was hoping to amplify, multiply and expand upon President Trump's incredible agenda for the American people," she said, describing her vision for the job.

Zacharia, a 41-year-old devotee of the Maga movement, is taking over the White House communications role just as Republicans face warnings of heavy defeat in upcoming midterm elections. Little known to the general public, Zacharia opened her first session at the famous briefing room podium by reading — at a notably slow pace — a lengthy list of what she said were achievements under the "energetic" leader.

Katie Zacharia

These types of initial roundups, dubbed "toppers" in White House press lingo, are usually followed by a long question-and-answer session in the packed room — often extending to dozens of questions. But Zacharia took questions from just three reporters, starting with right-wing website Breitbart.

The next questions went to Fox News, one of the key pillars of Trump's media support, and to the Daily Mail tabloid website.

With that, after just 15 minutes, Zacharia declared the briefing finished and walked out, pursued by the sound of reporters shouting unanswered questions.

"I thought she was very good," Trump, known to enjoy watching his staffers' performances on television, later told reporters.

Zacharia did make one piece of news, announcing that Trump had sacked his ambassador to Greece after a bribery scandal.

Asked if the demanding job would impact her personal life, Zacharia described how her family of four children was adapting.

But she slipped up, triggering ripples of laughter, when she referred to "my president, excuse me, my husband."

ANTHROPIC WARNS OF AI 'WORMS' SPREADING ACROSS SMART GADGETS

SAN FRANCISCO: Small AI models may be only months away from being able to behave like a computer worm, copying themselves from one internet-connected gadget to the next without human help, Anthropic said.

The research, posted on an Anthropic blog late Monday, comes as tech companies race to build ever more powerful AI directly into phones, laptops, cars and household devices, rather than running it only in distant data centres.

A computer worm is malicious software that spreads between machines on its own. Researchers at Anthropic said an AI version would no longer need powerful data centres to operate. Instead, it could run on networks of cheap, poorly secured consumer devices such as smart TV boxes and kitchen appliances. AFP

Nasa rover breaks record for off-planet driving on Mars

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

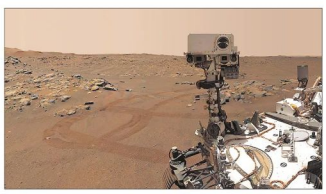
WASHINGTON: While no person has ever set foot on Mars, humankind has managed to conduct extensive explorations of the surface of Earth's planetary neighbor using robotic rovers. One of them, Nasa's six-wheeled Perseverance rover, has now set a record for the longest distance driven by any vehicle on a world beyond Earth.

Nasa announced that the car-sized Perseverance has trekked 45.2km since arriving on Mars roughly 5-1/2 years ago, passing the distance mark previously established by another Nasa rover, Opportunity, from 2004 to 2018. Perseverance and Opportunity both also beat the driving distances of any rover that operated on the moon.

Perseverance, carrying a suite of scientific instruments, has searched for evidence of ancient microbial life on Mars — a planet that long ago was wetter and warmer than the cold and desolate place it is today — and collected rock and soil samples for a potential future return to Earth.

Since landing on February 18, 2021, Perseverance has driven in and around Jezero Crater, an area in the Martian northern hemisphere believed to have been flooded with water and home to a lake basin billions of years ago.

Nasa said the rover achieved its milestone on Sunday.



Perseverance has trekked 45.2km since arriving on Mars in 2021.

Mauritius declares curfew after worst riots in 3 decades

Bloomberg
letters@hindustantimes.com

PORT LOUIS: Prime Minister Navinchandra Ramgoolam of Mauritius, an Indian-ocean island nation best known for its white-sand beach resorts, declared a curfew after the worst riots since 1999.

The curfew began at 8.30pm local time on Tuesday. It will end at 6am on Wednesday, he said in a televised address.

Demonstrations that erupted last week over water shortages and living costs escalated on Monday after the police shot and injured a 27-year-old woman on October 9. The protests almost three decades ago came amid demands for cannabis to be decriminalised.

"There is a group of people who are inciting hatred and violence," he said. "Their goal is to encourage tension in the country, to trouble public order and peace."

Earlier the main business lobby group urged companies to allow staff to work from home. Schools were shut and will remain closed on Wednesday.

"This time again, as in 1999, the police are the main target," Jocelyn Chan Low, a historian and political analyst, said in an interview. "The scale of the violence has multiplied, with police stations and vehicles set ablaze."

While African countries ranging from Morocco and Kenya to Madagascar have been hit by riots overs costs, power shortages and unemployment over the last two years, unrest in Mauritius is unusual.

The archipelago, which relies on tourism and financial services to fund its economy, is Africa's second-richest nation per capita after the Seychelles. It has held peaceful elections since independence from the UK in 1968. Still, the West Asia war has driven up fuel prices and a crippling drought has emptied reservoirs, resulting in water-use restrictions in some areas.

{ GREG GIANFORTE } GOVERNOR OF THE U.S. STATE OF MONTANA

'We need multi-yr India farm contracts'

Montana governor Greg Gianforte has just returned to the US from a trade mission to India, a trip that drew a wave of online abuse amid a broader rise in anti-Indian sentiment in the US. In an interview to Shashank Mattoo, Gianforte brushed off the backlash, saying the visit had made significant progress despite the noise. He pitched India on buying more of US farm produce, while inviting Indian tech and pharma firms to set up shop in his state.

Could you tell us what you're bringing home from the trade mission to India?

India buys lentils, peas, and chickpeas from us — we're the largest producer of these products in North America. India also buys commercial aircraft parts that are manufactured here. The two economies are very complementary.

India brings scale, technology, talent, and capital. Montana brings pulse crops, critical minerals, photonics, quantum expertise, and a fast-growing economy.

So the purpose of this trip was to deepen existing relationships and find new opportunities.

India has agreed to open up some of its agricultural sector to US exports as part of a US-India trade deal. What exactly are Montana's farmers looking for?

Certainty. Agriculture is a $6.2 billion industry in Montana. The central ask for us on this trip to our buyers in India was: we want fair and stable market access. If a farmer doesn't know beforehand whether there's going to be a market for the crop, he's not going to plant it. So we need predictable market access — which might mean multi-year contracts. With other foreign markets — China excepted — we have long-term relationships.

What sort of firms and sectors in India showed an interest in investing in Montana?

I'll highlight three. The first is bioscience. Indian biotech and pharma firms looking to expand into the US can use Montana clinics for trials in a way that's not available in any other state. This will dramatically lower the cost of entry to the marketplace.

Greg Gianforte

Number two is agri-tech. We have some upcoming visits from Indian agri-tech businesses looking at establishing a presence here in Montana. And the third is aerospace and advanced manufacturing. Boeing has a presence here in Montana. We visited the Boeing facility in Bengaluru. Janicki (Industries) just located here. They're going to hire 2,000 people making aircraft parts.

There has been an outpouring of anti-Indian sentiment online recently, much of it coming from America. How does this impact what you're trying to do?

We were there for one purpose, and that's to further Montana's interests in a way that benefits both India, Montana and the US. Frankly, in today's environment, you can't do anything without getting a little bit of pushback. But I'm confident that we made good progress. We deepened existing relationships and we made new ones.

One recent concern about Indian firms and talent has revolved around moves by the Trump administration to restrict immigration to the US. How do you square the two?

Indian students in our universities represent the second highest population of any foreign nation, second to Canada. I was really pleased to visit IISc in Bengaluru and it turns out the gentleman who heads our photonics work at Montana State University graduated from IISc. So again, these bridges have been built. There's always going to be a little noise around the process, but this is a solved problem.

TWO MALDIVIAN PILOTS ARRESTED IN THE UAE OVER FLYDUBAI ATTACK

Press Trust of India
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DUBAI: Two Maldivian pilots employed by flydubai have been arrested by UAE police in connection with an alleged attempt by an Omani co-pilot to hijack and crash a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight, in which Indian Captain Smit Machchhar was injured while foiling the suspected plot, according to media reports.

The duo were taken into custody on October 3, and their families have been formally informed of their detention by the Maldivian Embassy in the UAE, Maldivian portal Adhadhu reported. Maldivian authorities declined to comment on the detention of the pilots, it said.

No official details have been released by the UAE authorities regarding the allegations against the detained Maldivian nationals. According to Male-based Mihaaru newspaper, the two male pilots are believed to have interacted with al-Hammami at their workplace and lived in the same building as him.

'LTCG debate healthy, keen to hear views'

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NEW DELHI: Finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday acknowledged the debate over long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax and securities transaction tax (STT), as well as the rupee's recent depreciation, while expressing confidence that private investment in India was reviving.

With preparations for the Union budget for 2027-28 underway, Sitharaman said investors in India and abroad had raised questions about capital gains taxation and the treatment of different asset classes, but declined to indicate whether the government would make changes.

"It's healthy to have this debate, and I will be keen to hear them," she said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum.

On the rupee, Sitharaman acknowledged that the currency had depreciated significantly over the past one-and-a-half to two years. She said the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) was seeking to curb volatility rather than defend a particular exchange rate. "They are not trying to fix the rupee; they are trying to stop the volatility," she said, adding that the efforts would continue.

Nirmala Sitharaman, finance minister. PTI

She attributed much of the pressure on the currency to external challenges, while maintaining that India's macroeconomic fundamentals remained sound. The government would maintain fiscal discipline without compromising spending on welfare, education and healthcare, she said.

Sitharaman also expressed confidence that private investment was picking up, with domestic companies strengthening their balance sheets and attracting capital into sectors such as renewable energy, semiconductors, pharmaceuticals and aviation.

"Today I can say with confidence that private capital is moving in. India's domestic private capital is moving in, and it's also attracting private capital from elsewhere," Sitharaman said, adding that companies were investing in sectors that could be within or outside their core areas of activity.

India had gone through a difficult phase after 2013-14, when poor asset management and companies' inability to repay loans weakened corporate and banking balance sheets. The government subsequently undertook banking-sector reforms, while companies reduced debt and cleaned up their balance sheets, she said.

INVESTMENT CALLS GETTING TOUGHER NOW, SAYS BIRLA

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Billionaire Kumar Mangalam Birla said multiple global crises have made investment decisions tougher for his metals-to-retail empire that generates over a third of its business overseas.

"You either grow or you go down; you can't stay in a state of equilibrium," the chairman of the Aditya Birla Group said at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi Tuesday. "We've been constantly investing as well in our existing and in new businesses because you can't stop growing."

Global businesses face a volatile environment marked by unpredictable US tariff and trade policies, the Middle East war, as well as shifting demand across major economies and sectors.

The Aditya Birla Group operates across 41 countries and generated $72 billion in revenue in the year ended March. As of June, it derived 42% of its sales from outside India.

Stocks take off as FM's remarks lift investor sentiment

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MUMBAI: Indian stocks rallied on Tuesday, with the Nifty posting its biggest gain in over two months, after finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman said the government would hear investors' views on capital gains taxation. Her remarks lifted sentiment in a market battered by sustained foreign selling, though no policy change was signalled.

The Nifty rose 1.6% to close at 22,721.95, its biggest single-day percentage gain since 3 August. The Sensex gained 1.5% to settle at 73,033.78, its strongest rise since 15 April. The rally came after the Nifty fell in eight of the previous nine weeks on heavy foreign investor selling.

Speaking at the Bloomberg New Economy Forum in New Delhi on Tuesday, Sitharaman said Indian and foreign investors had raised questions about long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax, the securities transaction tax (STT) and whether different asset classes should be taxed on a similar footing.

"The finance minister's comments have certainly brought some cheer to the market," said Feroze Azeez, joint CEO of Anand Rathi Wealth. While she had not indicated any decision on LTCG or STT, the government's willingness to hear industry views was encouraging, he said.

Taxation is an important consideration for foreign investors, particularly when competing Asian markets do not levy capital gains tax on equity investments.

Any rationalization could encourage greater long-term foreign participation, Azeez added.

The Nifty is down about 13% in 2026, putting it on track for its first annual decline in 11 years, as foreign investors sold $32 billion worth of Indian equities. Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) were net sellers of ₹1,305 crore on Tuesday, while domestic institutional investors (DIIs) were net buyers of ₹2,439 crore, according to provisional BSE data.

Nifty rose 1.60% to 22,721.95, marking its best single-day gain in two months. REUTERS

The Union budget in July 2024 raised the LTCG rate on listed equity shares and equity-oriented mutual funds held for more than a year to 12.5% from 10%.

"Although the remarks did not signal a policy change, they raised hopes of a possible reassessment of a tax that has been a point of concern for investors," said Ponmudi R, CEO of Enrich Money, a Securities and Exchange Board of India-registered online trading and wealth-tech firm.

Azeez cautioned against viewing taxation as the sole driver of market performance. Improving sentiment towards information technology stocks, some recovery in the rupee and easing bond yields had also contributed to the positive mood. Crude oil prices, global interest rates and corporate earnings would remain important in determining whether foreign investors return, he said.

IT led Tuesday's rally, with the Nifty IT rising 5.2%, the most among NSE sectoral indices.

UPI fee rollout deferred until after Diwali

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NEW DELHI: The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), which operates India's retail payments and settlement systems, on Tuesday deferred the implementation of a 0.4% merchant discount rate (MDR) on select UPI transactions above ₹2,000, just two days before the scheduled rollout.

The deferment is temporary, and a fresh implementation date will be announced after Diwali.

"The UPI and Services Steering Committee today decided that, keeping in mind the festive season, the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on select Person-to-Merchant (P2M) UPI transactions shall be implemented immediately post-Diwali, on a date to be notified separately," Mumbai-based NPCI said in a statement.

A circular issued by NPCI last month had set an MDR of 0.4% on select P2M payments above ₹2,000 made through popular UPI apps such as Paytm, PhonePe and Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM), with implementation scheduled for October 15. NPCI had clarified that merchants, not consumers, would pay the fee. The levy was also capped at ₹300 for transactions of ₹75,000 or more.

The decision drew sharp criticism from some trade bodies and Opposition parties, which called it a tax and warned that it could push people towards cash payments. They argued that merchants would pass on the additional cost to customers rather than absorb it.

As per the September 15 circular, person-to-person payments were to remain free. For essential services such as railways, telecom, fuel and insurance, the MDR was capped at a flat ₹5 per transaction above ₹2,000.

To address concerns among petrol pump dealers, NPCI issued frequently asked questions (FAQs) explaining how MDR would apply to fuel purchases made through UPI.

The deferment came just two days before the rollout. MINT

"Fuel purchases made at petrol stations via UPI qualify for the flat concessional rate of ₹5 for payments over ₹2,000. The flat ₹5 fee protects petrol pump operators from high processing fees on tank refills. For all fuel payments under ₹2,000, the MDR remains at 0%, ensuring everyday commuter refuelling is completely charge-free, while fuel station operators are not subject to any MDR on such transactions," the FAQ said.

India SME Forum president Vinod Kumar welcomed the deferment, calling it a "wise and timely decision" and commending the government for recognising the need to protect micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) during the festive season. "Our survey of 7,497 enterprises underscores why this matters. Over 97% of respondents said UPI had helped increase sales or prevent customer loss, while nearly 93% reported improvements in cash flow or collections. UPI has become an essential part of how small businesses sell, collect payments and grow," he said.

The survey also highlighted the sensitivity of these enterprises to additional costs. Nearly 48% of respondents said they would add the proposed charges to product or service prices, while almost 32% said they would encourage customers to pay cash.

Chandra backs long-term semiconductor bets

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feedback@livemint.com

Tata Sons Pvt. Chairman Natarajan Chandrasekaran said the group will keep building what India and the world need, including semiconductor chips, even if these projects are slow to deliver amid a tussle with owners who are pressing for quicker returns.

The group's semiconductor push shouldn't be judged on whether it meets the numbers in two to three years, he said at Bloomberg's New Economy Forum in New Delhi on Tuesday.

"Direction is certain, need is certain, ability to execute is certain," Chandrasekaran said. Chips will be fundamentally required, and advanced manufacturing is here to stay, he said, adding that India has the talent, the market and the ability to step up. His defence of nation-first projects — which has helped win Chandrasekaran the government's goodwill — comes as the group's controlling shareholders reassess capital allocation. Tata, the nearly 160-year-old group that posted $185 billion in revenue last fiscal, has made a $120 billion wager on future growth, including India's first chip-making unit seen as key to the country's high-tech manufacturing push.

Noel Tata, chairman of Tata Trusts, has clashed with Chandra, as he's widely known, in board meetings in recent times over capital allocation decisions and projects that can show returns on a swifter timeframe. Tata Trusts owns about 66% of Tata Sons — holding company of the sprawling group behind brands such as Jaguar Land Rover, Air India, Taj hotels and Tetley tea.

N. Chandrasekaran, chairman, Tata Sons. REUTERS

Tata Technologies Pvt., which is building India's first large-scale chip fab or production plant, has faced operational and technology-access delays, people familiar with the matter have said earlier.

Chandra acknowledged a rough run, citing an air crash, a cyberattack and supply-chain disruptions, but said the group still delivered double-digit growth, with margins holding up. Past decisions have "all been proved right in the long term," he said, and when things go wrong, "you course-correct." On the path ahead, he said: "We can't be reckless."

Mumbai-NMIA flight shift pushed to 2027

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NEW DELHI: The proposed partial shifting of international flights from Mumbai airport to Navi Mumbai International Airport (NMIA) has been deferred until the summer schedule beginning March 2027, following discussions between airport operator Adani Airports Holdings Ltd (AAHL) and airline representatives on Tuesday, an official aware of the development said.

AAHL, which owns both airports, had asked airlines to shift 33% of their international flights from Mumbai airport to NMIA by October 25, the start of the winter schedule. Mumbai airport had planned to cut 265 weekly international flights from Terminal 2 (T2) from that date, *HT* reported last week. The move was linked to the planned redevelopment of Mumbai airport's Terminal 1 (T1), with the airport operator seeking to redistribute traffic between the two airports. Airlines opposed the proposed transition since the Navi Mumbai is around 35km away from the Mumbai airport and shifting of operations of 33% of international flights require adequate time for planning before execution.

According to a statement issued by Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL), AAHL's top leadership, including director Jeet Adani, and CEO Arun Bansal, assured the airline community at the meeting that disruptions would be minimised and historical slot allocations respected, with no changes to slots during the winter schedule. MIAL said full support would be extended to any airline wanting to shift operations to NMIA.

"With the redevelopment plan shifted to March, airlines are expected to transition their international operations in a phased manner," the official said. "Airlines have also asked AAHL to share its full plan for the redevelopment of T1," he added.

The civil aviation secretary will review the transition plan at a meeting on October 20. AAHL and airline representatives will meet again on October 28 to address any pending issues.

Delhi HC rejects SpiceJet's plea for more time to pay Marans

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NEW DELHI: The Delhi high court on Tuesday dismissed an application filed by Budget airline SpiceJet seeking an extension to deposit the first ₹50-crore instalment towards the ₹144.5 crore owed to Kalanithi Maran and KAL Airways Pvt. Ltd. in their long-running legal dispute and extend the timeline for depositing the subsequent tranche of ₹94.15 crore by 45 days.

A bench of justice Vinod Kumar noted that following high court's March 18 order asking SpiceJet and its promoter to pay ₹144 crore, the airline on July 13 had undertaken to deposit ₹50 crore within 45 days, making August 27 the deadline for the first instalment and the remaining ₹95 crore within 90 days. However, even ₹50 crore had not been deposited. The bench said it could not grant repeated extensions.

"This could court have taken a lenient view in respect of the time limit of second installment, had the petitioner complied with their own undertaking to deposit ₹50 crore with the Registrar General in 45 days. Even this part of undertaking has not been complied with," the bench said.

The bench said it could not grant repeated extensions. PTI

The judge further rejected SpiceJet's plea to submit a property title deed instead of depositing ₹144 crore.

"So far as submitting the original document of property in Gurgaon is concerned, such a request has already been rejected by this court by order dated March 18. Though the property is now unencumbered, this Court is more concerned with the petitioner's own undertaking of depositing ₹50 crores within 45 days. Had the petitioner deposited Rs 50 crores this Court could have entertained the plea of depositing the document of property in Gurgaon as security for permitting the amount of ₹94 crores. However, as the petitioner has not deposited ₹50 crores as per his undertaking, I am not inclined to accept the property as security. Application dismissed," the court said.

A detailed copy of the verdict is awaited.

Kalanithi Maran and KAL Airways Pvt. Ltd was represented by senior advocate Jayant Mehta along with senior partner Nandini Gore and associate partner Sonia Nigam from Karanjawala and Co.

In its application, the airline contended that denying an extension without the release of the second tranche of ₹349 crore could have serious repercussions for its operations. SpiceJet in its application said it was still reeling from the impact of the West Asia crisis and warned that failure to grant additional time could bring its operations to a grinding halt.

Smartphone mkt faces 14-yr Q3 low

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NEW DELHI: For the third consecutive quarter, global smartphone shipments have suffered a substantial and steeper decline, and have breached the lower Q3 numbers in 14 years. The higher cost of components leading to more expensive smartphones, with weakening consumer affordability putting pressure on the overall smartphone market. Tarun Pathak, Counterpoint's Research Director, tells *HT* that India isn't immune, and the worst is still not over. "India's smartphone shipments are expected to decline around 20% YoY in Q3 2026, based on preliminary estimates," he said.

In recent weeks, most smartphone brands have increased the prices of phones that are already on sale, while new phones cost significantly more than their predecessors.

In an Indian context, the Q3 decline comes off a strong base in the same period last year, and this follows an 11% drop in Q2 (that was the lowest Q2 level since 2013). Q1 2026 had also seen a 6% decline.

The report estimates global smartphone shipments will fall 20% in Q3 of 2026. ISTOCKPHOTO

They estimate that as smartphone makers have passed on the higher cost of components to consumers, average smartphone retail prices have increased by 20% so far in 2026.

Pathak points out that memory prices are now up 5X within a year.

"The global smartphone market is currently going through one of the most challenging times. The full brunt from memory crisis was seen in Q3 2026 when the market sharply declined 20%, the weakest third quarter since 2012," he said.

Samsung leads the global market share stakes with 23% share, followed by Apple with 22%. Competition is distant for the two runaway leaders, with Xiaomi (10%), Oppo (9%) and Vivo (8%) following, who have all lost market share due to declining shipments year-on-year.

"Although festive sales begin in October, phone makers typically build channel inventory in Q3 ahead of the festive season. However, higher device prices and subdued demand likely led to more cautious stocking this year," Pathak said, adding that price-sensitive segments faced the greatest pressure, while premium and mid-premium devices remained relatively resilient.

The latest data by Counterpoint Research pegs global smartphone shipments decline at 20% year-on-year in Q3 2026,

Hyundai to put $15.5 bn into India ops by 2032

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NEW DELHI: South Korean Hyundai Motor Group has committed to invest $15.5 billion in India between 2026 and 2032 through a dedicated investment entity, spanning manufacturing capacity expansion, research and development, local supplier development and investments in startups.

In a statement released on Tuesday evening, the group said the investment which will cover both Hyundai Motor India and Kia was discussed during a meeting between executive chair Euisun Chung and Prime Minister Narendra Modi in New Delhi. The investment is expected to create additional employment opportunities across manufacturing, R&D, engineering and supply chains, as per its statement.

The commitment, the group's largest investment pledge for India, comes two years after its automobile unit, Hyundai Motor India, raised ₹27,870 crore through its initial public offering in October 2024. During Hyundai India's first investor day last year in October, the company committed $5.4 billion investment till fiscal year 2030 (FY30).

The latest investment follows a ₹77,500 crore commitment for five years by Japanese auto giant Suzuki earlier in August, underlining the growing interest of global automakers in expanding their presence in India. "India remains one of Hyundai Motor Group's most important and strategic markets globally. The past 30 years have been defined by our commitment to India. This investment reaffirms our commitment to India for the next 30 years and beyond," Chung said in the statement.

{ THE CROSSWORDS }

CRYPTIC CLUES

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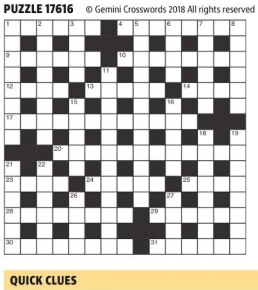

ACROSS

1 Replacing the last of the footlights (6)
4 Fairytale prince given marching order (8)
9 He takes his bow before he performs (6)
10 Second employer (8)
12 Some sugar plum pulled out (4)
13 How one may feel when unemployed or in bed (5)
14 Looking extremely cold and depressed? (4)
17 He deals openly with his clients (6,6)
20 A moneylender might, but it won't appear in his books (4,8)
23 Join with one reservation (4)
24 Hold out for new iron lining (5)
25 Great singer eager for comeback (4)
28 Plant that has done real damage (8)
29 The main worry for the old sailor (6)
30 The original makers of sinks (8)
31 Kidnap tenor (6)

DOWN

1 Perfect though said to lack foundation (8)
2 Again but for the last time presumably (4,4)
3 Not now the capital of Norway (4)
5 It's no use the pair arranging for a decorator (12)
6 The normal thing in government (4)
7 Hard water? That depends (6)
8 Get together and tuck in (6)
11 Drink avoided by most ventriloquists (6,2,4)
15 A fruit of the lemon variety (5)
16 Point always cut off (5)
18 Confuse by suggesting that one should be less calm (8)
19 Tidy flat (8)
21 Temporarily stop working on hedge (3,3)
22 Ladies' man holding ancient city office (6)
26 Take a meal up for the girl (4)
27 Father uplifted after he makes a pile (4)

QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

1 Confirm formally (6)
4 Contemptuous (8)
9 Pen for livestock (6)
10 Taught to a select few (8)
12 Chief part in play (4)
13 Spiteful (5)
14 Lacking cordiality (4)
17 A boost (4,2,3,3)
20 Spotlessly clean (5-3-4)
23 Sympathetic sorrow (4)
24 Sealant for window-glass (5)
25 Rebuff (4)
28 Machination (8)
29 To inconvenience (3,3)
30 Delicate filmy material (8)
31 Of mixed origin (6)

DOWN

1 Foolhardy (8)
2 Pungent culinary herb (8)
3 Unweave at the edges (4)
5 Be very expensive (4,3,5)
6 Rebuke angrily (4)
7 Deep wrinkle (6)
8 Site (6)
11 High fashion (5,7)
15 Chilly (5)
16 Unrefined (5)
18 Unrestricted admission (4,4)
19 Without loss of force (8)
21 Espionage (6)
22 Relative importance (6)
26 Capital of Peru (4)
27 Small and weak (4)

YESTERDAY'S SOLUTIONS (17615)

CRYPTIC

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QUICK

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{ SUDOKU }

DIFFICULTY LEVEL ★★★★

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4			8					3
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	3			6			1	
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2				8				4
	9				3			
3	6	5						

Fill in all the squares in the grid so that each row, column and each of the 9X9 squares contains all the digits from 1 to 9.

GAME ZONE: Scan the QR code for more daily puzzles and brain teasers

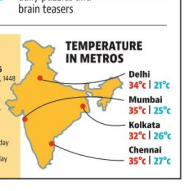
{ WEATHER }

TEMPERATURE ●HIGH ●LOW

WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
Generally cloudy sky	Thunderstorm with rain	Thunderstorm with rain
34°c | 21°c	33°c | 20°c	31°c | 19°c

ALMANAC
Today is
14th October 2026
01 Jumada Al-Awwal, 1448
19, Ashwina, Shukla Paksha, 4 Samvat 2083
Sunset: Wednesday at 05:52 p.m.
Sunrise: Thursday at 06:21 a.m.
Moonrise: Wednesday at 09:44 a.m.
Moonset: Wednesday at 08:01 p.m.

TEMPERATURE IN METROS



Rising rates: How to manage your home loan

When RBI hikes repo rate, floating rate loans reset higher, raising EMI or tenure. To offset this, check your reset date, compare lenders for repricing and prepay when you can

Lisa Pallavi Barbora
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PERSONAL FINANCE

MUMBAI: Rashi and her husband got quite a shock when they realised the principal on their home loan was no longer reducing at the same pace. The loan from a housing finance company had become more expensive, with the interest rate rising from 6.9% to 9.25% per annum, and the tenure had also increased. The young couple had taken the loan during the Covid-19 pandemic for an under-construction property, when the lender was offering a lucrative 6.9%. The loan started in February 2021. In March 2023, just two years later, they found out the cost had gone up significantly without any prior intimation by the lender.

They felt cheated at being kept in the dark. Then, transferring the loan to the private bank where she was working cost them another round of fees and stamp duty. The process was not simple either. It involved multiple interactions, including an entire day of just sitting in the lender's office to get the documents signed for the transfer.

Why did their home loan interest go up 2.35 percentage points?

Between May 2022 and February 2023, RBI increased the repo rate by 2.5 percentage points from 4% to 6.5% — this led to a direct cost increase for long term borrowers like Rashi.

Housing loans as on August end stand at ₹34 lakh crore, 47% of banks' retail loan book (RBI sector wise credit data). Non-banking finance companies (NBFCs) have an existing outstanding of another ₹8.6 lakh crore worth of housing loans. If your home loan is part of this count, it's likely that after last week's repo rate hike, the interest rate on your existing home loan or the one you were planning to take will rise soon. MPC also changed its stance to calibrated tightening, which rules out rate cuts for now.

Repo or repurchase rate is the interest rate at which RBI lends short term money to commercial banks. A repo rate hike hits home-loan borrowers hardest. The interest rate doesn't rise any more than others, but a home loan is on floating rate with built-in rate resets, it's large and for a long period, so even a 25-basis point (each point equal to one percentage point) increase can hurt new borrowers, albeit not immediately. If tenure is increased, it could be an additional year of EMIs for existing borrowers.

According to Adhil Shetty, CEO, BankBazaar, "For borrowers with floating rate home loans linked to an external benchmark such as repo rate, transmission may not be immediate. The loan rate is reset as per lender specified reset cycle, for external benchmark linked loans that's at least once every three months. Older loans linked to MCLR or other benchmarks may follow different reset cycles. For existing borrowers, a rate hike can mean a higher EMI or a longer tenure or both."

But you don't have any control on what RBI will do with interest rates. It helps to check your reset date and understand how the lender will adjust EMI or tenure beforehand.

A prudent approach to home loan

Buying your own home can be an emotionally uplifting decision. At the same time, it is a large financial decision and taking a loan adds additional cost. Even though a loan allows you to fulfil this dream, it's worth considering the impact on cash flows and on your future financial health beforehand.

Outflow check before you sign

Consider the home loan within your existing liability set: do you have other loans on which monthly repayments are going out? Would you be okay to alter your lifestyle — childcare, education, travel retirement contributions etc — if cash flows come under stress from an added monthly outflow? There is also an immediate cash outflow as a down payment. "Borrowers need to account for processing fees, legal and technical charges, stamp duty and registration costs and other mortgage related charges. These vary by lender, state and property value. So, for a ₹50 lakh loan on property that costs ₹65 lakh, a 0.5%processing fee works out to ₹25,000, stamp duty plus registration at 6% adds ₹3.9 lakh. Actual charges may vary," says Shetty. Plus, you'll spend on doing up the interiors and that cost will add up too.

Lastly, it's worth checking your total interest cost across the loan tenure. Sample this: at 8% per annum interest for a 20-year loan, you will likely pay a total interest cost slightly higher than the value of your loan. If it's a 30-year loan, your total interest cost is 1.6 times your principal. The longer your tenure, the higher the cost. There is always the risk of even higher interest if benchmark rates rise during your loan tenure.

Add the loan tenure to your age, if the result is past 60-65 years and the monthly repayment sets you back more than 40% on your monthly income, a strain on current and future financial health is likely to show up.

Your actual vs advertised rate

The advertised rate by a bank or an NBFC is usually the one which comes with the best terms and linked to the highest credit score. Don't base your loan calculations on that rate. Check with the bank or NBFC for the rate they will offer you based on your credit score and history. Anything between a 750-900 can get you lower interest rates and better terms. At a credit score of say 600-699, interest rates offered may be slightly higher and you may not get access to the premium lenders. So, your credit behaviour matters (see this story hindustantimes.com/business/your-credit-score-just-got-more-immediate-101787736552643.html).

If needed you can take a few months to manage your existing loans and cash flows such that you are able to increase your credit score and get better terms.

Audit after you have signed

Review your loan cost once a year or once in two years to ensure that you are not missing out on more attractive interest rates. Rashi had to do it under duress, but ultimately instead of the high 9.25% per annum cost on her home loan, her interest now is 7.35% per annum – which is a significant relief. It's possible your credit score improved in the interim and another lender is willing to offer you better terms or that interest rates went down and you never repriced your loan. Being proactive helps.

"Repricing large sized loans makes sense especially if the remaining tenure is long. But also remember that there may be additional costs involved in the transfer of the loan. Do not forget to calculate that impact beforehand," says Deepali Sen, managing partner, Srujan Financial Services.

Consider pre-paying your loan whenever possible. There can be a significant saving if you are able to build in a good pre-payment discipline (see Table 3)

Lastly, hedge for the worst-case situation — which is your untimely death. A term life policy bought online for an amount equal to the outstanding loan covers the risk. At the least, it will continue to cover your family after the loan is prepaid. The true cost of an unaffordable or tedious home loan experience shows up in sleepless nights, strained relationships and the loss of freedom to change jobs or lead a lifestyle of your choice. Borrow less than the bank will lend you. Make a down payment that doesn't dent your goals, and choose an EMI that doesn't cost you sleep.

Lisa Pallavi Barbora is a freelance writer and author of Money & Her

Rate escape: Deconstructing the surge in borrowing costs

TABLE 1

Home loans are a big part of the retail loan pie

Proportion of total retail loans as on August 2026

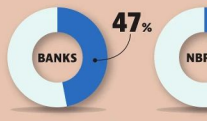

TABLE 2

Your home loan could get more expensive

RBI has raised the Repo rate by **0.25 basis points to 5.5%**.
This will have an impact on your home loan interest rate

Loan Value ₹50 lakh — Increase in EMI if interest rate moves from 8% to 8.25%

Change in ₹

10 year loan	662
20 year loan	781
30 year loan	875

Source: emicalculator.net

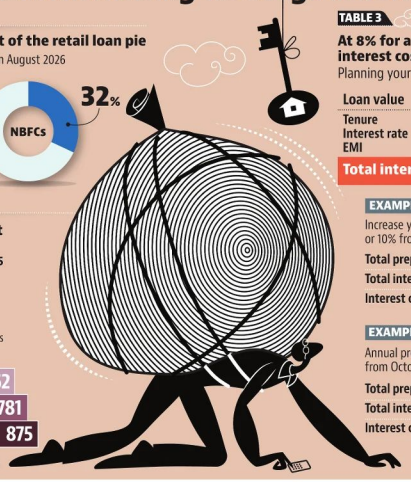

TABLE 3

At 8% for a 20 year loan, your total interest cost will exceed loan value

Planning your pre-payment can reduce cost

Loan value	₹50,00,000
Tenure	20 years
Interest rate	8% per annum
EMI	₹41,822
Total interest cost	₹50,37,281

EXAMPLE OPTION 1

Increase your monthly EMI by ₹4,182 or 10% from October 2027

Total prepayment	₹7,73,982
Total interest	₹40,54,739
Interest cost saved	₹9,82,542

EXAMPLE OPTION 2

Annual prepayment of ₹1 lakh a year starting from October 2027

Total prepayment	₹13,00,000
Total interest	₹33,53,205
Interest cost saved	₹16,84,076

Source: emicalculator.net
Illustration: Huidrom Bikash

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CHANGE OF NAME

I **ANJANI** Gaur W/o Santosh Kumar Gaur Holder of Adhar Num.4739-0644-6442 TF 15 Omicron 3rd Adresh welfare society Greater Noida Have changed My Name Anjani Chauhan to Anjani Gaur for all future purposes.

I, **NARENDRA** Kumar Almadi, S/o Sh. Krishan Lal, R/o 692, Bhai Permanand Colony West, Dr. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi-9, have changed my name to Narender Kumar for all purposes.

I **NITU** Devi W/O Sh Jitesh R/O Qtr No. 9, Indian Army, C/O 56 APO 900477, Roorkee, Haridwar, UK - 247667,I Nitu and Nitu Devi r Same Person, Have Changed my Name Nitu to Nitu Devi for future purpose.

I **PERUMPALLI** Ponnamma Nair, R/o Flat no.269A, Pkt-C, Mayur Vihar Phase-II, Delhi-110091 have changed my name to Mrs P.P. Nair for all my future purposes.

I, **ANIL** Kumar S/o Sh Chunni Lal R/o 1030/8 Mehrauli New Delhi - 110030 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Anil K Arora in my minor son namely Vaibhav Arora aged 17 years in his CBSE Class 10th Educational documents. The actual name of mine is Anil Kumar.

I, **INDRESH** Peelwan W/o Sh. Harish, R/o Gali No. 2, Gurjar Colony, Dadri (Gautam Budh Nagar) - 203207, have changed my name to Indresh Devi for all future purposes.

I, **MEENA** Gahlot, R/o H. No. 70, Kakrola, Delhi, have changed my name to Meena for all purposes.

I, **ANAND** Kumar, S/o- Shiv Mangal R/o- Rz-A4/251, Gali No-A-4, Durga Park, Nasirpur, South West Delhi-110045, have to declare that my earlier name was Ram Sanjiwan, according to all educational/ Property/ Govt records/ Banks, Now changed my Name as Anand Kumar, both names belong to same person.

I, **HEMANT** Koli S/o Parmanand, R/o H.No. 5350, Laddu Ghati Paharganj, New Delhi-110055, declare that in my Caste Certificate my name is incorrectly mentioned as Hemant Kumar instead of Hemant Koli. My actual and correct name is Hemant Koli.

I, **INDU**, wife of Parvesh Kumar Goyal, resident of 402, Shree Balaji CGHS, Sector 45, Faridabad, Haryana - 121003, have changed my name from Indu Rani Bala vide Affidavit dated 1st October, 2026, sworn before Notary Public Vinod Kumar, and henceforth I shall be known as Indu Bala for all purposes.

I, **HARISH** Peelwan S/o Sh. Charan Singh, R/o Gali No. 2, Gurjar Colony, Dadri (Gautam Budh Nagar) - 203207 have changed my name to Harish Kumar for all future purposes.

I, **MUKESH** S/o Omprakash Gupta, R/o C-22/4, Street No. 9, Sadh Nagar, Palam, South West Delhi-110045, hereby declare that Mukesh, Mukesh Kumar and Mukesh Kumar Gupta are one and the same person.Henceforth I shall be known as Mukesh Kumar Gupta for all future purposes.

I, **PUSHPA** W/o Late Sanjay Kumar, R/o R-Extension 55, Mohan Garden, Uttam Nagar, Delhi -110059, do here by declare that name of my minor Son is wrongly written as Namit (DOB 01/10/2011) in his School records. the correct name of my son is Namit Kumar. Which may be amended accordingly.

I, **NEELAM,** W/o Sh. Beer Singh R/o C-36-A, Rz, Nh, 19/5, Block-C, Rama Vihar, Village Mohammad Pur Majri, Delhi-110081, have changed my minor son's name from Yash to Yash Prajapati for all purposes.

I, **JAGTAR** Singh (as per Aadhar Card no. 2038-6698-6160), S/o Sh. Didar Singh R/o E-2/207, Ist Floor, Sector-11, Rohini, Delhi-110085 have declared that my name due to written as Jagtar Singh Saini instead of Jagtar Singh. That Jagtar Singh Saini & Jagtar Singh both are the same and one person.

I **JAIDITYA** Narang S/O Devender Narang R/O Flat No-33, Engineers Estate, IP Extention, Patparganj, Delhi-110092 have changed my name from Madhav Narang to Jaiditya Narang for all purposes.

I, **PRASHANT** Kumar Singh S/o Shri Naveen Kumar Singh R/o Village Koriya Patti, Ward No 2, Rupauli, P.S. Lahnaur, Dist. Madhubani, Bihar-847403 have changed my name from Prsant Kumar Singh to Prashant Kumar Singh all future purposes.

I, **PARVESH** Goyal, son of Subhash Chander, resident of 402, Shree Balaji CGHS, Sector 45, Faridabad, Haryana 121003, hereby declare that I have changed my name from Parvesh Goyal to Parvesh Kumar Goyal vide Affidavit dated 1st October 2026, sworn before Notary Public Vinod Kumar, and henceforth I shall be known as Parvesh Kumar Goyal for all purposes.

I, **HITHERTO** known as Jagdeesh Ram S/o Kishan Chand residing at RZ-328, Gali no.19, Tughlakabad extn., New Delhi 110019, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Jagdish Ram.

I **JAGDISH** Kumar S/o Uttam Chand R/o. H.No. SM/93, G.F. NIT-5, Faridabad have changed my name to Jagdish Kumar Mendiratta for all future purposes.

I, **SHYAM** Sundar S/o Late Mam Chand R/o 251 Maidan Garhi , South Delhi - 110068 Have Changed My Name to Shyam Sunder For all future purpose.

I, **SAFIYA** Raqib wife of No-9926845l, Hav Abdul Raqib Unit 5 Ladakh Scouth C/o 56 APO, have changed my name from Safaya Banoo to Safiya Raqib and DOB from 11-05-1985 to 11-05-1984 for all purposes vide Executive Magistrate Leh affidavit dt 12-10-2026.

I **DHARMENDRA** Kumar Singh S/o Kale Ram R/o Flat No 11-A, Pocket-A, Near Tel. Exchange, Mayur Vihar Phase II, Patparganj, East Delhi-110091 have changed the name of my minor son Ayush Raj Choudhury aged 15 years and he shall hereafter be known as Ayush Raj Choudhury

CHANGE OF NAME

I, **SHAILENDER** Singh S/o Late Sh. Hem Singh R/o H.No-CI/8 Jharia Market, Palla No -2, Amar Nagar, Faridabad Haryana- 121003 have changed my minor son's name from Hiten to Hiten Solanki, aged 15th years for all purposes.

I, **HUSAN** Chand aged about 47 years S/o Sh. Lekh Raj R/o Vill. & PO Dhusara Tehsil Amb Distt. Una (HP) do hereby solemnly affirm and declare that my son Saurav, date of birth 15.12.2007 has changed his name Saurav to Sourabh. In future my son will be known as Sourabh for all known to me.

I, **ANIL** Jain R/o 62/16 Basai Road, Sohna Adda Chowk, Bada bazar, \Gurgaon have changed my Name as Anil Kumar Jain.

I, **GULSHAN** Ara, wife of Mohammad Sohrab and daughter of Mohammad Wajul Haque, permanent resident of Village Alakhbani, Vrindawan, Sitabar, PS- Kalyanpur, East Champaran, Motihari, Bihar, India - 845412, and presently residing at B-3, 1904, Cleo County, Sector-121, Noida, Uttar Pradesh - 201301, do hereby solemnly declare that my date of birth is 01-01-1970 and that I have changed my name from Gulshan Ara to Gulshan Begam. Henceforth, I shall be known and identified as Gulshan Begam for all purposes, including official, legal, and personal records.

I **VANDALI** Haridasan Nair, S/o late P.K.Nair, R/o Flat no 269A, Pkt-C , Mayur Vihar Phase-II, Delhi-110091 have changed my name to V .Haridasan Nair for all my future purposes.

I, **ANIL** Kumar Yadav S/o Sh. Nathun Yadav R/o H.No. SNJ 105 Sahid Nagar Jhuggi, (Sanjay Colony Sector-23), Faridabad, Haryana-121005 my name mentioned in my SBI a/c No. 61314923655 as Manib Yadav instead of Anil Kumar Yadav amend accordingly.

I, **NAVNEET** Kumar S/o Sandeep Kumar & Suman Devi R/o H.No. 542F Sector-64, Ballabgarh, Faridabad, Haryana-121004 have changed my name from Navneet to Navneet Kumar for all future purposes. Navneet & Navneet Kumar is the same & one person.

I, **NARAYANAN** Kannan S/O Mr. Kannan R/O 207, Pocket-E, Mayur Vihar Phase-II, Delhi-110091, have changed my daughter's name from Srishti to Sristi Narayanan for all future purposes.

I **FLOREENA** Murugasan D/O, Benny Murugeson R/o 1/243c, Gali No. 2a, Mahavir Enclave, Palam, New Delhi 110045 have changed my name to Floreena Murugeson.

LALITA RAUTELA D/o Is Mathura Singh R/O HNO 67 E Block Goyla Dairy Outuh Vihar phase 1 South West Delhi Chawala, Po Dist South West Delhi 110071 Changed my name Lalita Bora for all future purpose

I, **DHARAMVIR,** S/O Gopal Chand R/o C 273 Phase 2 Nangloi Delhi 110041 have changed my name to Dharamvir from Dharam Vir vide affidavit dated 12.10.26 sworn in the Court of Judicial Magistrate.

I **SACHIN** Kumar S/O Chhaju Ram R/O HNO 5 Gali No A/5 Palam Vihar C2 Ashok Vihar Phase 3 Gurugram Haryana 122002 hereby declare that in my son Bhavyansh Sharma's birth certificate my name is wrongly written as Saiyan Sharma whereas my actual & correct name is Sachin Kumar. Please amend the same in your record.

I, **MOHD** Shahzad S/o Chand Khan R/o H-221, Jaitpur Part-2, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044, have changed my name to Mohammad Shahjade.

I**T IS** for general information that I, Sunil Kumar S/o Devi Singh R/o Plot No. 491, Sector 3, Kingwood Enclave, Wave City, PO Adhyatmic Nagar B.O., Distt. Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh-201015, declare that the name of my minor son has been wrongly written as Shaurya in my minor son namely Shaurya Chaudhary, aged 14 years in his School Record and Birth Certificate No. 09027142596l. The actual name of my minor son is Shaurya Chaudhary, which may be amended accordingly. It is certified that I have complied with other legal requirements in this connection.

I, **MAYANK** Jain S/o Desh Bhushan Jain, R/o Flat No. B-1104, 11th Floor, Exotica Fresco, Plot No. GH05/A, Sector 137, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201304, have changed the name of my minor daughter Avni Mayank Jain, and she shall hereafter be known as Avni Jain and I have complied with all legal requirements in this connection.

I, **SHAILENDER** Singh S/o. Late Sh. Hem Singh R/o H.No-CI/8 Jharia Market, Palla No -2, Amar Nagar, Faridabad Haryana- 121003 have changed my minor son's name from Hitesh to Hitesh Solanki, aged 15th years for all purposes.

I, **RUPESH** Son Of Sh. Hawa Singh Resident Of 99 A N-Block Gopal Nagar Najafgarh South West Delhi-110043, have change my name from Rupesh to Rupesh Yadav d.o.b. 19.11.2006 vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 at Delhi.

I, **MD** Nadeem S/o Sh. Shafi Haider R/o C-422, Street No-4, Old Mustafabad, Delhi-110094 have changed my name from Mohd Nadeem to Md Nadeem for all future purposes.

I, **RUPIKA** Sachdeva W/o Ashok Kumar, R/o 6/382, Sector-6 Raj Nagar, Ghaziabad U.P. 201002, declare that Rupika and Rupika Sachdeva are one & same person, Hereafter I will use my correct name as Rupika Sachdeva for all future purposes.

I **WOULD** like my name, Avneet Kaur, to be recorded against my LIC policy number 11530 3573, whereas my name is recorded as Amarjot Kaur in other documents. Both names belong to me. Amarjot Kaur D/o the late Shri Gurdeep Singh, resident of House No. 88, Govindpuri, Kankarkhera, Meerut.

I **DR** B.S. Anant S/O Likhi Ram, R/O 204, Second Floor, Cc-1, Supertech, Capetown, Sector-74, Noida, U.P.- 201301 have changed the name to Brahm Singh Anant

I, **JYOTI** Daughter of Sh. Hawa Singh Resident of 99 A N-Block Gopal Nagar Najafgarh South West Delhi-110043, have change my name from Jyoti to Jyoti Yadav d.o.b. 25.12.2003 vide affidavit dated 12/10/2026 at Delhi.

CHANGE OF NAME

I, **ANJU** W/o Davinder Kumar, R/o H.No.6, Housing Board Colony, Distt. Palwal have changed my name from Anju Lata to Anju for all purposes.

I **GARGI** Narang D/O Devender Narang R/O Flat No-33, Engineers Estate, IP Extention, Patparganj, Delhi-110092 have changed my name from Priyanka Narang to Gargi Narang for all purposes.

I, **ARYAN,** S/o Manoj Kumar, residing at H. No. 237, Ambedkar Gali, Janta Colony, Circular Road, Shahdara, New Delhi-110032. have changed my name to Aryan Thakur, my father's name from Manoj Kumar to Manoj Kumar Thakur and my mother's name from Kavita to Kavita Thakur. All names refer to the same respective persons.

I **MAMTA** Chauhan W/o Late Mahesh R/o 173, Rai Mandi Kasba Kharera Meerut Cantt Uttar Pradesh-250001 have changed my name to Mamta Chawhan.

I, **AJAY** Kumar S/o Shatrughan Prasad R/o 1/206, Sec- 17, Rohini Sec- 15, Delhi -89, have changed my minor daughter name Gungun to Gungun Yadav for all future purposes

I, **HARISH** kumar S/o Sh. Inder Kumar R/o ID, BG-I, West Shalimar Bagh , Delhi-110088 Have Changed my Minor Daughter's Name from Bhumisha Rohra to Bhumisha for all future purposes

I, **VIKRAM** Singh Gahlot, R/o H. No. 70, Kakrola, Delhi, have changed my name to Vikram Singh for all purposes.

IT IS for general information that I, Meenakshi W/o Laiman R/o H No-101 B Re-2 G-Block Gali No-7 Prem Nagar Najafgarh, Delhi-110043, declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Doli in my minor daughter Laxmi aged 17 years in his 10th and 12th class Educational Documents. The actual name of mine is Meenakshi, which may be amended accordingly.

I, **SHALINI** Khanna W/O Late Satish Khanna, D/O Late Vidyasagar Mahta R/O 982A/9, 2nd floor, Gali 9, Govindpuri, Kalkaji, New Delhi - 110019, declare that Punita Kumari and Shalini Khanna are the names of one and the same person namely myself, and my name for all future purposes is Shalini Khanna.

I **SWATI** Nehra W/O Anil Kumar Nehra R/O B 106, R.K Puram, Govindpuram Ghaziabad 201013 UP have changed my name from Swati Anil Nehra to Swati Nehra for all purpose.

LOST & FOUND

LOST PROPERTY Deed Original Sale Deed dt. 13.03.1958, in the name of Baldev Raj Sawhney, vide Reg. No. 2589 & Reg. dt. 03.04.1958 of Prop. No.D-11/4, Model Town, Delhi, belonging to Mr. Ramnik Narula and Mr. Amit Narula has been lost/misplaced. Finder Contact: 9312276544

I, **SUNIL** Kumar S/O Kishanpal Have Lost Our Firm M/S Ivoland Infrastate LLP Original Old Sale Deeds Missing 14 Nos, Documents Details Below Mentioned(1).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed by Sh.sher Singh,sh. Balbir Singh And Others Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As No. 6579 Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 35 To 38 Registered On 27.09.1985. (2).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi & Others Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As Document No.6581, Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 47 To 51 Registered On 27.09.1985.(3).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi & Others Vs.servisingh Registered As Document No.6585, Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 79 To 83 Duly Registered On 27.09.1985.(4). Sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As Document No. 6556, Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 84 To 88 Registered On 27.09.1985.(5).sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upal Properties (P) LTD Duly Registered Document No. 5323, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 9-16 Registered On 16.07.1993.(6).Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5324, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 17-24 Registered On 16.07.1993.(7) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5322, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 17-24 Registered On 16.07.1993. (8) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttanta Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5326, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 49-57 Registered On 16.07.1993. (9) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttania Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5329, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 58-66 Registered On 16.07.1993.(10) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttanlal Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5330, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 67-75 Registered On 16.07.1993 (11) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5327, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 41-48 Registered On 16.07.1993 Beforesub Registrar - Iii, New Delhi(12) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5326, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 33-40 Registered On 16.07.1993(13) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5325, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 25-32 Registered On 16.07.1993 (14) Sale Deed Executed By Capt. V K Kapoor In Favour Of Smt.shakuntala Devi Videsale Deed Registered As No. 846 In Book I Volume 6310 At Pages 145 To 148 Dated 27.01.1989. All Deeds Situated In Revenue Estate Of Villagesamalka,tehsil Vasant Vihar, New Delhi. If Found Please Return Ivoland Infrastates LLP , Khasra No- 6/23 Min2-08), 24/4-16), 25/1 (1-05), 5/2 Min West (0-11), 6 Min West(0- 14), Etc. , New Delhi , 110037, Contact No. 8527044115

LOST & FOUND

I, **RAKESH** Goel S/o. Sarla Devi lost of Shares Certificates of SRF Limited Under Folio No. 50007539 Certificate No. 1133470 Distinctive no. 2955256341-2955260997 (464 Shares), Certificate No. 491262 Dist. No. 24580403 - 24580432 (20 Shares), Details Below Mentioned(1).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Sh.sher Singh,sh. Balbir Singh And Others Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As No. 6579 Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 35 To 38 Registered On 27.09.1985. (2).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi & Others Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As Document No. 6581 Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 47 To 51 Registered On 27.09.1985.(3).sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi & Others Vs.servisingh Registered As Document No.6585, Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 79 To 83 Duly Registered On 27.09.1985.(4). Sale Deed Dated 27.09.1985 Executed By Smt.lile Devi,smt.sheela Devi Vs.servisingh Duly Registered As Document No. 6556, Book No. 1, Volume No. 5347 On Pages 84 To 88 Registered On 27.09.1985.(5).sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Duly Registered Document No. 5323, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 9-16 Registered On 16.07.1993.(6).Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5324, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 17-24 Registered On 16.07.1993.(7) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Shri Chittranjan Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5322, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 17-24 Registered On 16.07.1993. (8) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttanta Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5326, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 49-57 Registered On 16.07.1993. (9) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttania Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5329, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 58-66 Registered On 16.07.1993.(10) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smttanlal Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5330, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 67-75 Registered On 16.07.1993 (11) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5327, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 41-48 Registered On 16.07.1993 Beforesub Registrar - Iii, New Delhi(12) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD Bearing Document No. 5326, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 33-40 Registered On 16.07.1993(13) Sale Deed Dated 16.07.1993 Executed By Smt Gina Kapur In Favour Of M/S Upaal Properties (P) LTD. Bearing Document No. 5325, Book No. 1, Volume No.7973 On Pages 25-32 Registered On 16.07.1993 (14) Sale Deed Executed By Capt. V K Kapoor In Favour Of Smt.shakuntala Devi Videsale Deed Registered As No. 846 In Book I Volume 6310 At Pages 145 To 148 Dated 27.01.1989. All Deeds Situated In Revenue Estate Of Villagesamalka,tehsil Vasant Vihar, New Delhi. If Found Please Return Ivoland Infrastates LLP , Khasra No- 6/23 Min2-08), 24/4-16), 25/1 (1-05), 5/2 Min West (0-11), 6 Min West(0- 14), Etc. , New Delhi , 110037, Contact No. 8527044115

TENDER NOTICE

TENDER FOR CONFIDENTIAL WORK
A prominent educational institution intends to engage an experienced computer agency for confidential work relating to OMR scanning and result/data processing. Agencies undertaking such work may express their interest by email at **confidentials.office@bseh.org.in** by 18.10.2026

SHAHJAHANABAD
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Plot no.1, Sector-11, Dwarka, Phase - I, New Delhi -110075
Registration No.970 (G.H.) NEW -1983
NOTICE INVITING QUOTATION
Sealed quotations are invited on an "As is Where is Basis" for the disposal of unserviceable, obsolete, and scrap firefighting equipment's/ materials lying at Shahjahanabad CGHS Ltd., Plot no. 01, Sector-11, Dwarka, New Delhi-110075. Interested vendors, scrap dealers and others may inspect the items on any working day upto 14-11-2026 and last date of receipt of quotations upto 03:00 P.M. On 15-11-2026.
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Disclaimer: This advertisement is purely conceptual and is not a legal offering. All visuals, images, and specifications are for representational purposes only and subject to change as per the architect's discretion and statutory approvals. The developer reserves the right to amend plans without prior notice. The project is registered with the Uttar Pradesh Real Estate Regulatory Authority under Registration No. UPRERAPRJ761382/10/2025. For complete details, please visit www.up-rera.in or contact our sales office.
*Terms & Conditions apply. 1sq.mt. = 10.764 sq.ft.
RERA NO: UPRERAPRJ761382/IO/2025
WWW.UP-RERA.IN
PROJECT START DATE: 03/10/2025

PUBLIC NOTICES

HARERA GURUGRAM

PUBLIC NOTICE

FOR INVITING OBJECTIONS REGARDING CONTINUATION OF REGISTRATION OF THE AFFORDABLE PLOTTED COLONY UNDER DDJAY NAMELY

"ASHOK ESTATE"

(HARERA RC NO. 64 OF 2022) SITUATED IN SECTOR-63A, GURUGRAM BEING DEVELOPED BY

M/S ANANT RAJ LTD.

1. The above-mentioned project is registered with the HARERA Gurugram vide registration no. 64 of 2022 dated 18.07.2022 and the registration was valid up to 31.12.2025. Further, an extension of registration of project was granted vide no. 45 of 2025 dated 10.12.2025 which is valid up to 31.12.2026.
2. Now, the promoter has made an application dated 29.09.2026 with the request to the authority that instead of revoking the registration on its expiry, the authority may permit it to remain in force until such further terms and conditions as it thinks fit to impose in the interest of the allottees, and any such terms and conditions so imposed shall be binding upon the promoter.
3. The Authority is considering the application of the promoter to permit the continuation of the registration certificate under Section 7(3) of the Act, 2016 for this project to remain in force and hereby invite objections from the allottees in particular and any other concerned persons in general in this regard.
4. The objections, if any, shall be filed in the registry of the Authority before 28.10.2026 till 11:00 AM and concerned may appear in person before the Authority on 02.11.2026 at 11.00 AM during the hearing failing which the Authority may consider the present application for continuation of the registration of project under Section 7(3) of the Act, 2016.

Given under the approval of the Authority and its seal.

Secretary
For and on behalf of Haryana Real Estate Regulatory Authority, Gurugram

Dated: 13.10.2026

HT
Readers are recommended to make all enquiries and seek appropriate advice before acting on any advertisement appearing in this publication. Any subscriber sending money, incurring any expenses or acting on any medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication, shall do so entirely at his/her discretion, intelligence and risk. The Company, Publisher or any of its employees do not vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of products and services and shall not be held liable for any damages, loss, consequences, suffered by any person on account of relying on such advertisements.

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PUBLIC NOTICES

Notice Regarding refund of amount invested in M Tech Developers Pvt. Ltd.

It is hereby informed to the Customers / Investors of M Tech Developers Pvt. Ltd. that as per order of Hon'ble Delhi High Court and Subsequently South East District Court Saket Delhi, several Advertisements / Public Notices were published earlier regarding refund of invested amount in M Tech Developers Pvt. Ltd. and maximum no of Customers obtained the refund of amount invested.

In compliance to Judgment of Hon'ble Court it is once again informed that customers who could not take the refund till date for any reason, may submit their documents related to the investment mentioning booking / invested amount at email ID **refund.mtech@gmail.com**

The amount shall be refunded as per order of Hon'ble Delhi High Court dated 17.12.2013 after due verification of documents. The original papers shall be required at the time of receiving the payment.

For any information contact on:

Mr. Amit Kumar Jha
(Ex. Director M Tech Developers Pvt. Ltd.)
Phone No. +91 9910381134
Email ID: refund.mtech@gmail.com
(In Compliance to Judgement Dated 11-11-2019 of South East District Court Saket Delhi)

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform the general public that the original Conveyance Deed / Property papers relating to my Residential Plot No. 1709, Sector-A, Greenfield Colony, Faridabad, Haryana, (Area 269.45 sq. yards) have been misplaced / lost in transit. It is further clarified that the said property is free from any loan or mortgage and has not been sold. Anyone who finds the above-mentioned original property documents is requested to kindly contact the undersigned at the following address or mobile number:

Anil Mehrotra, Kalka Public School Campus, Alaknanda, New Delhi – 110019.
Mobile No.: 9811889025

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP./ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT,EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP./AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1.	MUNICIPAL CORPORATION HISAR	CONST OF CC AND IPS STREETS GALI NO 9 AND LINK GALI, GALI 10 AND 11 IN GANDHI NAGAR GALI NO 3 AND 5 MANOHAR COLONY, STREET NO 24 TO 26, CHAUDHARY DEPT STORE WALI GALI LORD RAMA SCHOOL WALI GALI, IN PATEL NAGAR WARD NO 16 MC HISAR + 2 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 22.10.2026	1,78,03,693/-	https:// etenders.hry.nic.in	01662238001 xenmchisar@ gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO No. 13/2027/40/50156/I/19/7

JHRKHAND STATE BEVERAGES CORPORATION LTD. RANCHI
(A GOVT. OF JHARKHAND UNDERTAKING)
Corporate Identification No :-U51228JH2010SGC014519, TIN No – 20520108277
UtpadBhawan, Ground Floor, Near New Police Station, Kanke Road, Ranchi - 833008, E-mail :- jsbcl.jharkhand@gmail.com

E-Tender Notice No :- JSBCL/09 Date- 09.10.2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

SELECTION OF AGENCY FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION, TESTING, COMMISSIONING & COMPREHENSIVE OEM WARRANTY MAINTENANCE OF IT COMPUTER HARDWARE

Office of Managing Director, JSBCL, invites online bids through the Government e-Marketplace (GeM Portal), Bid Number: GEM/2026/B/8144403, Dated: 10-10-2026 from eligible, reputed Original Equipment Manufactures (OEM) or their Authorized Dealers/Hardware Suppliers for the procurement, delivery, site installation, testing, commissioning and OEM Onsite Comprehensive Warrany of Three Years maintenance of IT computer hardware and peripherals under the project titled 'Computerisation of Office of the Managing Director, JSBCL, Jharkhand.

Important dates

S.N.	Particulars	Date	Time
1	Bid End Date/Time	31/10/2026	17:00:00
2	Bid Opening Date/Time	01/11/2026	17:00:00
3	Bid Offer Validity (From End Date).	30 Days	

Note :-

For detailed Detailed tender document and details of terms & conditions please visit website Government e-Marketplace (GeM Portal) and http://jsbcl.in from the dates mentioned above.

Sd/-
General Manager (Operation),
Jharkhand State Beverages Corporation Ltd.
Jharkhand, Ranchi

PR 391679 Excise(26-27)#D

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM - 2

The Deputy Chief Material Manager/ Construction/ Kashmiri Gate, Delhi-110006, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items for and on behalf of the President of India.

PL Code	Field Name	Existing Value	Modified Value
479012234080	Item Description	(Supply)-Design, Manufacture, supply, erection, testing and commissioning of heavy duty elevator for 15 passenger lift (1020 kgs) capacity with speed of 1.0 m/s center opening sliding door double door type, 7 stop and 7 opening in all respects as per RDSO spec no. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016 (Rev-2) - 2025 or latest.	(Supply)-Design, Manufacture, supply, erection, testing and commissioning of heavy duty elevator for 15 passenger lift (1020 kgs) capacity with speed of 1.5 m/s center opening sliding door double door type, 7 stop and 7 opening in all respects as per RDSO spec no. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016 (Rev-2) - 2025 or latest.
47901AMC	Item Description	Comprehensive annual maintenance contract for 10 years after 2 years of warranty period including spares and material of heavy duty elevator for 15 passenger lift (1020 kgs) capacity with speed of 1.0 m/s center opening sliding door double door type, 7 stop and 7 opening in all respects as per RDSO spec no. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016 (Rev-2) -2025 or latest.	Comprehensive annual maintenance contract for 10 years after 2 years of warranty period including spares and material of heavy duty elevator for 15 passenger lift (1020 kgs) capacity with speed of 1.5 m/s center opening sliding door double door type, 7 stop and 7 opening in all respects as per RDSO spec no. RDSO/2013/EM/SPEC/0016 (Rev-2) -2025 or latest.

Deletions

S.No	Document Description	File Name
1	Annexure-I for lift G+4	5927340.pdf

Note:- 1. Detailed information can be seen on the IREPS website i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in**
2. Manual tender will not be accepted.

No.: Dy. CMM/C/NR/ 40265458 Date: 13.10.26 **3568/2026**

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Name of Work and its location	121-SRDEE-G-DLI-2026-27, Balance work of Augmentation of Power Supply system and Provision of Central Air Conditioning system of Boxing Hall at Karnail Singh Stadium, New Delhi.
Approx. cost of the works in	Rs. 8739077.00/-
Address of the office	Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer/General, DRM Office, Delhi Division, Northern Railway, State Entry Road, New Delhi, 110055
Earnest Money	Rs. 174800.00/-
Last Date & time of submission of tender	04.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Opening of tender	04.11.2026, 13.00 Hrs.
Website & notice board	www.ireps.gov.in & Sr. Divi. Elect. Engineer/ General, New Delhi.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3565/26

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
PANKI, KANPUR - 208020
TENDER NOTICE

1. Gem Bid No.-GEM/2026/B/8141487, Implementation of Document Management System (DMS) at 1x660 MW PTEP, Panki, Kanpur.

Estimated Cost: Rs. 8,85,000.00 (With GST)

Earnest Money: Rs. 15,000.00

OPENING DATE OF GeM Bid: 28.10.2026

पत्रांक: 62 / 13560 पी०प०नि० पनकी शिक्षा / मुख्यअभि० / टी0एण्ड0पी0सी0 / विज्ञापन / 2026 दिनांक: **13.10.2026**

"Save Electricity for Nation"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of the President of India, the Deputy Chief Mechanical Engineer (Train Set), Northern Railway Charbagh Workshop, Lucknow invites following e-tender from reputed firms for works as given below: **Tender No. : W-CB-VBE1-Electrical-2026, Name of Work :** Electrical Furnishing Work of Vande Bharat Coaches during SS-3 (As per Scope of Work). **Estimated Cost of Work :** ₹ 1,36,40,400.45/-, **Earnest Money/Bid Security:** ₹ 2,72,800/- only, **Cost of Tender Form :** Rs. 0/- only, **Period of Contract :** 03 Month, **Date & Time for Submission of Tender : from 14.10.2026 to 28.10.2026** up to 15:00 Hrs. **Date & Time for Opening of Tender :** after 15:15 Hrs. on **28.10.2026.** ● The tender form may be submitted on the website **www.ireps.gov.in** from **14.10.2026 to 28.10.2026** (up to 15:00 Hrs.). ● Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, any such mannual offer received shall be ignored. ● Contractors are allowed to make payment against this tender towards tender document cost and Earnest Money/Bid security only cash through e-payment gateway or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. ● The tender will be opened on specified date and time as above. In case the above date is a holiday the tender opening would be conducted at the same times on the next working day. ● No post tender correspondance for submission of additional documents shall be entertained after opening the technical & commercial offers. Even suo-moto post letter of the tender shall be treated as NULL & Void. **Tender Notice No : W-CB-VBE1-Electrical-2026 Date : 12.10.2026** 3562/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

U.P. POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LTD.
Electy. Substation Design Circle-II
13th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Ext., Lucknow

"INVITES-OPEN TENDER (E-TENDER)"

For

Construction of 2x40 MVA, 132KV S/S Jagdishpur, Amethi on turnkey basis against tender specification No ESD-691.

Tender ID: 2026_PTRCL_1195091_1

Bid Portal (download & Submission): www.etender.up.nic.in

Bidding: Online, EMD : Rs. 22,68,000.00

Estimated Cost : Rs. 22.68 Crore (With GST)

KEYDATES :

Online Bid Submission Start : 09.10.2026

Online Bid Submission Closing : 24.10.2026, 12:30 Hrs

Technical Bid Opening : 26.10.2026, 15:30 hrs. Onwards

Bidders are advised to visit e-portel regularly for amendments/ corrigendum etc.

Email: seesdc2@upptcl.org Mobile No 9412632786/8860979344

"Save Electricity for Nation"

R-217, Date-13.10.2026

U.P. POWER TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
Electy. Substation Design Circle-I,
13th Floor, Shakti Bhawan Extension, Lucknow.

INVITES OPEN TENDER (E-Bid)

"Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of 15 Nos. Centralized Type 220kV Bus Bar Protection Panels at Different 220kV Substations of UPPTCL against E-Bid Specification No. SD-1053."

Tender ID: GEM/2026/B/8149913

Bid Portal (Download & Submission): https://bidplus.gem.gov.in

Mode of Bidding: Open E-Bid

EMD: Rs. 4.15 Lakh

KEY DATES (Date/Time may change as per GeM approval):

Online Bid Submission Start: 12.10.2026, 17:30 Hrs.

Online Bid Submission Closing: 02.11.2026, 18:00 Hrs.

Technical Bid Opening: 03.11.2026, 18:00 Hrs. onwards

Note:- Bidders are advised to visit the GeM Portal regularly for amendments/corrigenda, if any.

E-mail: seesdc1@upptcl.org

Contact No.: +91 9415902867

R.No.: 218, Dt. 13.10.2026 "Save Electricity for Nation"

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE

The Sr. Divisional Engineer-I, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

1	Name of work	Upgradation of Yard Loop Line work under ADEN/PNP.
2	Approx cost of work	Rs. 75,17,844.59 (Rupees Seventy Five lakh Seventeen Thousand eight Hundred Forty Four and Fifty Nine Paise Only)
3	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 1,50,400.00/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousand Four Hundred Only)
4	Cost of tender document	Rs. 0.00/-
5	Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	03.11.2026 @ 15:00 Hrs.
6	Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
7	Allocation	04-211-32

● The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. **www.ireps.gov.in** for participating in the e-tender system.
● For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. ● No manual offers are acceptable. **No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/50/2026-27/W-I Dated :- 12.10.2026** 3550/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD
(SURVEY & CONSTRUCTION)
VARIOUS WORKS FOR CONSTRUCTION OF NEW RAILWAY LINE BETWEEN DESHALPAR-HAJIPIR-LUNA

TENDER No. DyCE-C-BHUJ-NL-EPC-02

Dy. Chief Engineer (C) Bhuj for & on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-Tender for the following work: **(1) Name of work:** Construction of New Railway Line between Deshalpar-Hajipir-Luna (82.38 Kms) (including all yards falling in the section) covering all works of Earthwork, Blanketing, Retaining Wall, Toe Wall, Side drain, Construction of Major Bridges, Minor Bridges, RUB/LHS all P. Way works (including Laying and Linking), Supply of all types of Sleepers, P. Way Fittings (excluding Rails, steel girder), other Civil engineering works, Signal, Telecom and Electrical (General Services and TRD) complete Works in Ahmedabad Division of Western Railway in the Gujarat State on EPC basis. **(2) Approx. cost of work:** ₹ 1061,76,40,907.85 **(3) Bid security:** ₹ 21,23,52,800.00, **Type of Tender:** *Two Packet System*, **Completion period:** 2 Years (6 Months)/ 913 Days (including monsoon period), **(4) Closing time & Date: 09-02-2027 at 11:00 AM Hrs.**, **Date & Time for opening of E-Tender: Any time after 11:00 AM Hrs. on 10-02-2027 (5) Website particular and Notice Board Location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office:** Complete details of tender including eligibility criteria are available on Western Railway website www.ireps.gov.in **Office of Deputy Chief Engineer (C)Bhuj, Nirman Bhavan, 1st Floor, Opp. GCS Hospital, Naroda Road, Near DRM Office, Ahmedabad: 382345** In case of any clarification the firm may contact at the above office during the working hours in person or at office **Mobile No.9724093262.**

CPM-087

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Government of Odisha, e- Procurement Notice **34001/1001/2627**
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)
Bid Identification No. C.C.E.Dkl./R&B) 15/2026-27 Email Id-seedkjpwd@gmail.com
Letter No. 2195 / Dt. 12-10-2026

The Chief Construction Engineer, Dhenkanal (R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites Percentage Rate bids in double cover system to be received in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road & Building works as detailed below:

1. Name of the work :- Road & Building works
2. No of works :- 02 (Two) Nos
3. Estimated Cost :- Rs.1.61 Crore to Rs. 1.95 Crore (as given in column No. 03 of table)
4. Cost of tender paper :- Rs 10,000.00
5. Class of contractor :- 'B' Class, 'A' Class (as given in column No. 07 of table)
6. Period of Completion of work :- 05 (Five) to 07 (Seven) calendar months (as given in column No. 08 of table)
7. Date and time of availability of bid Document in the website :- From Dt.16.10.2026 to 5.00 P.M. of Dt.30.10.2026
8. Date of opening of bid :- Dt.31.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.

The bidders have to participate in ONLINE biding only further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal: www.tendersodisha.gov.in. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the siad website.

Chief Construction Engineer, Dhekanal(R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal

OIPR - 34001/34132/1/26-27/0018

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER P.W.D UJJAIN ZONE UJJAIN
No. 0734-2524462, E-Mail: cepwdujjain@mp.nic.in
Tender Notice

NIT OF 13 GEN/CE/2026-27 **UJJAIN DATE 09.10.2026**

ONLINE PERCENTAGE RATE TENDER FOR THE WORK MENTIONED BELOW ARE BEING INVITED. THE TENDER HAS/HAVE BEEN UPLOADED ON THE E-PROCUREMENT SYSTEM OF PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT ON THE PORTAL **WWW.MPTENDERS.GOV.IN** TENDER DETAILS ARE AS BELOW:-

S. No.	Division Name	Tender ID No.	Name of work	Cost of Project (PAC) (Rs. In lacs)	Time Period
1	2	3	4	5	6
1	UJJAIN	2026_PWDRB_542207_pack1	CONST. OF GHATTIYA JAGOTI KHAJURIYA ROAD KHEDA KHAJURIYA ROAD LENGTH 14.50 K.M. DN. UJJAIN.	1894.00	18 Months Including Rainy Season
2	MANDSAUR	2026_PWDRB_542208_pack1	CONSTRUCTION OF POLADUNGAR TO CHIKNIYA KURLASI CHUKNI DUDHAKHEDI TUNGNI BHANPURA ROAD LENGTH 44.90 KM INCLUDING ELECTRIC WORK DN. MANDSAUR	8771.16	24 Months Including Rainy Season
3	RATLAM	2026_PWDRB_542209_pack1	CONSTRUCTION OF RAKODA RIYAWAN MAUKHEDI KALUKHEDA ROAD LENGTH - 19.750 KM INCLUDING EXTERNAL ELECTRIFICATION WORK DN. RATLAM	3195.99	24 Months Including Rainy Season
4	RATLAM	2026_PWDRB_542210_pack1	CONSTRUCTION OF MAWTA RIYAWAN TO BADAYALAMATAJI ROAD LENGTH 9.50 KM INCLUDING EXTERNAL ELECTRIFICATION WORK DN. RATLAM	1463.18	12 Months Including Rainy Season
5	SHAJAPUR	2026_PWDRB_542211_pack1	CONSTRUCTION OF UPGRADATION AND WIDENING OF KALAPIPAL KHAMLAY AMLAY ROAD TOTAL LENGTH 29.00 KM IN INCLUDING ELECTRIC POLE SHIFTING WORK UNDER PWD DIN S SHAJAPUR.	6135.94	24 Months Including Rainy Season
6	NEEMUCH	2026_PWDRB_542212_pack1	CONSTRUCTION OF KHATUNGA TO DHARDI MAKHANGANJ ROAD LENGTH 21.50 Km. DIN NEEMUCH	7449.11	24 Months Including Rainy Season

THE DOCUMENT CAN ONLY BE PURCHASED ONLINE FROM THE ABOVE WEBSITE AFTER MAKING ONLINE PAYMENT. THE LAST DATE & TIME FOR PURCHASE OF DOCUMENT AND ONLINE BID SUBMISSION ON LINE IS DATED 27.10.2026 UP TO 17.30 PM. DETAILED NIT AND OTHER DETAILS CAN BE VIEWED ON THE ABOVE MENTIONED PORTAL. AMENDMENTS TO NIT, IF ANY, WOULD BE PUBLISHED ON WEBSITE ONLY, AND NOT IN NEWSPAPER.

Sd/- **CHIEF ENGINEER**
G-19995/26 **P.W.D UJJAIN ZONE UJJAIN**

Government of Uttarakhand, Department of Higher Education
No :– 439094 / XXIV-C-1/2026-E-42(53)/01(08)2020, 08 October, 2026

NOTICE FOR INVITING APPLICATIONS FOR THE APPOINTMENT OF VICE- CHANCELLOR OF SOBAN SINGH JEENA UNIVERSITY, ALMORA

The Uttarakhand Government has announced the appointment for the post of Vice Chancellor at Soban Singh Jeena University Almora. Under the provisions mentioned in Section 10(1) of the Soban Singh Jeena University Act, 2019 and as per conditions stipulated in UGC Notification dated 18.07.2018, applications are invited for the appointment on the one post of Vice Chancellor with a pay scale of Rs. 2,10,000 and a special allowance of Rs. 11,250.00, with total emoluments of Rs. 2,21,250.00.

2- The Vice Chancellor will be appointed from individuals possessing the highest level of efficiency, integrity, morality, and commitment to the institution. Eligible candidates must have at least 10 years of experience as a professor in a university or 10 years of educational leadership experience in a recognized research or educational administrative organization. The applicant should be a distinguished academician with relevant experience.

3- The age of the person applying for the post of Vice-Chancellor shall not be more than 65 years.

4- "Applicants/post-holders fulfilling the eligibility criteria must submit their applications online on the Samarth Portal URL (https://vcrec.samarth.ac.in/) within 15 days from the date of issuance of this advertisement, by 6:00 PM. The application must be filled out completely in the prescribed format, accompanied by the attached declaration form, along with photocopies of all relevant eligibility documents based on the said conditions—including proof of date of birth, appointment order to the post of Professor, date of joining, and certificates related to the pay scale for the post of Professor.

Additionally, one hard copy along with all supporting documents must be sent via Speed Post or Registered Post to the **Office of the Secretary, Department of Higher Education, Government of Uttarakhand, Election Office, 1st Floor, Vishwakarma Bhawan, 04 Subhash Road, Dehradun.**

Prescribed Format

Name & Address	Date of Birth	Age as on date of Publication of advertisement	Education/ Qualification	Position held Presently	Date of joining on Post of Professor and Equivalent	Teaching/Post Position held (From - To) Experience		Administrative Experience		Awards/ Patents/ Recognition	Publication/ Research Work	Remarks
						Post	Duration (From - To)	Post	Duration (From - To)			
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15

(Dr. B.V.R.C. Purushottam)
Secretary

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA **25001/1313/2627**
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SUNABEDA
e-mail - serwsbd2003@yahoo.com

Letter No. 6161 Date : 12/10/2026

1st Corrigendum

In continuation to this office Bid Identification No. CCERWCSBD-Online-35/2026-27 invited vide this office Notice No.5500, Dtd.21.09.2026, partial modification of NCB has been made as follows:-

Sl.No.	Item	Time schedule as per Original TCN	Time schedule as per Corrigendum Notice
1.	Availability of tender online for bidding	Dt.28.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. to Dt.13.06.2026 Up to 5.00 P.M	Extended from Dt.28.09.2026 at 11.00 A.M. up to 5.00 PM of Dt.06.11.2026
2	Date & time of seeking tender clarification if any	Dt.12.10.2026 Up to 2.00 P.M.	Dt.05.11.2026 Up to 2.00 P.M.
3	Date & time of opening of tender (Technical Bid)	Dt.14.10.2026 At 11.00 A.M	Dt.07.11.2026 At 11.00 A.M.
4	Date a time of opening of tender(Price Bid)	Will be intimated later on to the successful bidders	Will be intimated later on to the successful bidders

All other terms and conditions will remain unaltered.

Chief Construction Engineer
R.W. Circle, Sunabeda

OIPR - 5001/25182/1/26-27/0077

SAHARANPUR SMART CITY LIMITED
Nagar Nigam Campus, Gurudwara Road, Saharanpur-247001
Email: smartcitysaharanpur@gmail.com, Website: www.saharanpursmartcity.com

NIT No. 06/2026-27/01/SSCL **Notice Inviting Tender** Date: 13th October 2026

Saharanpur Smart City Limited, Saharanpur invites online Bids on two stage system for the following works:

Name of Project/ Work(s)	Estimated Cost (excluding GST) (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)	Tender Fee (Rs.)	Period of Completion
Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of HT Electrical Infrastructure including Transformer at Convention Hall, Jannach, Saharanpur Tender ID: 2026_SSCL_1196117_1	33,42,716/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakh Fourty Two Thousand Seven Hundred Sixteen only)	70,000/-(Rupees Seventy Thousand Only)	5900/-(Five Thousand Nine Hundred Only)	Six (06) Months

1. Detailed NIT & Bid Documents shall be downloaded from https://etender.up.nic.in
2. Availability of Tender on-line for bidding: From 14.10.2026 at 1000 Hrs.
3. Last Date & Time for online submission of Bids: 28.10.2026 at 1700 hrs.
4. Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid: 29.10.2026 at 1100 hrs.
5. Date & Time of Opening of Financial Bid: To be intimated later
6. Pre-bid Meeting: 21.10.2026 at 1600 hrs. at SSCL office
7. SSCL reserves right to reject any or all Tenders and/or cancel/ annul/ keep in abeyance the Auction Process.
8. Any subsequent addendum/corrigendum shall be published at eauction portal https://etender.up.nic.in only.

(Company Secretary)

Behind India's team transition: The specialists are taking hold

A strategic pursuit of T20 firepower and push to identify Test batters has resulted in squads separating

Rasesh Mandani
rasesh.mandani@htlive.com

MUMBAI: Think of the best contemporary players who play across formats and Harry Brook's name springs to mind. Some would think of Travis Head. Jofra Archer among fast bowlers. It is impossible to forget Jasprit Bumrah, but the pacer's fitness and workload concerns have turned him into a special purpose entity.

England have a few others such as Ben Duckett and Will Jacks who are seen on the international circuit year round. South Africa have Aiden Markram, Marco Jansen and Kagiso Rabada. Among leading nations, there's also Australia's Cameroon Green. But what about the India team? Over the last two years, India have had no player with a sizable all-format presence.

How and when did this change come about? Is it by design? With a calendar so congested, bowlers breaking down frequently under its burden, rest and rotation of players so common; one may be persuaded to believe the separation of India's squads is a natural consequence. True. But, not entirely so.

A strategic pursuit of T20 firepower and an effort to identify Test batters have contributed heavily to India's Test and T20I squads separating away from each other. Even the ODI team has developed a distinct identity. Piecemeal retirements of stalwarts Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma: first from T20Is, then Tests have acted as catalysts.

Head coach Gautam Gambhir received a reality check quite early in his job, when New Zealand blew India away at home. That's when he first spoke of the need to "identify solid red-ball batters". Opportunities to the likes of Devdutt Padikkal, Sai Sudharsan, Dhruv Jurel, Sarfaraz Khan followed. The selectors moved away from experimental selections such as Bazball-inspired Test cap to Suryakumar Yadav in 2023.

Concurrently, the T20 team took shape, developing even stronger selfhood. As India's T20I calendar became busier, the selectors identified a set of T20 specialists: the likes of Abhishek Sharma, Shivam Dube, Tilak Varma, Varun Chakravarthy among others who clocked international air miles from Ireland, England, Japan before returning for the home leg. Axar Patel and Arshdeep Singh also feature in the ODI team. Bumrah and Hardik Pandya are not regulars on the white-ball bilateral treadmill.

Strategic outlooks in sport, though, function in circles. Once India's team transition fully sets in, new avenues may open up for some players. Tilak Varma has given evidence of being a rounded batter. Rinku Singh has the tools to find success beyond T20s. Vaibhav Sooryavanshi is still finding his feet in T20Is, but he is tipped to branch out to other formats.

Team set ups can't do without all-format players altogether for too long. "Ideally, for any coach, the more all-format players we have, it's better because continuity is very important," Gambhir told Star Sports. "But no matter how hard the coach and selectors try, you will have few three-format players in future because you will have to keep rotating players."

To give players a greater chance to push for all-format, India's cricket calendar needs to become less punishing and better planned. Shubman Gill, who captains the Test and ODI teams has on more than one occasion been short changed with inadequate time to prepare for red-ball action.

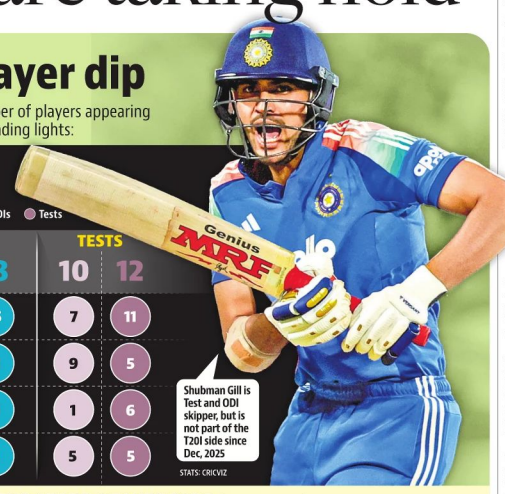
Despite that Indian cricket calendar post 2024 T20 World Cup still shows Gill to have played most matches across formats (22 T20Is, 26 ODIs, 18 Tests). Even after losing his T20I place on the road, Gill's all-format presence remains healthy in the current WTC cycle (11 Tests, 15 ODIs, 15 T20Is). With a more spaced out schedule, a generational talent like Gill may not take long to find his T20 peak.

Among others to have featured with some regularity across formats post the 2024 World Cup are Washington Sundar (22 T20Is, 15 ODIs and 14 Tests) and Kuldeep Yadav (16 T20Is, 21 ODIs and 7 Tests). Nitish Reddy ranks next in players to have played international cricket across formats (8 Tests, 8 ODIs and 10 T20Is).

Washington and Reddy's all-round offerings give them an extended run. Kuldeep remains an unlikely starter in away Tests. But the likes of Gill and Jaiswal are itching to maximise their full potential. By donning the wicket-keeping gloves during Ranji practice, Jaiswal may have sent a cryptic message to push towards that goal.

Multi-format player dip

India teams show a gradual decline in the number of players appearing across formats. A look at the numbers of the leading lights:



PRESENCE ACROSS FORMATS

Between 2024 T20 WC and start of 2025 WTC cycle (Jun 29, 2024-Jun 17, 2025) | Start of 2025 WTC cycle

T20Is ODIs Tests | T20Is ODIs Tests

TOTAL MATCHES INDIA PLAYED	T20Is		ODIs		TESTS	
	21	49	11	18	10	12
Shubman Gill	11	11	11	15	7	11
Washington Sundar	11	11	4	11	9	5
Kuldeep Yadav	0	16	10	11	1	6
Nitish Reddy	4	4	0	8	5	5

Shubman Gill is Test and ODI skipper, but is not part of the T20I side since Dec, 2025

STATS: CRICVIZ

PLAYERS WITH MOST CAPS SINCE THE START OF WTC 2025 (JUNE 17, 2025)

PLAYERS	T20Is (TOTAL MATCHES INDIA PLAYED: 49)
Abhishek Sharma	48
Shivam Dube	46
Tilak Varma	43
Axar Patel	39
Arshdeep Singh	34

PLAYERS	ODIs (18)
Rohit Sharma	18
KL Rahul	16
Shubman Gill	15
Virat Kohli	15
Prasidh Krishna	13

PLAYERS	TESTS (12)
Yashasvi Jaiswal	12
KL Rahul	12
Mohammed Siraj	12
Shubman Gill	11
Ravindra Jadeja	11

Why are India's fielders getting caught out in T20s?

Vishesh Roy
vishesh.roy@htdigital.in

NEW DELHI: In the third over of the West Indies innings during the third T20I at Indore, Shimron Hetmyer slashed a delivery from fast bowler Mayank Yadav. It flew towards the short third man and seemed to be a pretty regular chance. But Abhishek Sharma got confused about whether he should take the catch in a conventional way or go for the reverse cup. The result was another drop. Another, because the scenario perfectly summed up India's catching woes in the shortest format.

Can a side consistently stay at the top if their fielding standards continue to drop? India's surge to the top in T20Is has been marked by a decline in the field over the past three years.

The chances are going down at an ever-increasing rate in T20s. In 2026, according to data provided by CricViz, India are 11th among the 12 full members, with a catching efficiency of 74.4, ahead of only West Indies, who are bottom with 73.8.

This year, Tilak Varma has been the safest Indian catcher, pouching 23 catches, but despite this figure, he has also been guilty of putting down nine chances across 27 matches. The worst of India's fielders have been Abhishek Sharma (57.8%) and Washington Sundar (62.5%). In essence, it boils down to one question: what exactly is going wrong?

If the last three-year period is considered, the catch efficiency rate has been steadily declining. If it was 80.4% in 2024, it came down to 79.8% in 2025, and now it's 74.4% this year.

For context. Australia's efficiency has increased, going up from 80.2 in 2024 to 83 in 2026. According to CricViz, India put down 33 chances in 26 matches in 2024; the number then decreased to 26, but the number of games played was 19. This year, the Men in Blue have dropped a whopping 55 chances in 32 matches.

Fielding coaches have recently changed, with T Dilip replaced by Subhadeep Ghosh, but the problem persists.

"I think fielding has now definitely taken a backseat in terms of application and in terms of building a certain culture," said R Sridhar, the former India fielding coach, during a media interaction. "There is a clear culture in the way the Indian team is batting. And similarly, there's a clear culture in the way the Indian team is bowling, especially in the ODIs, where Shubman Gill likes tall, hit-the-deck fast bowlers. But whereas in fielding, that (the culture) seems to be absent."

"And what is really worrying is that the new kids coming into the squad are undercooked. Whoever is coming in, they don't seem to be the kind of fielder a Kohli is or even a Surya or even a Shreyas, the generation of that block, I'm saying, because they seem to have been brought up on only one skill, that is, batting. So that's a bit of a worrying factor, but that is not for the Indian team to worry. That is for the entire ecosystem to wake up and smell the coffee. So there are a lot of things to be done, but the fielding coach will have a job on his hands to train these young guns straight away," he added.

Is there something that can be done to result in a mark improvement for the New Zealand series? Sridhar reckons the change will take time to be reflected, as it will depend on how each individual responds to the coaching style.

"In coaching, one size doesn't fit all. You need to understand the person behind the player and have a different strategy for all of them. Understand their workload, understand what they are going through emotionally with their performances and bring them to the best possible place. Coach the face, not the symptom," said Sridhar.

The drop zone

Catching efficiency in T20Is in 2026

Team	M	Ct	Dp	Catch%
AFG	12	48	9	84.2
ENG	19	109	22	83.2
AUS	10	49	10	83.0
BAN	10	40	9	81.6
IRL	10	56	14	80.0
ZIM	17	86	22	79.6
NZL	20	94	28	77.0
SA	21	101	30	77.0
SL	22	88	27	76.5
PAK	15	78	25	75.7
IND	32	160	55	74.4
WI	19	82	29	73.8

Indian pros seek home comfort as golfing elites descend on tricky DGC

Shantanu Srivastava
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: If the 2025 edition was a precursor, here comes the real deal. Headlined by six-time Major winner Rory McIlroy, defending champion Tommy Fleetwood, current PGA Championship winner Aaron Rai, reigning Open champion Ryan Fox, and 2019 Open winner Shane Lowry, the second edition of the $4 million DP World India Championship has attracted the shining stars of golf to the lush and iconic Delhi Golf Club (DGC). While the Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) is chuffed at the star cast and is upbeat about the domino effect an event of such magnitude will likely have on the sport, it's the here and now that one is more bothered about.

The last time an Indian won an event on the European Tour — now known as DP World Tour— was in 2018 when Gaganjeet Bhullar won the tri-sanctioned Fiji International. That win came just six months after Shubhankar Sharma won the Maybank Championship in Kuala Lumpur, raising hopes of consistent Indian results. Eight years on, while Indian pros have been making the right noises at home, overseas wins have dried up. At the inaugural DP World India Championship, only five of the 26 Indians in the field made the cut with Shiv Kapur's T32 the best Indian finish.

This time, there are 27 Indians in the fray, most of them having a fair degree of familiarity with the tough course. While Gaganjeet Bhullar's late withdrawal to a back injury is a blow — he is replaced by Sachin Baisoya — there's enough experience in the ranks.

PGTI CEO and DGC captain Amandeep Johl has set a realistic expectation — half of the Indian entries making the cut. While that will soon be put to test, the likes of Anirban Lahiri and Shubhankar Sharma are busy re-acquainting themselves with a course they have grown up on.

"We have a conveyer belt of some really exceptional young golfers. Yes, we've had a few lean years and there haven't been any international wins on any tours, but that doesn't mean we don't have the talent. There is enough to work with. I believe that the golf has grown. There has been more professional opportunities now," Lahiri said.

The 39-year-old isn't off the mark. In Saptak Talwar, Veer Ahlawat, Yuvraj Sandhu, Viraj Madappa and Manu Gandas — all will be in action — India did have a number of youngsters ready to ride the momentum that Shubhankar's 2018 win in Europe generated. The leaderboards though have been narrating a different tale.

"At the end of the day, it's about your mindset and how you prepare for the challenges you'll face abroad. I don't think Indian golf courses, and the set-ups that a lot of Indian tours are playing, best prepare you for what you face abroad. It was the same during my time. You have to adapt, be agile, be able to think and prepare for, okay, what am I going to face when I play the DP World Tour or whichever tour. So, it comes down to how you train and how your support team is managing that," Lahiri, who will play after a seven-week break, said.

"There is a lot of growth that needs to happen in that area. Once you start taking a little more holistic approach, you'll see better results. You don't want them to be flashes in the pan. You want it to be something structured where you know these kids are going to grow. I think that's happening. Maybe not as fast as we need to."

For Shubhankar, the struggle has spilled over to a second season. The 30-year-old has missed cuts in 13 of the 22 events he has played on the DP World Tour, thanks largely to him experimenting with his clubs.

"That backfired because I didn't find what I needed, and I remember last year at this time I was saying the same thing," Shubhankar, who is coming off a win at the Kapil Dev Invitational last week, said.

"I couldn't find something consistent throughout. The solution has been just to go back to the basics of finding clubs, which I did in the middle of the year. I went back to old clubs with some minor adjustments, like strengthening the shaft."

On the course and conditions, the seasoned pros vouched for DGC's traditional challenges — tight fairways, thick roughs, and the need to be accurate off the tee.

Can home advantage turn it around?

Indians have not won in Europe (DP World) since 2018, but theys will hope it changes in the star-studded DP World India C'ship. A look at the main Indian challengers:

SHUBHANKAR SHARMA
Having endured two tough seasons in Europe, the 2-time winner on that tour will aim to bounce back. He won the Kapil Dev Invitational last week and that confidence should come in handy on a familiar course

VEER AHLAWAT
With 9 top-10s on PGTI this season, Ahlawat is in fine form coming into his home course. The former PGTI Order of Merit winner will bank on his vast experience of playing at the DGC to come good in a world-class field

ANIRBAN LAHIRI
The two-time European Tour winner returns to DGC, a course where he won the Hero Indian Open in 2015. Returning to competitive golf after 7 weeks, Lahiri will hope for an encore in front of a home crowd

SAPTAK ALWAR
The current PGTI Order of Merit leader is on a hot streak, claiming eight top-10s out of 15 outings on the domestic tour. A good show here will help him cap a fabulous season on a high

Rose and Rai: Of solitary Major and soldiering on

N Ananthanarayanan
anantha.narayanan@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: His only previous trip to India is a blur for Justin Rose. It was 22 years ago and for barely three days to play in a Skins event. A destination 40th birthday celebration planned had to be called off because of the Covid pandemic.

Another interminable wait is to win a second Major. The first had come at the 2013 US Open. Rose added lustre to that phase of his career by winning gold at 2016 Rio on golf's return to the Olympics after 112 years. Since then there have been five second-place finishes, including potentially crushing playoff defeats at the Masters to Sergio Garcia (2017) and Rory McIlroy (2025).

The other two were at the Open (2018, 2024), but well into his 40s, it reflects the fitness, skill and persistence of Rose that he went so close in the last two years. And at this year's Masters, he was leading into the back nine on Sunday before slipping to T3 as McIlroy made it back-to-back.

Thus, it wasn't surprising that Rose, 46, was asked about the competitive fire burning in him and taking over the unwanted mantle of the Masters nearly man from McIlroy, who shed that tag with his 2025 win.

At a media interaction ahead of the $4 million DP World India Championship starting at Delhi Golf Club on Thursday, the former world No.1 spoke of playing "for the memories". While acknowledging the depth in elite golf, the 13-time winner on the PGA Tour said: "I have been playing well in the last 2-3 years, but haven't necessarily lifted the trophy."

"I will be 47 next year, that shouldn't be possible (winning top events). But that is possible."

It is the steel within as well as innovative fitness routines of the former world No.1, who is currently 16. Rose is famous for travelling on the tour with his recovery vehicle fitted with hot and cold plunge, infra-red sauna and a spin bike. "It is time intensive," Rose says in a YouTube video as he gives a tour of the custom-made vehicle.

On the Augusta near misses, he said: "I can't control what happens at Augusta. I can control my own performance and how I break down the golf course and how I play the golf course. You are never going to skip through your career without a mistake at the wrong time. I've been fortunate to have a lot of things go my way in the biggest moments. So yeah, just keep trusting that you knock on that door. I know how to compete. I know how to close a tournament. I know how to win. You just got to hope that it all lines up the right week."

Aaron Rai is a different story. As he was completing the US PGA Championship victory in May, McIlroy, Jon Rahm and Xander Schauffele were all delighted that a nicer guy on the tour could not be joining their club, that of a Major winner.

The 31-year-old from Wolverhampton is highly regarded for his modesty—he still puts back the covers on his irons, like he did as a boy from modest means to protect the expensive equipment. For the player of Indian origin, being nice and battling it out in a tough sport is about staying humble acknowledging that one's game "can get better, stagnate or get worse".

"When it comes to golf and competing and practicing, in my mind being respectful to the game is treating it with the challenge and discipline and hard work that it deserves.

"Golf rewards consistency in different parts of the game. Having goals doesn't mean they are going to come true." One has to stick to a "half step by half step process", says the world No.16.

Two men who will be very popular winners if everything comes together come Sunday.

Justin Rose. AFP

Aaron Rai. AFP

I know how to compete. I know how to close a tournament. I know how to win. You just got to hope that it all lines up the right week.

JUSTIN ROSE, 2016 Rio Olympic champion

Ranji: Bengal firmly in control as Delhi struggle

Somshuvra Laha
somshuvra.laha@htlive.com

Delhi's Yash Dhull lies on the ground after getting hit by a delivery from Akash Deep. PTI

KALYANI: Defensive batting from Delhi and an unresponsive pitch ensured Bengal's Ranji match stretched into a fourth day, but the visitors have left themselves with a mountain to climb. At stumps on Tuesday, Delhi were 101/3 in their second innings, trailing Bengal's first-innings total of 429 by 88 runs. Yash Dhull, meanwhile, retired hurt after taking a blow to the chest from Akash Deep.

Bengal started the day with the advantage of two overnight centurions, Abishek Porel and Sudip Gharami, and the prospect of batting Delhi out of the game. The first hour yielded 52 runs for the loss of one wicket. Gharami departed for 133 out leg before.

Porel continued to dictate terms, reaching 149 before getting caught at short leg. By then, Bengal had secured a lead of 150. But from the promise of a much larger lead, Bengal had been restricted to 429, leaving Delhi with a deficit of 189.

Delhi's reply began with a reprieve for Sarthak Ranjan, dropped on two by Sudip Chatterjee at second slip off Shami. Akash Deep beat Ranjan comprehensively, sending his middle stump cartwheeling. The setback was compounded when Dhull took a short ball from Akash on his chest and left the field in discomfort.

At tea, the visitors were 27/1, with Ayush Doseja on three and Sanat Sangwan on 18. The session had produced just 33 runs and four wickets, an indication of the defensive stranglehold that had settled over the match.

Doseja and Sangwan subsequently shut shop, facing 142 balls between them to add only 36 runs. Their resistance ended when Mukesh Kumar got Doseja, on 19, after the batter tried to leave a delivery that brushed his gloves on its way to the wicketkeeper. Pramanik then produced the ball of the evening, pitching in the rough and turning sharply into Sangwan to disturb his stumps.

Badoni and wicketkeeper Anuj Rawat injected some life into the closing overs, adding 42 runs in 12 overs without further loss. They ended unbeaten on 24 and 25 respectively.

Yet Bengal remain firmly in control. On a pitch offering little encouragement to stroke-makers, Delhi's caution has bought time rather than a credible route back into the contest. The visitors need another 88 runs merely to draw level, with seven wickets standing and the threat of Akash Deep and Bengal's attack still to negotiate.

Brief scores: In Kalyani: Delhi 240 & 101/3 in 45 overs (Ayush Badoni 24*). Bengal 429 in 112 overs (Sudip Gharami 133, Abhishek Porel 149; Ayush Badoni 5/43). **In Delhi:** Maharashtra 333 & 66/5 in 28 overs (Ankit Bawne 32*; Arjun Sharma 4/30). Services 227 in 93.2 overs (Nitin Tanwar 61; Hitesh Walunj 5/51). **In Mumbai:** Mumbai 429 beat Chandigarh 78 & 196 in 52.1 overs (Shivam Bhambri 44; Shams Mulani 3/69, Tanush Kotian 3/30, Tushar Deshpande 2/37). Mumbai won by an innings and 155 runs. **In Jaipur:** Rajasthan 363 and 81/4 in 34 overs (Mahipal Lomror 25*). Tamil Nadu 274 in 98.4 overs (Andre Siddarth 81, Pradosh Ranjan Paul 58, Narayan Jagadeesan 55; Ajay Singh Kukna 5/51).

Ayush Mhatre suffers Grade 4 hamstring tear

HT Correspondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: In a major setback to the Mumbai side, their promising young opening batter Ayush Mhatre sustained a Grade 4 tear in his right hamstring during Mumbai's Ranji opener against Chandigarh.

Mhatre suffered the injury while running between the wickets during his 48-run knock in the first innings. He didn't come out to field and scans revealed a Grade 4 tear. The opener is likely to miss the first half of the Ranji season. "It seems that he will not be with the team for some time now," Mumbai captain Siddhesh Lad said after Mumbai's innings win on Tuesday.

"It happened while running (between the wickets), because we had two or three simulations (matches) and club games and also played at the BKC (Ground), and he was looking fine for the last 3-4 matches, but he felt something in his hamstring while taking a second run," Lad said.

It will be a tough blow to take for Mhatre, who was playing his first match after a long recovery from a left hamstring injury sustained in April while playing for Chennai Super Kings in IPL 2026. The young opener spent three months at the BCCI's Centre of Excellence (CoE) in Bengaluru undergoing treatment and rehabilitation.

Mumbai win

Spinners Shams Mukani and Tanush Kotian shared three wickets each to bundle out Chandigarh for 196 in their second innings and help Mumbai to a massive innings and 155-run victory against Chandigarh at the Wankhede Stadium.

Except for a 62-run knock by Arjun Azad and Shivam Bhambri's 44 at No. 5, none of the Chandigarh batters offered any resistance. Tushar Deshpande who took a fifer in the second innings, picked up two more in the second to finish with a match haul of seven.

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH
WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
HASDEO CANAL W/M DIVISION, JANJGIR
DISTT. JANJGIR-CHAMPA (C.G.)
e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 26.10.2026 at 1730 Hour

System Tender No.	NIT No. & Date	Name of Work	Probable Amount of Contract (Exluding G.S.T.) (In Lakhs)	Tender Call
201195	15/ SAC/2026-27 Dtd. 09.10.2026	CONSTRUCTION OF MAINTENANCE OF LINING, STRUCTURES, EARTH WORK, MAINTENANCE OF BHATHALI SUB DY. CANAL SYSTEM OF NAWAGARH BRANCH CANAL.	248.75	Second Call
201202	16/ SAC/2026-27 Dtd. 09.10.2026	CONSTRUCTION OF G-TYPE NEW RESIDENTIAL BUILDING AT MUNICIPAL CORPORATION AREA BILASPUR.	438.38	Second Call

(Estimated cost of tender S.O.R. Based on date 01.08.2010 & Amendment Date 23.04.2026)

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal **(https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in) from Date 16.10.2026 at 1731 Hours. (IST) onwards.**

NOTE:- All eligible/intrested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal **(https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in)** and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Other terms and condition of this tender visit WRD website **https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in** under Live Tender available.

Sd/- **EXECUTIVE ENGINEER**
HASDEO CANAL W/M DIVISION, JANJGIR
DISTT. JANJGIR-CHAMPA (C.G.)
G-262703903/5

Public Works Department
Office of The Superintanding Engineer, Pwd, Raipur Circle No.-1 Raipur. (C.G.)
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)
(1st Call)

No. 20/Raipur/2026-27 **Raipur, Dated. 06.10.2026**

Public Works Department (PWD) invites proposal for Planning, Design, Estimation and related services for the work

जिला रायपुर में मेगा एग्जामिनेशन सेंटर भवन का निर्माण कार्य हेतु आर्किटेक्ट नियुक्त करने बाबत्।

Situated at Raipur

Probable cost of project Rs. 25.00 Cr.

Minimum eligibility for participants shall be as below:-

S. N.	Building project cost	The applicant firms, firms forming Joint venture/consortium shall be	Earnest money (In shape as per annexure I) Favor of Executive Engineer, PWD Division No.-03 Raipur
1	For project cost Between 10 to 25 Crore	Empanelled as architect in Class "C" & Above Class in C.G. PWD.	Rs. 5,000-00

General condition: All the documents & Information as per para 6.4, shall be submitted through speed post/Registered post, so as to reach the office of under signed on or before dated **26.10.2026** by **1730 hour**. Any documents received after the last date and time will not be entertained.

The detailed RFP is available on the website **www.cg.nic.in/ pwdraipur** & **http://cgstate.gov.in/** from where it can be downloaded for submission. CG.PWD reserves the right to reject all or any of the application without assigning any reason. Right to modify the process of Pre-qualification is reserved with CG.PWD.

Superintending Engineer
Public Works Department
G-262703923/2 **Raipur Circle No.-1 Raipur**

DR. RAM MANOHAR LOHIA INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL SCIENCES
VIBHUTI KHAND, GOMTI NAGAR, LUCKNOW- 226 010 (U.P.) | Phone: 0522-6692000, 6692001, Website: www.drrmlims.ac.in

Ref. No. RMLIMS/MM(Eq)/2026-27/1478 **Date: 13.10.2026**

Re Tender/GeM Bid Notice (2nd Time Offer)

On-line offers are invited through GeM bidding from **Original Equipment Manufacturer/ Direct Importers/Authorized Distributors** for the supply & installation of Various Medical Equipments for the various departments of the Institute.

1. Due to none of the bidders having participated earlier for the listed items against tendered advertisement no. **RMLIMS/MM(eq)/2026-27/586 and 1071 dated 13/07/2026 and 16/09/2026,** the tender for the said items will be treated as cancelled and Ist time re-tender (2nd time offer) is being published. The equipment covered under this includes: **Shortwave Diathermy Unit, Guarded Calibrated Diamond Knife (for LRI), TEG Analyser Machine, Patient Transfer System, etc.**
Since no bidder had participated in the earlier tender for the above items, the bidder participating in this re-tender shall be required to deposit the prescribed EMD afresh as per the tender terms and conditions.

2. Due to none of the bidders being qualified earlier for the listed items against tendered advertisement no. **RMLIMS/MM(eq)/2026-27/586 and 1071 dated 13/07/2026 and 16/09/2026,** the tender for the said items will be treated as cancelled and Ist time re-tender (2nd time offer) is being published.
Since bidders had participated in the earlier tender for the above items but none of them qualified, the bidders participating again in this re-tender are not required to deposit the EMD afresh. However, they shall enclose the proof of the EMD deposited earlier in their technical bid, as per the tender terms and conditions.
Therefore, those who have already submitted their offer against the above advertisement are also required to submit their offer again. However, in case of items covered under Point No. 2 above, they are not required to deposit EMD again, subject to submission of proof of the EMD deposited earlier in the technical bid as per tender terms and conditions.
For detailed information like list of items, Date of Submission and opening of bid etc., you may please visit the GeM portal **www.gem.gov.in.** The list of equipment will also be available on our website **www.drrmlims.ac.in** for reference only. The offer will be accepted **On-Line only on GeM portal** with terms and conditions as mentioned in the GeM bidding document.
The Director reserves the right to **accept or reject any or all bids/tenders, either in part or in full, without assigning any reason thereof.**

Director

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION NO. 1, NAGPUR
INVITATION FOR TENDER
Email: div1nagpur.ee@mahapwd.gov.in.
E-Tender Notice No. S/ 32 /2026-2027

Online Percentage Rate e-tender Prescribed form are invited by the Executive Engineer. P.W. Division No. 1, Nagpur (Tel Phone No. 2565449) on Behalf of Governor of Maharashtra for following work from Experienced & shop establishment certificate holders. The name of work, estimated cost, time limit for completion etc, as are under.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estt. cost (Rs. in lakhs)	Cost of blank tender form
1	Replacement of Curtains, Sofa sets, Computer Tables, Cusion of chairs of Center Hall & PMO Office at Lok Bhavan,Nagpur.	40.00	590.00
2	Replacement of Curtains, Beds & Sofa sets, Curtain rod, Brackets & Other Misc work. of VIP Suite no.34 at Lok Bhavan, Nagpur.	40.00	590.00
3	Replacement of Curtains, Beds & Sofa sets, Curtain rod, Brackets & Other Misc work. of VIP Suite no.29 & 32 at Lok Bhavan, Nagpur.	50.00	590.00
4	Replacement of Curtain cloth with Rod, Brackets, Window Curtain, Carpet, Runner Superior Quality, Tables Cloth, & Other Misc.Work of GS Bunlgow	50.00	590.00
5	Providing & Supplying VVIP Sofas, VIP Chair & Stage for At Home Programme at Lok Bhavan, Nagpur.	30.00	590.00
6	Providing Services of Plumber, Carpenter, Skilled & Unskilled Worker for Arranging Furniture & Sweeper for chockes All Drainage line in the premises of Lok Bhavan, Nagpur.	30.00	590.00
7	Providing House Keeping services of Skilled and Unskilled workers Providing managements of household affairs for Hon'ble C.M. Bunglow Ramgiri, Nagpur.	25.00	590.00
8	Providing Vaccume cleaning floor clearing by machine at Deogiri Bunglow and Hirak Building Deogiri premises Nagpur	12.00	590.00
9	Providing and supplying labours for Running of Assembly camp at Deogiri Bunglow Nagpur	15.00	590.00
10	Providing Labour for RAC 2026 at Deogiri Premises, Nagpur.	45.00	590.00
11	Providing and supplying Labour RAC 2026 at 160 Tenements Nagpur.	30.00	590.00
12	Supply of Man Power Services & Security Guard and supply of plumbing and sanitary material to Ravinagar Complex Transit Quarter, Nagpur.	25.00	590.00
13	Supply of furntiture for Sub Division office at Ravibhavan, Nagpur.	40.00	590.00

1. Detailed Tender Notice can be seen on web site https://mahatenders.gov.in
2. Detailed Tender Notice can be seen on the Notice Board in the office of the undersigned.
3. Right to reject any or all the tenders without assigning any reason thereof is reserved with the undersigned.
4. In this Tender Notice, Tender Downloading, Tender Opening etc. information available on web site.

Outward No. 9160 Date 9 OCT 2026

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
P.W. Division No. 1
Nagpur

DGIPR /2026-2027/ROC 3222

UJVN LIMITED
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)
H. O. "UJJWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006 CIN No.- U40101UR2001SGC025865
Tele.- 0135-2763308, 2763609, Fax: 0135-2763307, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.942 Date : 13.10.2026

Short Term Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Galogi SHP), UJVNLtd., Ganga Bhawan, Yamuna Colony, Dehradun, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Notice Inviting Tender No.: 05/EE(GC)/2026-27: Annual contract for general cleaning, sweeping and upkeeping of Galogi Powerhouse, campus area, training center, Bhatta Headworks and associated land areas including miscellaneous works.
Estimated cost: ₹16,26,931.00+ GST extra
Date of availability of bid :13.10.2026 from 17:00hrs.
document on website
Last date for submission of tender: 29.10.2026 up to 15:00 hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website **www.ujvnl.com**

Executive Engineer (Galogi SHP)

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO	NAME OF BOARD/ CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD CORP/AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	HVPNL	NIET NO. 04/XEN/TS/MNS/2026-27 DATE: 07.10.2026 FOR THE WORK OF REPAIRING THE DAMAGES OF 220KV 1000SQMM XLPE POWER CABLE B PHASE GIS TERMINATION CABLE SEALING END AND ATTENDING SF-6 GAS LEAKAGE IN D06 BAY AND REFILLING OF 1000SQMM GIS INDOOR CABLE TERMINATION OF 220KV GIS TRANSPORT HUB TO MAU CKT-2 BAY AT 220KV GIS SUBSTATION, TRANSPORT HUB, MANESAR TENDER ID- 2026_HBC_552693_1.	07.10.2026 03.11.2026	322.18 LACS	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
2	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE TO CREATE 132KV BAY FOR FEEDING ADDITIONAL 20/25MVA 132KV T/F AT 132KV S/STN. BEER BY HVPNL IN IST HALF OF 2024-25, DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	07.10.2026 22.10.2026	10,38,469/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
3	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION OF 132 KV S/STN. JAKHAL FROM 1X20/25MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X16/20 PLUS 1X10/16) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS TO 2X20/25MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X16/20 PLUS 1X10/16) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS FOR THE YEAR 2025-26, DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	08.10.2026 22.10.2026	14,02,802/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
4	HVPNL	SPECIAL ESTIMATE FOR AUGMENTATION OF 132 KV SUBSTATION BHATTU KALAN FROM 1X20/25 MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X10/16 PLUS 1X16/20) MVA, 132/11KV T/FS TO 2X20/25 MVA, 132/33KV PLUS (1X10/16 PLUS 1X16/20) MVA, 132/11KV TFS AT 132KV S/STN. BHATTU KALAN BY HVPNL FOR REDUNDANCY IN 1ST HALF OF FY 2024-25, DISTRICT NAME - HISAR	08.10.2026 22.10.2026	10,00,469/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
5	HVPNL	SITE SURFACE DRESSING, PCC, SUPPLY AND SPREADING OF GRAVELS AT ONE NO. THE 132KV BUS COUPLER BAY B-7 AT 132KV SUBSTATION RAJOUND. (DISTRICT KAITHAL)	08.10.2026 15.10.2026	4,19,806/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN
6	HVPNL	REPAIR AND MTC OF CEILING AND WALL PLASTER, REPLACEMENT OF CHOWKHATS AND DOORS AND WHITE WASH OF QUARTERS AT 220/132KV S/STN PHC HVPNL KARNAL.	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	4,23,432/-	www.hvpn.org.in	0172-2583789 PRO@HVPN.ORG.IN

RO NO 13/2027/140/50168/I/19/7

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT: www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR No.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/ EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, HISAR	SUPPLY, CARRIAGE AND COLLECTION OF STONE METAL IN SIZE 53MM TO 22.4MM IN MAIN STORE HISAR IN PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.I, PWD BANDR BRANCH, HISAR IN HISAR DISTRICT + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	6.52 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9873884499 pwd-eepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, AMBALA	IMPROVEMENT OF ROAD FROM AMBALA-BARAULA ROAD (KM 10.00 TO 16.00) BY PROVIDING STRENGTHENING OF ROAD IN AMBALA DISTRICT (ROAD ID 9) (UNDER NABARD SCHEME RIDF-XXXII)	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	313.20 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
3	KALPANA CHAWLA GOVT MEDICAL COLLEGE KARNAL	E-TENDER FOR PROVIDING CAFETERIA SERVICES AT KCGMC, KARNAL	15.10.2026 27.10.2026	EMD 10000	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8295340665 director.kcghc-hry@gov.in
4	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, MANDI DABWALI	KALANWALI STP:- PROVIDING AND INSTALLATION / REPLACEMENT OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRIC INSTALLATION AT 9.50 MLD STP KALANWALI DISTT. SIRSA. CH. TO :- KALANWALI:- ESTIMATE FOR REPLACEMENT/ UPGRADATION OF EQUIPMENT AND ELECTRICAL ITEMS AT 9.50 MLD STP AT KALANWALI TOWN DISTT. SIRSA	09.10.2026 21.10.2026	58.07 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8730000001 ee.mandidabwali@gmail.com
5	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	STRENGTHENING /REHABILITATION OF EXISTING DAMAGED 500 MM I/D RCC NP3 PIPE UPSTREAM TO 4.00 MLD STP KAIMRI ROAD BY CIPP (CURED-IN-PLACE PIPE) TECHNOLOGY	CLOSING DATE 27.10.2026	521.40 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
6	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	A/MTC. ESTIMATE FOR SEWERAGE SCHEME HISAR TOWN AND ALL OTHER WORKS CONTINGENT THERETO, FOR THE YEAR 2026-27	CLOSING DATE 16.10.2026	8.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
7	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, HISAR	FIXING OF HYDRANT AT VARIOUS STPS UNDER DIVISION NO.3 HISAR.	12.10.2026 19.10.2026	5.39 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01662-247033 eephisar@gmail.com
8	PUBLIC HEALTH ENGINEERING, FATEHABAD	SPECIAL REPAIR/WDG./STG. OF 02 NO. ROADS UNDER RATIA CONSTITUENCY IN FATEHABAD DISTRICT (WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (GROUP-11) 1. STG. ON BHIRDANA TO BHUTHAN KALAN ROAD KM 0.0 TO 4.245 (ROAD ID 10178) 2. WDG. AND STG. AND IPB ON RATIA FATEHABAD ROAD TO DHANI TALWALI KM 0.0 TO 0.78 (ROAD ID 5602) (WITHOUT GST) + 1 WORKS	12.10.2026 22.10.2026	563.26 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	01667-220120 pwd-eepd-fatehabad@hry.nic.in
9	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, FATEHABAD	REPAIR OF WATER CROSSING OVER HISAR GHAGGAR MULTIPURPOSE CHANNEL X-ING AT RD 183300 AND185200	CLOSING DATE 17.10.2026	0.94 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466751554 xenwsdivisionfbd@yahoo.com
10	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, KARNAL	CONSTRUCTION OF LINED DRAIN FROM RD 4300-7700 AND 01 NO. BRIDGE ON CONNECTING MAIN DRAIN NO. 1 AND 2 AT VILLAGE KHOTPURA TO PROTECT THE ABADI AREA AFTER FLOOD 2024	08.10.2026 16.10.2026	100.79 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184-2258008 xenirnddivn@yahoo.in
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ, KURUKSHETRA	VARIOUS DEVELOPMENT WORKS AT BRAHMA SAROVAR KURUKSHETRA FOR IGM 2026. + 6 WORKS	12.10.2026 17.10.2026	75.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9896224357 prexeeng.krk@hry.nic.in

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in

RO No.. 11/2027/220/50169/I/19/7

Yuvraj named DC assistant coach

NEW DELHI: Former India World Cup-winning all-rounder Yuvraj Singh was on Tuesday appointed assistant and batting coach of Delhi Capitals ahead of the 2027 IPL. The announcement comes a week after DC unveiled Sourav Ganguly as their head coach.

Sindhu, Sen make first-round exits

ODENSE: PV Sindhu and Lakshya Sen made early exits in the Denmark Open. Sindhu lost to Yvonne Li of Germany 21-13, 23-25, 19-21 in the first round. Sen lost to third seed Chou Tien Chen of Chinese Taipei 18-21, 21-13, 15-21. Tanvi Sharma won 21-17, 16-21, 21-19 against Natsuki Nidaira of Japan.

Rajputana Royals beat Chero Archers

HYDERABAD: Shaking off a sluggish start to their campaign, title holders Rajputana Royals injected fresh life into their APL defence, sweeping past Chero Archers. The Royals, who went through a rut with three straight defeats, thrashed Chero 6-0.

Ankur, Diya win Natl Ranking TT titles

PANCHKULA: Ankur Bhattacharjee and Diya Chitale clinched the men's and women's titles at the second National Ranking TT Championships. Bhattacharjee beat Maharashtra's Raegan Albuquerque 4-3, while Diya got the better of West Bengal's Syndrela Das 4-3.

East Bengal lose 2-3 to Iraq's Al Shorta

KOLKATA: David Lalhlansanga's (8th, 40th) brace went in vain as East Bengal lost 2-3 to Iraq's Al Shorta in their second group match of AFC Champions League 2. The Iraqi side scored through Ruben Ramirez (14th) and Hussein Al Saedi (51st) and Kingsley Kuku (53rd).

Australia's Josh Hazlewood (2nd R) celebrates after dismissing South Africa's Wiaan Mulder on day five of the first Test. AFP

Hazlewood clinches six, ends SA captain Bavuma's unbeaten run

Agencies
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

DURBAN: Josh Hazlewood took six wickets as Australia completed a 214-run win over South Africa on the fifth day of the first Test at Kingsmead on Tuesday. Fast bowler Hazlewood twice broke promising stands and finished with 6/49.

Player of the match Matt Renshaw scored 190 during the first innings as he ended a near-decade wait for a second Test century. The hosts, set 421 runs to win, were bowled out for 206, in the first Test series between the teams in South Africa since the 2018 sandpaper scandal.

"It's a great way to kick off a series, particularly from the position we were on day one," the tourists' captain Pat Cummins said after they were 124 for six early on before controlling the rest of the fixture against the world Test champions.

Cummins added he was proud of the team for "clawing our way back, kind of grinding it out, and then once we had the lead, you know, not giving it back".

"I think our standards were very high for the last three or four days," he added.

South Africa skipper Temba Bavuma said his players needed to learn from the way Australia played after his first loss in 13 Tests as captain.

"They showed their experience, they showed their skill to get themselves into a very competitive position," Bavuma said. "You don't want to give them that opportunity to play the game from the front.

"We had the opportunity to prepare as well as we could."

"I think a lot of the mistakes we made out there were mental," he added after South Africa's first Test in 11 months.

Opening batsman Aiden Markram defied the bowlers for a minute short of six hours, scoring 75 before he was ninth out, caught behind from an inside edge off Mitchell Starc. The last four wickets fell for five runs in the space of 16 deliveries against the second new ball. Markram and Wiaan Mulder (29) were largely untroubled as they batted through the first 110 minutes of the day. But a double bowling change brought two wickets.

Mulder was caught down the legside by wicketkeeper Alex Carey off Hazlewood for 29 after a 139-minute innings during which he faced 110 balls.

Renshaw came on to bowl his off-spinners in the next over and with his first ball dismissed Kyle Verreynne for a single when the South Africa wicketkeeper played a forcing shot against a wide ball and edged a catch to Steve Smith at slip. It was the continuation of a dream match for Renshaw, who top-scored in both innings with 190 and 82, then took his first Test wicket when he dismissed Bavuma on Monday.

It was Smith's fifth catch of a match in which he became the world record-holder for most catches by a fielder in Tests.

Smith was back in action after being off the field at the start of South Africa's innings on Monday following a blow on the head while batting.

Marco Jansen made 35 and added 45 with Markram before Hazlewood bowled him in the fourth over with the second new ball. Three balls later Simon Harmer gloved a sharply lifting ball to Carey.

Australia were in trouble with the bat on the first day but dominated the rest of the match after Renshaw steered them to a first-innings total of 390.

South Africa will need to bounce back quickly in the second Test of the three-match series in Gqeberha starting on Sunday, when Bavuma hinted that key fast bowler Kagiso Rabada would likely be fit to play.

Brief scores: Australia 390 and 314/6 dec. South Africa 284 and 206 all out (Markram 75, Bedingham 46, Hazlewood 6/49, Renshaw 2/30). **Australia won by 214 runs.**

Afghanistan save Bangladesh Test

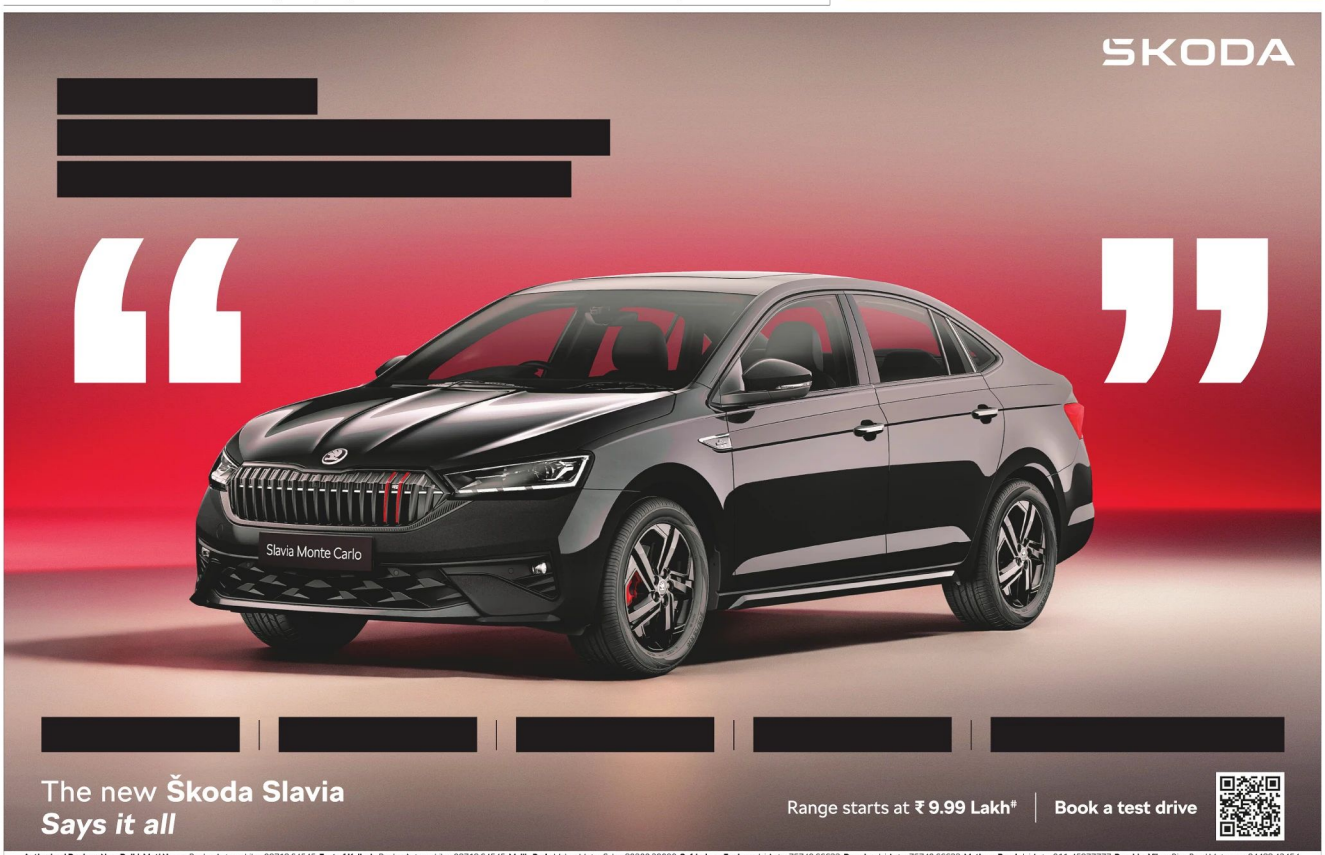
ABU DHABI: Sediqullah Atal's marathon century and some inspired lower-order resistance inspired Afghanistan to a dramatic draw in the one-off Test against Bangladesh on Tuesday.

Opener Atal, playing only his third Test, batted for eight-and-a-half hours for his 332-ball 111 before No 9 Qais Ahmad hit 49*.

Having started the final day on 132/3, Afghanistan survived to finish on 346/8, from a total of 142 overs, after being set a 479-run target to win.

When Atal fell to a close-in catch off left-arm spinner Taijul Islam soon after tea with the score at 281/7, Bangladesh were in sight of victory.

But Qais and fellow tail-ender Yamin Ahmadzai (19 off 85 balls) batted for 110 deliveries in a valiant 45-run stand for the eighth wicket to resist Bangladesh's spinners. Even when Ahmadzai fell to Mehidy Hasan, Bangladesh had five overs to enforce a win but Qais and Zia-ur-Rehman hung on.



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